

THE SEQUEL TO THE BEST SELLING EROTICA SERIES
'THE MODERN HUSBAND'S GUIDE TO WIFE SHARING'

A woman with long, wavy blonde hair and dramatic blue and black eye makeup is the central figure. She is wearing a vibrant red, halter-neck, low-cut dress and holding a gold, sequined clutch bag. She is standing in a dark nightclub setting with other patrons and red neon lights visible in the background. The overall mood is sensual and glamorous.

THE HOTWIFE DIARIES

#2: RACY DAISY
PAUL GARLAND

The Hotwife Diaries #2: Racy Daisy

The Hotwife Diaries
Book 2

Paul Garland



Copyright © 2026 by Paul Garland

All rights reserved.

No part of this book may be reproduced in any form or by any electronic or mechanical means, including information storage and retrieval systems, without written permission from the author, except for the use of brief quotations in a book review.

This is a work of fiction. Any resemblance to real world people, places or events, is purely coincidental.

✿ Formatted with Vellum

Contents

[Foreword](#)

1. [The Darling of Far Bridge Rise](#)
2. [A New Commission](#)
3. [Female Intuition](#)
4. [So, Claudia](#)
5. [Nothing, If Not Professional](#)
6. [Honesty Is Always The Best Policy](#)
7. [Different In Person](#)
8. [Putting It All Together](#)
9. [Euphoria](#)

[Afterword](#)

[About the Author](#)

[Also by Paul Garland](#)

Foreword

Welcome back! Unless you're new, in which case you should probably know there are nine books that led up to this one! The four 'Trad Wife' books featuring Jamie and Millie, the four 'Modern Husband' books focusing on Jordan and Daisy, and then, of course, the first Hotwife Diaries book, 'Sinner Minnie'

So, what do you have to look forward to in this one? We left off with Millie continuing her adventures, hitting the stumbling block of 'what's next?' then following Sophia's advice, leaving to her ad hoc night with a total stranger, and culminating in one of her followers, a guy called Jordan, setting up a meeting to share their experiences.

'The Hotwife Diaries #2: Racy Daisy' advances Jordan and Daisy's stories beyond the end of 'Modern Husband,' seeing how they will overcome their own obstacles before that fateful exchange of emails with Millie.

Again, writing this book felt like spending time with old friends, the fifth book that I've written with these particular characters and the Neighbourhood Watch of Far Bridge Rise, but some of what I wrote surprised me along the way.

I hope you enjoy those surprises as much as I did.

Thanks for your interest in my worlds and characters,

Paul

Chapter 1

The Darling of Far Bridge Rise

Claudia was one of the hottest women I'd ever seen in my life.

She was standing at the far end of the trestle table that Linda and Morgan had dragged out onto the cul-de-sac, a glass of red wine in her hand, laughing at something her husband, Tom, just said. Tall with beautiful pale skin the colour of alabaster, jet-dark hair pulled back loosely into a knot that let a few strands fall around her face, wearing a black leather jacket open over jeans and a tight black T-shirt that had absolutely no business being worn outside in January.

"Close your mouth, dear," Daisy said beside me, handing me a bottle of beer.

"I wasn't—"

"Yes, you were." She smiled, unbothered, and clinked her glass against my bottle. She was in a black rollneck sweater and tight blue jeans, her blonde hair loose, the silver anklet just visible above the heel of her boot. She looked gorgeous, too. "She's very pretty, isn't she?"

Pretty wasn't the word I'd use to describe Claudia. Beautiful was more accurate. But I didn't say that.

"She's alright."

Daisy raised an eyebrow. "Jordan. She's stunning, and you know it. Take your eyes off her breasts, you're embarrassing yourself."

I took a sip of beer and made a conscious effort to look elsewhere. The street was busy with all the residents of the street, not just the members of the Neighbourhood Watch, but new people I'd rarely seen, all congregating to enjoy the New Year's Eve party. The Watch had strung fairy lights between the lamp posts, looping them from gate post to gate post so the

whole cul-de-sac glowed in bright primary colours. A portable speaker near Charlotte and Russell's front step was playing something vaguely festive, and the smell of Morgan's grill drifted from the food table, burgers, sausages, and onions cutting through the cold late-December air.

Charlotte was there in a silver sequinned top that caught the coloured lights, her blonde hair down, talking to Frank's wife with a glass of prosecco in one hand. She was a striking woman—blonde with curves in all the right places—and she knew it. Her husband, Russell, stood near the drinks table, a few beers into his evening, his hands in his pockets. He was a good-looking guy, too, with a penchant for watching his wife with other men. By all accounts, they wanted me to be one of those men, but it wouldn't be tonight. We had our plans for how to bring in the New Year.

Linda and Frank were working the food table with their usual easy efficiency. Linda was in a long camel coat, her silver-blonde hair in a bun atop her head, handing out napkins with the warmth of someone who genuinely loved hosting. Her husband, the bulky, broad Frank, stood over the grill, turning sausages with a spatula and the focused expression of a man who took grilling seriously.

Their daughter, Kendall, was there near a made-for-the-occasion fire pit with Jake, her part-time boyfriend and lover. She looked good, wrapped in a dark coat, her dark hair fluttering in the light breeze. Paul and Tyler were by the low wall near number twelve, both in dark jackets, Tyler saying something that made Paul tip his head back with laughter. Tyler was lean and angular, Paul stockier, both of them easy company, good guys that I'd gotten to know well in the few months that we'd lived here. Daisy knew them well, too. Along with Frank, they were the three guys on the street that she'd fucked so far.

The new people from number seventeen were out too. Tom, I'd met briefly—tall, neat haircut, a friendly, open face, the kind of man who made a good impression without trying too hard. He was in jeans and a dark shirt, a bottle of beer in hand, looking considerably more relaxed than he had the night he'd met us, Daisy naked, Paul and Tyler and me all in various states of undress. But tonight was the first time I'd seen his wife, Claudia.

I'd been warned she was attractive. Linda had said something offhand about the new neighbours the other day. *"You'll like them. She's very striking."* I'd nodded and not thought much of it. But I wasn't prepared for just how good-looking she was.

"Have you spoken to her yet?" I asked Daisy.

"Briefly. We were in the supermarket queue together, and Morgan introduced me. She seems lovely, actually. Really friendly, like most people on Far Bridge Rise." Daisy paused, watching her. "And yes, before you ask, they still want me to talk to her about the watch. Just not tonight. Tonight's for having fun."

She squeezed my arm and drifted off towards Linda, her anklet catching the light with each step. I watched her go, then looked back at Claudia, who was now gesturing at something with her wine glass, laughing again, the leather jacket shifting across her shoulders. Tom was watching her the way I watched Daisy sometimes—with pride and a quiet awareness that everyone else's eyes were on her.

"She's quite something, isn't she?"

I turned. A man I didn't know was standing beside me, also facing the far end of the table, a paper plate with a half-eaten hot dog in his hand. Thirty, maybe a year either side. Dark hair, dark skin that contrasted with his startling green eyes, and a lean and easy build. He had Tyler's face and build, which made the introduction almost unnecessary.

"Jordan," I said, offering my hand.

"Lewis." He shook it. "Tyler's son."

"I thought so. You look just like your dad. You're back for New Year?"

"Everyone says that," he grinned, "Just back for a week. Dad and Morgan keep threatening to redecorate my old bedroom, and I keep showing up to prevent it." He nodded in Claudia's direction. "Have you met Claudia properly yet?"

"Not properly. They just moved in." I gestured to the house opposite ours. "Number seventeen."

"I know. Tom's a good bloke," Lewis said. "We went to school together, years ago, lost touch, then ran into each other a few months back. He was looking for somewhere new, and I mentioned there was a house on Far Bridge Rise." He took another bite from the hot dog, licking a trace of mustard from his lip. "I told them it was a very friendly neighbourhood."

The way he said *friendly* suggested Lewis knew what the Neighbourhood Watch, including his father and stepmum, got up to. But I didn't know for sure, so I spoke carefully.

"It has its moments," I said. "Most of the neighbours are very accommodating."

Lewis smiled to himself and left it there, which I appreciated. We stood together for a minute watching the street. Kids were weaving between parked cars with glow sticks, trailing loops of green and pink light through the dark. The fire pit near the end of the cul-de-sac was throwing orange light across the faces of Charlotte, Russell, Paul's wife Corinne and Kelly, and a small cluster of others. Music was drifting from at least three different houses, none of it quite matching.

Daisy's best friend, Elia, appeared at my elbow, slipping her arm through mine. She was in a dark green coat, her platinum hair straightened and glossy, cheeks pink from the cold. "Why are you standing here looking all boring and serious?" she said.

"I'm not. I'm talking to Lewis. Tyler and Morgan's son."

"Oh." She leaned past me. "Hi. I'm Elia, Daisy's friend. Nice to meet you."

"Lewis. Nice to meet you, too." The way the two looked each other up and down made me uneasy, and slightly jealous for some reason.

"She's with my friend—" I started, but Elia didn't let me finish.

"Spencer. Yes." She smiled. "He's over there arguing with Paul about something entirely pointless, as usual."

I looked. My best mate, Spencer, was indeed deep in what appeared to be a heated but good-natured disagreement with Paul near the drinks table, gesturing wildly with his beer bottle. Spencer was tall, dark-haired, broad across the shoulders. We'd invited them to the party. They already knew Paul and Corinne, they had for years, dating each other's partners originally before somehow switching. He caught my eye and gave a brief, easy nod. We'd arrived at a comfortable understanding in the couple of weeks since that night in the car park—nothing formal, nothing discussed at length, just an unspoken acceptance of what was probably going to happen eventually, a loose *let's see* agreement of sorts.

He and Elia were staying the night at ours. The spare room was made up ready for them, but whether it actually got used was still up in the air.

The evening rolled forward. Someone produced a box of sparklers around ten o'clock that the children burned through with impressive enthusiasm, carving letters of golden light in the cold air. Linda made a short speech that was partly about the New Year and partly about how much she loved this particular collection of people on this particular street, which got genuine applause and a wave of raised glasses. Tyler restocked the food

on the grill with quiet satisfaction at how many people were enjoying it. Russell was dancing with Spencer and Paul, and Charlotte turned to look at me across the crowd, her sequins throwing small stars of light at me, smiling when I nodded at her.

Daisy and I mixed and mingled until I found her near the fire pit around eleven. She was standing with Elia, both of them pink-cheeked and laughing, their clouds of breath mingling with the smoke from the slowly dwindling fire. She had a fresh glass of wine, and I could tell straight away that both she and Elia were merry, to say the least.

"Are you having a good time?" I asked, putting my arm around her.

"Brilliant." She leaned into me. "I saw you talking to that Lewis guy. He's handsome. Tyler says he's his son."

"That's right. He knows Tom from school, apparently."

"It's a small world." She dropped her voice slightly. "Elia just asked me what the sleeping arrangements were."

"And? What did you say?"

"I told her we had a spare room made up if they needed it. I played it very cool."

I laughed. "Very diplomatic."

"We'll see what happens, but I know they're going to try to get things on with us," she murmured, glancing at Elia next to her. "You can tell just by looking at her."

I could. Elia's pretty green eyes held a sparkle in them as she saw me looking her way, and it wasn't the reflection of the fire between us.

As midnight approached, everyone counted down together, voices rising across the cul-de-sac, and then the cheer went up as the clock struck 00:00. Glasses were raised, kids screaming with excitement as the fireworks started. Someone on the Rise had clearly invested some serious money, rockets going up every few seconds, the sky above us blooming in bursts of gold and red and white that lit up the street, bangs that echoed off the walls.

I saw Charlotte kiss Russell, Tyler and Morgan dancing, Linda and Frank holding each other under the fairy lights the way people do when they've been together long enough to appreciate moments like this. Lewis raised his beer bottle to the sky with a grin. Claudia stood on her toes to kiss Tom, one hand on his chest, the leather jacket catching the light from the fireworks above. Spencer and Elia had their tongues down each other's

throats like youngsters still in their dating stages rather than a couple that had been together for years.

Daisy turned to me, and we kissed properly, her hand coming up to cup my jaw, warm despite the cold air. "Happy New Year," she said softly against my lips.

"Happy New Year," I replied. "I love you."

"I love you too." She pulled back just far enough to look at me, eyes bright in the dark. "You know what? That's the highlight of the night done. I think I'm ready to head home."

"Already?"

I saw her glance over her shoulder towards Spencer, catching his eye through the thinning crowd. He was standing with Elia's hand in his, watching us with an open, easy expression. Elia caught my eye too and smiled, reading the look correctly and walking over.

"Yeah," I said, understanding. "I think I am too."

We took our time saying our goodbyes, wished everyone a happy new year, and then left the party just after half twelve, the four of us peeling away from the street while the last few small fireworks went off and people finished up their food and drinks. Nobody noticed, or if they did, nobody showed it.

Inside, the house was warm and quiet after the noise and cold outside. Daisy took everyone's coats. I opened a fresh bottle of wine without anyone asking and poured four glasses.

We took them into the living room. The fairy lights were still up around the window, the lamp on low, the heating on so the house wouldn't be cold when we got back. Elia kicked off her shoes and curled into Spencer on the sofa, bare feet tucked under her. Daisy settled beside me next to them, legs folded across my lap.

It was the most comfortable version of tension I'd ever felt. There was no pretence, no performance, just four friends in a warm room at the beginning of a new year with a bottle of wine and a loosely understood agreement.

Spencer broke the silence first.

"So," he grinned, looking between Daisy and me. "You've made us the spare room up."

"Yeah, the spare room," I confirmed, "It's nice. The bed is comfy."

"Right." He glanced at Elia, who was watching Daisy with a small, private smile. "And we're using it because—?"

"Because it's more comfortable than the sofa," Daisy answered sweetly.

The silence lasted about three seconds.

"But not as comfy as your bed," Spencer said simply.

Daisy looked at him. "Our bed is very comfy," she giggled.

"This is the first time we've all been together since that night in the car park." Elia sat up straight, her gaze switching between Daisy and me. "It'd be a shame if we didn't take advantage of the chance to carry on what we started before." She looked at Daisy directly. "Unless you didn't enjoy what we did that time?"

"Oh, I enjoyed it," Daisy replied with a small shrug.

Everyone looked at me. My heart was thumping in my chest with excitement.

"I think we all enjoyed it," I added.

Spencer let out a long breath that sounded like he'd been holding forever. "Elia and I have been reliving it every time we've fucked since then," he admitted.

Elia laughed, the last of the tension dissolving. "Apart from the part where your professor ruined it."

"Yeah, that was unexpected," Daisy chuckled. "But it worked out okay in the end."

She unfolded herself from the armchair and stood, holding her wine glass. She was still in the black sweater and jeans, hair loose, anklet glinting at her ankle, and she looked at Spencer with the clear, unhurried confidence of a woman who knew precisely what she was doing. "So, why don't we take this to the bedroom?" She turned and walked towards the stairs. "Bring your drinks."

In the bedroom, the four of us barely paused. Spencer sat on the edge of the bed and pulled Elia onto his lap, kissing her with no self-consciousness left between them since that night in the car park. Daisy and I hung back near the door for a moment, watching them, her hand finding mine.

"They're so carefree," she said quietly. "Are we really going to do this?"

"Only if you want to," I replied. One look into Daisy's deep brown eyes gave me the answer.

She kissed me, her hands wrapping around my shoulders, her body melting into mine, while Spencer and Elia undressed each other two feet

away. I closed my eyes, savouring the feeling of Daisy's lips on mine, but could hear the sounds coming from the bed—zippers pulled down, the rustle of garments coming off, hitting the floor, Elia's soft laugh at something.

We moved to the bed also, joining them in undressing without any inhibitions. We'd all seen each other naked now, so the clothes came off without hesitation. The bedroom light was off, but there was enough light from the landing to see Elia's body as she was the first to be completely bared. She was short, petite and pale, and completely bare between her legs, her platinum hair loose around her bare shoulders. Daisy's blonde hair fell forward as she reached back to unclip her bra herself, then slid off her underwear, standing naked except for the silver anklet. Spencer was naked, too, his impressive cock already hard, rigid, standing straight out in front of him, and I watched Daisy clock it with that eager, excited expression I recognised from the car park.

Spencer looked at Daisy, enjoying the sight of her pert breasts for a second, then he turned to me. "So," he said. "You've already seen us have sex. We want to watch you two."

Daisy raised an eyebrow. "Is that right?"

"We've talked about it," Elia said, settling cross-legged on the bed beside Spencer, completely at ease with her own nakedness. "A lot, actually. I want to know what you look like when you fuck."

"Ever since I watched you suck Jordan," Spencer said, his eyes on Daisy, "and when I felt your pussy in the car, I kept thinking—"

"What it would look like inside me," Daisy finished for him.

"Exactly."

Daisy looked at me. I gestured at the bed. "Shall we show them?" I asked, then, when my wife nodded, "After you."

She lay back against the pillows, her blonde hair spread out around her, the silver anklet catching the low light at her ankle. She held out her hand, and I took it, fingers intertwining, and lowered myself over her. My cock was already hard with excitement, and as the head of it found her pussy, it slipped straight in. She was already soaking wet, and when I pushed into her, she exhaled slowly, her eyes holding mine, her free hand coming to rest flat on my chest, slowing me down, not wanting me to rush this.

Spencer and Elia sat at the foot of the bed, close together, Elia's hand on Spencer's thigh. Neither of them spoke as I began to slowly fuck my wife,

something so familiar and yet so new, being watched so intently. Spencer's eyes tracked from Daisy's face down the length of her body to my cock sliding in and out of her, and he moved closer, his face just inches away, taking it in with the focused attention of a man who had been curious about this specific sight for a long time. Elia watched my face, then Daisy's, then looked down between us, also looking at my cock as I began to find a rhythm.

"Does it look good?" Daisy moaned, looking up at Spencer. "Seeing me get fucked?"

"God, yes," Spencer said under his breath. "Your body is incredible, Daisy."

I looked sideways after a few minutes, when I felt the bed shift as Spencer moved closer. He had his cock in his hand, wanking himself slowly as he knelt beside Daisy's head. His other hand brushed the hair from her face, and she turned to look at him without breaking rhythm with me, taking him into her mouth as naturally as if we'd choreographed it.

I glanced at my friend's face, saw his jaw tighten immediately at the sensation of his cock in Daisy's mouth. His hand rested lightly on her hair, his eyes closing for a second, then opening to find mine watching him. Something passed between us, a shared acknowledgement of what was going to happen next, then he began to fuck her mouth while I fucked her pussy.

Elia was beside me, her lithe body warm at my side, her mouth close to my ear. "This is so fucking sexy," she murmured softly. "Seeing you guys fuck and Daisy suck Spencer's cock again." Her hand traced down my arm, feeling the movement of my body. "I wanted you to fuck me so much that night. Why don't you—" she kissed my jaw "—do it now, and let Spencer have Daisy? You know it's going to happen sooner or later."

"Is that what you want?" I asked. "You want to swap partners?"

"Ask your wife what she wants," Elia replied with a small shrug that made her small breasts dance in the low light.

Spencer took his cock out of Daisy's mouth, her hand wrapped around the wet shaft, stroking him slowly. She was looking at me with bright, decided eyes.

"I want Spencer," she said simply. "You can fuck Elia if you want. She wants you."

"Yes, I fuck do," Elia confirmed.

I pulled out of Daisy's pussy, the cool air in the bedroom hitting my throbbing cock. I didn't know how long I'd last with Elia. I was already close, my erection throbbing with excitement. Spencer was already moving, taking my place between Daisy's spread thighs, as soon as I shifted across to Elia, who pulled me down immediately, her small hands gripping my shoulders, her mouth finding mine.

But we didn't go straight to sex. Elia pushed me onto my back and slid down, taking me in her mouth with the same directness she applied to everything, her platinum hair falling across my stomach. I propped myself on one elbow to watch Daisy and Spencer as I felt her lips close around my shaft, tasting Daisy's juices. Fuck, it felt good.

Spencer was kneeling between my wife's legs, working his way down her body with his mouth, and she had one hand in his dark hair and one fist in the sheet and was trying to stay quiet and failing. He took a nipple into his mouth, sucking gently, and her back arched from the bed.

"Just fuck me," she whimpered. "I want to know what you feel like inside me."

When he finally pushed up and lined himself against her, positioning the shiny, hard tip of his cock against her slick folds, she moaned in anticipation before he'd even entered her.

"I've thought about this since the moment I first saw your cock," she told him. "Don't hold back. Just fuck me. I like it hard, okay?"

"I've thought about this since I first met you," Spencer finished, pushing into Daisy slowly. "I've always wanted to fuck you."

She made a sound that started as a word and became something else entirely, her back arching again, both hands gripping his arms as he went deep. I had the perfect viewpoint to see her lips stretch out around his girth until it disappeared inside her, his balls resting against her ass. He was slow and deliberate, watching her face, pausing, but she shook her head at the pause.

"I know you've wanted me for ages," she sighed. "So just fucking take me. Fuck me hard."

He stopped being slow and deliberate.

Elia was still sucking my cock, but stopped then, keeping me in her hand as she got on top and straddled me, taking me inside her smooth, waxed pussy with one smooth drop of her hips, a small gasp escaping her, then a satisfied sound as she settled fully, our bodies connecting at the base

of my cock. She was tight, wet, and her hips felt soft and smooth as I took hold of her, guiding her as she began to move with her eyes half-closed, her platinum hair falling forward. Her tits were small, perky, with pale nipples, and I couldn't help but stare as this elven goddess rode my cock. Was this really happening?

We were parallel on the bed now, Elia riding me, Daisy beneath Spencer, both women facing the same direction, both men watching each other's partner with the other. Even after everything we'd done so far, this felt like the pinnacle, the moment we'd been waiting for, sharing our partner's pussies.

Daisy's hand slid between her own thighs, fingers working at her clit while Spencer moved inside her. Her head turned to find me, her cheeks glowing red, a similar-coloured flush spreading across her chest.

"He's so big," she murmured, "I'm going to cum."

"Do it," I replied, "I want to watch you cum on his cock."

Spencer thrust into her twice more, fast and hard, and Daisy's whole body lurched as her orgasm hit her. But he didn't pause, he pushed her knees up and forward, his weight pinning her, driving deeper and harder now, and the sound she made at the new position made Elia close her eyes above me and grind down harder. My cock throbbed in response. I was close to the edge.

"You can cum inside me," Elia said breathlessly, "I'm on the pill—" she paused, her rhythm breaking slightly, then I felt her pussy tighten around me, and she giggled, "—And I know Daisy is too, she told me."

"Does that mean Spencer wants to come inside her, too?" I asked.

"Why not? We're friends, we might as well fucking do this right," she grinned. "Come on, Jordan. Fill my tight little pussy up."

I felt the bed move and saw Daisy roll onto all fours, her thighs still trembling from her orgasm. Spencer put the head of his cock back inside her, then grabbed her hips, dragging her back onto him, making her groan like an animal at the feeling of him invading her deeply. Then he fucked her like a man who'd been waiting for this his whole life, his body thudding against hers ruthlessly until she came again. This time she wailed, loud and long and completely unguarded, her whole body shaking, Spencer pounding her through every second of it, his jaw set and his pace relentless.

I followed her over the edge while Daisy was still shaking, Elia's thighs locked around me, her small body taut, and I finished with both hands

gripping her hips and my face in her platinum hair as she leaned forward, pressing her lips against mine until every drop of cum had spurted from my cock deep into her pussy.

To my surprise, Elia made a sound against my temple that might have been my name, then shuddered, her own orgasm convulsing through her as she ground her pussy against me, my cock already wilting inside her.

We lay loose and warm in the dark while Spencer ploughed on, still taking Daisy from behind with that controlled, deliberate pace. Daisy was boneless beneath him, face buried in the pillow, arms flailing on either side of her, making soft sounds that were somewhere between exhaustion and disbelief.

"I'm close. I'm gonna—" he started.

"Do it," Daisy moaned into the pillow.

He pushed deep and finished with a low, sustained groan, his whole body going rigid and then slowly releasing. He stayed inside her until it passed, holding her hips so she couldn't pull away, ensuring that every drop of cum went as deep as it could into my wife's pussy.

The room went quiet except for the heavy breathing as we tried to catch our breath, and the last beats of the music filtering in through the window.

The four of us stayed there, on the bed, for a long while. I closed my eyes, feeling Elia curled into my side, her head on my chest, one hand wrapped loosely around my waist. I opened my eyes before I could drift off to sleep, seeing Daisy in the low light from the landing, lying under Spencer's arm with her legs tangled in his, the anklet still on, a satisfied smile still on her lips.

Spencer broke the silence. "That's what you call," he said to the ceiling, "Bringing in the New Year with a bang."

Daisy laughed, a real laugh, low and slow and deeply satisfied. "Happy New Year."

Elia tilted her head up to look at me. "That was worth the wait," she murmured.

"And that was just round one," I teased. "You're staying the night, remember?"

Spencer looked across at Daisy. "And I don't think we need the spare room," he chuckled, "This bed is plenty big enough for four."

Daisy reached up, pulling the pillows into position where they could rest their heads on them. "You're not going anywhere." She wrapped her

arms around him tighter, pushing her naked body against his. "I'm not done with you yet."

I looked at them entwined together, what had just occurred slowly sinking in. The four of us were friends, close friends, best friends, and we'd just fucked each other's partners. There was no guilt in it—we'd all walked into this with our eyes open—but there was a gravity to it, an importance, the feeling of having crossed a line that changed the shape of things. Spencer had been inside my wife. I had been inside his. We were lying four in a bed in the early hours of New Year's Day, and nobody wanted to be anywhere else.

It felt, strangely, like we'd got closer. Not just physically. Like we'd formed a bond tonight that was even stronger than the one we'd had before as friends. The four of us were lovers now, not just friends.

Elia tilted her head up and looked at me, reading my expression. "What are you thinking about?" she asked. "No regrets, I hope?"

"None at all," I reassured her. "It just feels... weird. Weird but nice. Like we're all closer now."

She smiled. "I know what you mean." She glanced across at Daisy and Spencer, Daisy's blonde hair against his shoulder, his hand moving slowly up and down her arm. "It only feels like this with people you care about. That's why, in the lifestyle, you have to be careful not to get the feels. You have to communicate well. Keep it light. Keep it fun."

"I get it," Daisy spoke, her voice soft and easy. She turned her head slightly to look at Elia over Spencer's chest. "I feel the same. I'm glad we did this. I'm glad we waited until it felt right and didn't rush into it." She pushed herself closer into Spencer's side, the silver anklet catching the light as she moved. "I'm glad we have you guys to share this with."

Spencer pressed his mouth to the top of her head. "So am I."

A comfortable quiet settled over the room again as the sounds of the party outside finally ended. No more fireworks, no music playing.

Spencer let out a long, satisfied breath. "The New Year party was fun, but I will say one thing to you about it."

"What?" Daisy asked.

"Claudia." He glanced down at her. "I think you've been dethroned as *the official new hot girl on the block*. I overheard the guys in your Neighbourhood Watch setting a challenge for who'll get to bed her first. Frank was bragging that he was Daisy's first and betting that he'd be the

first to get into Claudia's panties, too. Tyler reckons he's already halfway there. Paul was making a case for himself, saying she was definitely flirting with him at the drinks table."

Daisy was quiet for a moment. "Is that right?" she said. It wasn't quite a question.

"Personally, I don't think she holds a candle to you," Spencer paused. "Or Elia. But she is good-looking, in her own way."

Another silence, shorter this time. He was wrong. Claudia wasn't *good-looking in her own way*. She was stunning. There was no other way of putting it.

"Well, having competition for the crown of *Darling of Far Bridge Rise* isn't necessarily a bad thing," Daisy quipped, "It'll motivate me to up my game."

She said it lightly with a hint of a giggle, but then pressed her lips together as she settled back against the bed, as if she was already thinking about what he'd said and taking it seriously.

I caught Elia's eye. She was trying not to smile, reading Daisy's reaction the same way I just had.

The new year, it seemed, was already getting interesting.

ON THE PARADOX OF THE HOTWIFE: BELONGING AND FREEDOM

Excerpt from: Personal Research Notes: Consensual Non-Monogamy: Identity, Agency and the Female Experience

Daisy M Hoyland, December 2025

The term "hotwife" is, on the surface, a contradiction. The word *wife* implies exclusivity, belonging, and a closed relational unit. The prefix *hot* — in this context meaning sexually available to others — appears to open up that closure entirely. Popular discourse tends to treat the two halves of the term as being in tension. They are not.

In practice, the hotwife dynamic functions precisely *because* of the marital bond, not despite it. The husband's presence — as witness, facilitator, or participant — is not incidental to the encounter. It is central to it. Remove the husband, and you do not have a hotwife. You simply have a woman having sex with other men.

What distinguishes the hotwife from the unfaithful wife is not the act but the architecture around it: consent, communication, and the deliberate returning to the primary relationship. Each encounter with another man is, paradoxically, an act performed *within* the marriage rather than against it. The husband resets the boundaries. The wife moves inside them freely.

From a personal standpoint — and this researcher acknowledges the blurred boundary between subject and observer — the experience of being *chosen* by one's husband for this role carries its own particular charge. To be desired by others is pleasurable. To be desired by others *because* your husband finds that desirable, and to return to him afterwards as his, is something considerably more layered.

The symbology of the anklet is significant. It's not a collar. It is a symbol of a unique type of freedom.

Chapter 2

A New Commission

Daisy always made the coffee on the mornings she didn't have an early start, which was her way of pulling her weight, and which I accepted as a perfectly fair arrangement. She set a mug in front of me without being asked, dropped two slices of bread in the toaster, and sat down across from me with her own coffee and the expression of someone who had been awake and thinking since they first got out of bed.

"I'm nervous," she said, taking a sip of the hot drink.

"About university?" Today was her first day back. Her first time seeing Dr Patterson, her supervisor and lecturer, since she'd let him watch her have sex. The first time it was with Frank, Patterson at my side, in the bedroom after the Christmas Party. The second time it was over a live feed, a phone on a shelf while Tyler and Paul shared her.

"About seeing Peter." She wrapped both hands around her mug. Outside the kitchen window, the sky was grey, the kind of miserable cold that made the summer feel like a memory. "I didn't think I would be until I woke up today."

"He's a professional," I reassured her. "He'll be in full university professor mode the moment you walk through the door. It'll be all 'welcome back everyone, here's your new supervision notes, thesis feedback, your conference and lecture schedules.' You'll see."

"That's who he'll be when all the other students are there," she agreed, pushing a lock of stray blonde hair out of her eyes. "But he's going to want to talk to me, isn't he? About everything that happened."

"Obviously," I shrugged. "But you can handle him. Just because you've indulged him a little isn't going to change anything."

She looked at her coffee. "I guess. What if he wants to do more, though?"

"That's up to you," I replied. "If he wants to talk about it, let him talk. Then come home, and we'll discuss it. We haven't really decided what's next for us in the whole lifestyle thing besides what we did last weekend with Spencer and Elia."

The toast popped. She got up for it before I could, which meant she was more restless than she was letting on. She put it on a plate, scraped on a haphazard smattering of butter, then pushed it across to me and stayed standing, leaning against the counter.

"No, we haven't." She chewed her lip, twirling the offending lock of blonde hair in her fingers now. "I'll play it by ear, see how he is with me today. If it's professional and normal, then great."

She picked up her coffee again, decision made, restlessness settling, and took a sip.

"And if it isn't?"

She smiled over the rim of her mug. "If it's weird, then I remind him that I caught him jerking off in a dogging car park, watching one of his students in the back seat of a car, like a total perve."

"You've got this," I nodded. We ate our toast. Lady Gaga was playing on the radio. The washing machine finished its cycle in the utility room and clicked into silence.

She gathered herself to go, grabbing her bag from the hallway, her long grey coat from the hook, wrapping her scarf around her neck twice and tying her hair back into a long ponytail. She came back to the kitchen doorway, looked at me still sitting at the table with my mug and my crumb-filled plate.

"Right. Back to the daily grind," she sighed. "What are you going to do with your day, my modern husband?"

"I'd find something, I'm sure," I teased, putting my feet up on the stool next to me.

She crossed to me, tipped my chin up with one finger and kissed me, a long, lingering kiss that caused me to put my feet down and put a hand around the back of her head, but just as I did, she slipped away with a knowing smile.

"I expect dinner to be on the table when I get home at five."

"Yes, ma'am," I nodded, "Dinner at five. Got it."

One more kiss, and then she was gone, her citrusy perfume hanging in the air for a moment.

I drank the rest of my coffee, then looked around the kitchen at the breakfast things needing clearing, the surfaces needing wiping, I needed to start prepping the vegetables to go in the slow cooker with the lamb joint I had ready.

I got up, rolled my sleeves, and got to work.

* * *

The morning passed without any problems. The house felt quiet because I'd had Daisy's company every day throughout the festive holidays. I sorted out the kitchen, put a second load of washing on in the utility room, then back to the kitchen. I peeled the vegetables, browned the lamb in the cast-iron pan until the kitchen smelled amazing, then layered it all into the slow cooker with stock, rosemary, and a glass of the red wine we'd opened last night. Finally, I put the lid on and set it on low for seven hours. It would be cooked perfectly by five o'clock.

I was cleaning the floors, wringing out the mop, when my phone buzzed on the counter.

Hey you. Are you free this afternoon? I want to talk to you about something work-related. My Aunt Kamol's, one o'clock? My treat. Sariya x

My commission agent. I checked the time. Just gone eleven-thirty.

I hadn't heard much from Sarah/Sariya since I'd delivered the Drake piece just before the New Year. I'd sent her the final image files, she'd replied with a string of fire emojis and "*Jordan, this is STUNNING*" in capitals, and then nothing after that. I wasn't worried. I knew Sariya was busy at the best of times, and this was Christmas, too. I should have gotten in touch because the final payment hadn't cleared yet, which I'd been too polite to chase, despite Daisy nagging me to do so numerous times.

I typed back:

I'd love to! See you at one.

I had an hour. I finished mopping, changed out of the clothes I'd been cleaning in, ran a razor over my face and put on a decent jumper. Then I checked the slow cooker once more — the smell made my stomach grumble hungrily — and pulled my coat on.

* * *

The drive to Kamol's took twenty minutes through streets that hadn't quite decided whether they were done with Christmas yet. Someone on Ashfield Road still had their lights up, a brightly coloured cascade covering the entire front of their house. Another house hadn't bothered to take the fairy lights off their enormous, conspicuous Christmas tree that stood proudly in the middle of their front garden.

I'd been thinking about Sariya, on and off, for three weeks.

The last time we'd seen each other, she'd told me her real name, told me her husband thought sex was a monthly duty that he had to perform, rather than a thing two people did for fun, told me she'd slept with her swinging best friend's husband behind her back, and felt simultaneously guilty and furious that everyone around her was apparently having transcendent sex while she was lying in the dark, masturbating next to a man who was already asleep. Then, when I suggested putting her in touch with Alex or Jake, two of the Rise's favourite 'bulls', she'd leaned forward with those dark eyes and said, with the dry precision of a woman who'd decided the direct route was less exhausting than the scenic one: *I'm not asking you to set me up with strangers. I'm hitting on you.*

I'd told her that Daisy and I weren't quite at that point yet, and it had ended there, despite her leaving the door open if I changed my mind.

We'd emailed since then, but everything had remained thoroughly professional. *The Drake piece is wonderful, the background shading is perfect, can you adjust the highlights slightly, but apart from that, the client is absolutely delighted.* Not a word about anything else. I was relieved and yet slightly disappointed. Sariya was very attractive, it was just a difficult topic to address with Daisy. How far did we want to open up our marriage and how fast?

I'd mentioned it to Daisy. Not the full context — just that her Aunt Kamol had overheard the conversation between us and Spencer and Elia, and that it had somehow gotten to Sariya, who'd asked me about it. I'd told her what she'd said about her dead-in-the-water sex life, and how she was looking for some no-strings fun with someone new. Daisy had tilted her head in that particular way and repeated '*someone new*', and I'd said '*she's interested in me*', and Daisy had been quiet for a moment, taking accurate stock of a situation.

Is she nice? she'd asked.

Yes, I'd said. Smart and funny and pretty, but it's not just that. She promised more work for me.

Daisy had nodded slowly. *We'll talk about it when the time is right. If she asks again, let me know.*

Which was very Daisy. Very deliberate, very calm, no drama. So I'd filed it away for now. Should I text her, let her know I was meeting Sariya today? I decided I should, but not just yet, because I was outside the restaurant, pushing the door open.

The delicious aromas hit me first — lemongrass and coconut milk. My stomach rumbled again, audibly, reminding me how hungry I was. The lunchtime crowd was thin today, a few tables occupied, low music playing, a dark-haired waitress balancing three empty plates and a stack of glasses in her hands as she made her way across the small room.

Kamol herself was behind the counter, small and lovely and somewhere between fifty and eighty, depending on the light, frowning at the waitress performing the balancing act. She looked up when I came in, and her face rearranged itself into a warm, welcoming smile.

"Jordan," she said warmly. "Your lady is in the corner. The pretty one."

"Do you have an unpretty clientele, Kamol?"

She waved a hand. "Everyone pretty if the light is right. But some people bring their own light. But yes, my niece very pretty." She guided me across the room to where Sariya was sitting, at the same corner table as last time. "Sit, sit. I'll bring drinks. Water? Coke?"

"I'll have whatever Sariya is having."

My commission agent had a glass of sparkling water in front of her, and she was looking at her phone, not even noticing that I'd arrived. She was wearing a dark burgundy wrap dress under a black coat draped over the back of her chair. Her black hair was down today. Last time it had been up, a loose bun with a strand escaping over her temple that she'd kept tucking back, something I found very cute. Down, it was thick and lustrous, falling past her shoulders, her make-up was subtle, and she looked — sexy. Had she dressed up to impress me?

She finally looked up as I approached, and the phone went straight into her bag, her eyes taking me in as I smiled at her.

"Jordan." She stood, and we exchanged a double kiss. She smelled of something warm and floral and musky. She'd definitely made an effort.

"Bang on time."

"I don't do the fashionably late thing," I said, sitting. "You look nice today."

"Thank you. If I turn up here in joggers, my Aunt tells me off." She said it totally deadpan, but I couldn't help but laugh. "Okay, you can sit down, Jordan. I'm already slightly nervous, so don't make it weird."

"Nervous?" I waited for her to sit back down, then got comfortable in my seat, picking up a menu to browse. "Why nervous?"

Kamol appeared with a sparkling water for me and a small dish of something I hadn't ordered, set it down, gave Sariya an approving look that was bordering on maternal, and disappeared again. Sariya watched her go.

"Because of what we talked about last time," she replied. "When I hit on you. I feel a touch embarrassed about it now."

"There's no need to," I replied, shaking my head. "I mean... your Aunt told you what she overheard... about Daisy and me and our friends. I should be the one embarrassed."

"Well, you know I wasn't judging. I'm envious, otherwise I would never have asked you if you fancied being my friend-with-benefits." Kamol breezed past us again, cutlery in hand for one of the other tables. Sariya tilted her head slightly. "My aunt likes you. She told me you were *the kind of man who knows how to be a man*. I'm not sure what she meant, but I think that's high praise coming from Kamol."

"What does she say about men she doesn't like?"

"Nothing. She just brings them the wrong order until they leave." She took another sip of her water. "Right. Professional things first, because I want to get them out of the way." She set her glass down. "I have two commissions for you."

"Two?" I grinned, genuinely delighted. Work had dried up since the Drake piece.

She nodded and told me about the first, a friend of a friend who'd seen the pieces I'd done for the computer game and wanted something similar for his wife. A fantasy version of her, perhaps as a warrior-woman with something like a tiger by her side. Sariya named the figure, and I held my expression in place with the discipline of a man who has been underpaid for long enough to know that visible surprise is bad negotiation.

"That's for a live sitting and the completed piece?" I said.

"That's the deposit," she said pleasantly.

I recalibrated my expression again.

"They're serious collectors," she said. "They've had numerous art pieces done over the years, so they want it done properly. A proper sitting, multiple studies, the full process. They're prepared to spend the money." She paused. "The second commission is more personal."

She said it lightly, but something shifted in the air between us.

"Okay?" I prompted her to carry on, noticing her cheeks turn slightly pink.

"A portrait, maybe more than one," she replied. "Of me."

"Of you?"

She picked up the menu, which she must clearly already know by heart, and looked at it, avoiding eye contact for a moment. "Yes. I've been thinking about what I actually want. Nothing too explicit, but something sexy, sensual, partially nude, maybe." She glanced up. "Or fully nude. I'd be willing to let you guide me. You're the artist, if that makes sense?"

"It makes perfect sense," I replied slowly, unsure of where this was going and why. "What's the portrait for? Anything in particular?"

"I thought you might ask that." She met my gaze with a small, shy smile. "I want to see if they do anything for my husband. Whether I put one on the stairs, or the bedroom wall, I just want to see —" she paused, weighing the words, "— that's... if he even notices. I suppose I want to remind him that he married a woman who... wants to be looked at, and appreciated as a woman and not just as a wife." The smile went somewhere drier. "It's a test, essentially."

"And if he fails this test?"

She looked down at the dark wooden table between us. "Then I have the answer I suspected, and some very nice portraits to show for it."

Kamol arrived to take our order. Sariya ordered in Thai fluently, which earned her a short, delighted response from Kamol and a look at me as if to say, "*See? My niece is very clever.*" I unadventurously ordered Pad Thai, then Kamol took the menus and was gone again.

"So things with your husband haven't gotten any better?" I asked. "Since we last talked."

She considered the question as though she were deciding how much honesty the occasion warranted. She settled, apparently, on quite a lot. "We get on fine, as I said. Our anniversary was last month. He booked a restaurant, a very nice one, actually, I'll give him that, he researches well.

We had excellent food and a very pleasant conversation about what we'd been watching on Netflix. Then we came home, and he was tired." She traced the edge of her water glass with one finger. "So we went to sleep."

"I'm sorry," I said, and meant it.

"Don't be. I've stopped being sorry about it." She said it cleanly, without bitterness, which was somehow sadder than bitterness would have been. "I know what it is. He's just lost his libido. Permanently, it seems. Which is why I want to try some subtle things. I'm dressing nicer when I'm in the house. I'm wearing perfume, trying to watch sexy things on TV to get him in the mood. And then I want to try the portraits. And then after all that, if he's still uninterested, then I guess I have to accept it for what it is."

"And then what?" I asked.

"That's where you come in." She looked up, her tilted, dark eyes considering me, waiting for me to reject her.

The way she'd said it was casual, matter-of-fact, and yet there was undoubtedly vulnerability there. I had a sip of water.

"I didn't bring it up in the emails," she continued, "because it didn't belong in work emails, or anywhere that someone could see. But I want you to know that I haven't changed my mind. Everything I said last time, I still mean. I'm not a person who says things I don't mean, and I'm not a person who takes them back because I got embarrassed afterwards." She tilted her head. "Am I embarrassing you?"

"No," I said honestly. "I'm flattered. Seriously, Sariya. I am."

"I spent all morning practising what I was going to say," she confessed, deadpan, and then laughed when I did, a proper laugh, surprised out of her. "I'm joking. Partially." The laugh faded into something more honest. "I've just got to an age where I thought — what is the absolute worst that happens if I just go out and get some sex? What's the worst that happens if I ask you for some discreet fun? He says no, I carry on as before, masturbating rather than actually having sex, until I find the courage to go on a dating site or do something else risky."

"And if he says yes?"

She held my gaze. "Say it, and we'll find out."

My heart skipped a little, but before I could find a reply to that, the food arrived. Kamol set it down, folded her arms beneath her considerable bosom, and looked between us with the quiet satisfaction of a woman who had subtly engineered this reunion and felt no need to pretend otherwise.

"Is everything going okay?" she asked, likely meaning more than just the food.

"We're having a nice talk," I said, meaning several things.

Kamol beamed and withdrew.

"You know, things between Daisy and me," I started, taking a mouthful of the Pad Thai, "They've moved on from where we were before. We've done things with our friends, more things. Daisy might... *might*, be willing to let me help."

Sariya listened without interruption, which I appreciated.

"And if not, then I know some other men — some very hot, sexy men — who I know would jump at the chance to—" I looked around, making sure no one was within eavesdropping distance, "—have some fun with a gorgeous woman like you."

"I just wouldn't feel right with a stranger." She was quiet for a moment, then said, "Does Daisy know about me?"

"She knows about your situation and that you asked me if I might be interested in helping you out."

Sariya picked up her fork and considered that. "So you tell each other everything," she said, a statement, not a question.

"If you're going to have an open relationship of any sort," I replied, "You have to. No secrets. Which is why you should try talking to your husband first, before you do any of this stuff."

"He wouldn't understand," Sariya sighed. "But it's good advice, I appreciate that."

We ate. The food was good. The afternoon outside was uniformly grey, the windows speckled with fine raindrops, the street beyond reduced to blurred figures walking past in coats or with umbrellas. I asked Sariya what exactly she had in mind for the portraits. She set her fork down and thought about it properly, her eyes going unfocused as she pictured it.

"I want to be on a bed," she said. "Not *in* a bed, not under covers, not... cosy. I don't want cosy. I want sexy, on top of the bed, like I've just woken up, or like I'm about to go to sleep, or like I'm thinking about someone." She paused. "You know how in old paintings the women in repose always look vaguely like they're thinking about something they shouldn't be?"

"The Odalisque," I said.

"Exactly like that." She pointed at me. "That. I want that. But me. The real me, not some fantasy of me. Not an interpretation of me. Me, in my

own room, in my own body. I want my husband to look at it and remember that's the woman he married. That he used to want."

"And you want to be nude? Or if not, what are you wearing?"

Her cheeks reddened again as she considered me across the table for a moment, with a look that was entirely composed and entirely aware of what the question was doing to the tension between us. "Nude might be too much, at least for the first portrait. But I want to show skin," she replied. "I could do topless, maybe. Implied nude." She reached for her water. "I think I have a good body for my age. I want to do this now, before I'm too old to want to."

"You're hardly old. You're what? In your early thirties?"

"Thirty-seven." She tilted her head. "Do you think I look good for my age?"

"Thirty-seven is still young," I replied, then, deciding to be open with her: "And you look good, yes. You're a good-looking woman, Sariya. Your looks, your body, that's not why I'm... hesitant about your offer."

She swallowed hard, my words having a visible effect on her. She picked up her fork again, twisting noodles around it idly, deep in thought.

"So, you'll do it?" she asked. "You'll draw me?"

"I'll do it," I agreed, my cock twitching in my pants at the thought. "Just tell me when. You can come to my house, or I can come to yours, if you insist on it being a drawing of you in your bedroom."

Sariya was quiet for a moment, still turning her fork slowly between her fingers. Outside, the rain had decided to commit, sliding down the window in proper rivulets now, the grey deepening. In the warm light of the restaurant, she looked gorgeous. The clean line of her jaw, her dark, tilted eyes, the way her hair fell forward when she leaned in, a thick curtain of it, and she didn't push it back the way she had last time, but left it.

"Can I ask you something personal?" she asked.

"Well, you know that I share my wife," I chuckled. "And I know you only orgasm on your own, so I think we're past requiring permission."

She laughed again, the laugh that sounded surprised. "True. Okay." She folded her arms on the table, pushing her breasts higher in the dress as she leaned in slightly, dropping her voice not because anyone near us could hear but because it was that kind of conversation. "When you draw someone — a woman, I mean, someone you find attractive — do you get turned on?"

"I haven't drawn many nudes," I answered honestly. "Just one recently, a friend, a female neighbour. And, yes, I got turned on. It's hard not to."

She absorbed that. "And what about her? Did she get turned on, too?"

"She did," I said honestly. "And yes, it led to something. But if you're suggesting—"

"No, I'm not," she cut me off before I could complete the sentence. She held my gaze for a long moment. "I was just wondering what happens when that sort of thing occurs, that's all."

"I'll do the portraits of you," I said carefully, "if what you're telling me is true, that it's for you and your husband, something to try to wake him up and make him see what he's missing. If it's an elaborate attempt to seduce me, then stop. You don't need to. You've already made it clear what you want and that you'd be interested in exploring that with me. And I'm flattered, and if I'm honest, yes, I'm tempted. But if I have to talk to Daisy first."

"It's genuine, I promise. I want the pictures for me and for what I said." Sariya bit her lip, looking at me with those dark, lidded eyes. "You're tempted? Really?"

"Why wouldn't I be?" I sighed, gesturing at her gently over the table, letting my eyes roam over the curves of her breasts in the dark red dress. "You're fucking gorgeous."

She smiled, and we carried on eating until the conversation shifted to more neutral topics when Kamol seated a couple at the table next to us, the restaurant starting to fill a little more. When we were done, Sariya went to pay, but I talked her into letting me, then we stood, pulling on our coats when Kamol appeared at my shoulder, pushing a paper bag with something hot inside it into my hands.

"Curry puff," she smiled, "For the drive home." She looked up at me with the long, settled gaze of a woman who had been reading people across a restaurant counter for decades and no longer needed to work at it.

"I'm heading out, Auntie." Sariya kissed Kamol on the cheek, making the older woman beam happily. "I can see you want to talk to Jordan, but don't embarrass me, okay? He knows everything, so you don't need to elaborate. We had..." She looked at me, remembering the words, "A good talk."

With that, she headed out, and I turned to Kamol, who had that considering expression on her face again, the smile gone, turned to

something more serious.

"My niece deserves to be happy," she murmured softly. "I think you can help her. She said you were a good listener and a good man." She patted my arm. "Don't make a liar of her."

Then she headed back into the kitchen, leaving me standing there and alone with a curry puff and a feeling that this was going to get complicated.

But one thing I'd learned through this whole process with Daisy and the Neighbourhood Watch was that, sometimes, complicated could be fun.

PRE-UNIVERSITY PERSONAL NOTES

Daisy M Hoyland: PRIVATE

Things to say to Dr Patterson today:

1. Acknowledge what happened. Say: I know all the stuff that happened leading up to Christmas was crazy. But I don't regret it, and I hope you don't either. Keep it brief, keep it clean, don't let it fester into us both pretending it didn't happen.
2. University stays university. This is separate from everything with the Watch. That line doesn't move.
3. Suggest dinner, Jordan, me, and him, something that puts a normal social frame around it before the weirdness can ruin it.

I'm nervous but looking forward to seeing him, too. It's good that I get to speak to him face-to-face, just me and him, before the dinner, before anything else. I guess I just need to know what I'm working with.

Because the truth I haven't said out loud yet is that I've thought about Peter Patterson considerably more than I probably should. I've thought about him watching me get fucked. I thought about sucking his cock. I've wondered how many times he's wanked off over me since then.

I want him to tell me he wants to fuck me.

And I want to fuck him.

There. I said it. I want to fuck my professor. I want to know what his hands feel like on my breasts, what his dick feels like inside me. I want to know if he's as controlled in bed as he is in a seminar room, or whether something else comes out entirely when it's just him and me alone.

Whether it's a good idea is a different question.

The lamb had been in the slow cooker for hours, and the kitchen smelled amazing. I'd pulled it out at four-thirty to rest, the meat falling apart at the touch of a fork, the vegetables soft and dark in the rich stock. I'd done roasted potatoes in the oven, green beans on the side, and gravy from the cooking juices. A proper dinner, the handmade kind that made a house feel like a home.

Chapter 3

Female Intuition

I heard Daisy's key in the door at five past five. A good sign. She'd texted at half four to say she was leaving campus, which meant she hadn't had anything go catastrophically wrong with Patterson. She appeared in the kitchen doorway, still in her coat, unwinding her scarf, dropping her bag from her shoulder onto the floor. Her cheeks were pink from the cold, and her ponytail had come half-loose, little strands of blonde hair framing her face. She looked tired, but not the bad kind of tired. Just the kind that comes from a long day of hard work.

"Something smells yummy," she smiled, sniffing the air theatrically.

"Get your coat and shoes off, sit down, and I'll dish up."

"Give me five minutes." She disappeared into the hallway, and I heard the familiar sounds of her coat being hung up, boots being unzipped and kicked off, then a brief silence as she headed upstairs to change into something comfortable.

She returned minutes later, in one of my old university hoodies, lounge shorts and a pair of thick socks, hair down now. She'd washed her face and looked refreshed and considerably more relaxed. She sat down at the kitchen table, pulling her knees up, and I set a glass of red wine in front of her before she'd even thought to ask for it.

"How was your day?" I asked, not looking at her, starting to plate up.

"Fine, actually." She picked up the wine, knowing I was asking about Patterson. "You were right. Peter was very professional. Everything just felt... back to normal. Almost as if nothing had happened between us."

"I told you."

"You did." She took a sip. "But then... after, he did ask me to stay behind."

I set her plate down in front of her and sat across the table with my own, the food steaming between us. "I knew he would. What did he say?"

"We went to that coffee place around the corner from the psych building. Ortega's, the one with the good cakes."

"And?"

She speared a piece of lamb, ate it, and closed her eyes for a second in genuine appreciation. "Jordan. This is amazing."

We ate in silence for a moment, until she put her knife and fork down, and looked at me over the table, her eyes considering. She sat back slightly, wine in hand.

"It's not what I was expecting. He's had time to think. He really enjoyed watching me. In the car, at the party, me with Tyler and Paul." She paused. "But he doesn't think it should go any further than that. Not while I'm still at university, under his supervision."

"Oh." I felt a twinge of disappointment. I suspected the professor would be her next conquest. "How do you feel about that? Are you sad?"

"I don't know." She looked at her plate. "Honestly? I'm a little disappointed, I guess. Which is ridiculous, because the sensible part of me knows it's absolutely the right call. He's my supervisor. We're both already compromised. Getting any more tangled up in it while he's still marking my work and signing off on my thesis would be—"

"Messy," I offered.

"Very messy." She ate another forkful. "He said maybe when I've finished the master's, and I'm no longer his student, perhaps then. Which is —" She made a vague gesture with her fork. "I mean, it's a long way off. A lot can change between now and then."

"What does he actually want, then? Going forward?"

"Oh, he wants to stay in the loop with everything." She glanced up at me. "He wants to hear about what we do, who I have sex with, what I get up to. Maybe be involved with the Neighbourhood Watch, but from a distance. He said it's fantastic research for the whole extramarital relationships thing, that watching us has given him more material than twenty years of theoretical study, and he wants to help me make the thesis the best it can be." She paused. "He also said he'll make sure I get top marks."

There it was. "Grades for secrets."

"Essentially." She didn't look guilty about it. "I mean, we already agreed on that. It's just—"

"What?"

"It feels a bit—" She searched for the word while chewing a piece of lamb. "Cheeky. That he gets to watch and hear and get off on what I'm doing, while keeping himself at arm's length otherwise. He's not all-in. He wants the dirty fun, but not the commitment."

"Annoying." I sighed. If Patterson wasn't going to be Daisy's next lover, then who was?

"Yes, very annoying." She ate in silence for a moment. "But then again, if I can leverage him to get a distinction on my master's, it'd be very stupid not to."

I looked at her across the table, my brilliant, calculating wife, sitting in my old hoodie with a fork full of lamb and a glass of wine, calmly discussing the management of her dissertation supervisor's voyeuristic interest like it was a negotiation tactic, which it absolutely was. I'd have been proud of her if it weren't also slightly terrifying.

"If he doesn't want to have any sexy fun with you, it's his loss, you know?" I said, wondering how she really felt about it all.

"I know." She grinned. "Now stop looking at me like that and eat your dinner. It's too good to let go cold."

* * *

The dishes were done by half six. I'd cleared the table, boxed up the leftovers and stored them in the freezer, while Daisy headed to the living room with her laptop and a second glass of wine, spreading her legal files across the coffee table with the focused industry of someone who'd had three weeks off and was mildly anxious about returning to the office tomorrow. I could hear the tap-tap of keys, the rustle of papers, the humming sound of her organising herself back into the professional version of Daisy Hoyland.

My own laptop was open on the kitchen side, propped against the fruit bowl, playing Millie Grace's latest upload. DemureMillieGrace — the Trad Wife blogger I'd been following for months — had posted two new videos and a whole range of blogs over the Christmas break, and I'd decided to catch up on them. Right now, she was talking about the ritual of cooking for

your husband, standing in her small but very clean kitchen, her dark hair pinned back, her voice that particular brand of warm and deliberate that no doubt was part of her success. The other part being her good looks. She was exceptionally pretty, with dark hair and eyes, her petite body, which she occasionally 'accidentally' revealed by wearing floaty summer dresses without a bra or other mishaps, such as her buttons coming undone. I half-listened while I worked through the pots, the warm water going grey and losing its bubbles around my wrists.

I was nearly done when the doorbell rang.

I dried my hands and went to the front door to find three people on the step. The newcomer, Tom from number seventeen, was at the front, hands in the pockets of a dark wax jacket, his neat haircut slightly windswept from the cold. Behind him stood his stunningly gorgeous wife, Claudia, in the leather jacket she'd worn at the New Year's Eve party, her dark hair loose around her shoulders, cheeks flushed from the January air. Tyler and Morgan's son, Lewis, was beside her in a grey fleece, a small torch clipped to his belt.

"Sorry to disturb you," Tom said. "We saw your kitchen light on and thought we'd stop by to say hi."

"Not at all. Hi. Come in for a minute, it's freezing out there."

They stepped inside, into the warmth of the hallway. I led them back to the kitchen, where Millie Grace was still talking about the spiritual satisfaction of an ironed tablecloth, or something to that effect. I reached over to pause it.

"Leave it," Lewis said.

I looked at him. He was watching the screen with a small, unreadable expression, genuine interest in his eyes. On the laptop, Millie Grace was smiling at the camera over the rim of a teacup, wearing a pale blue top that was so tight, it showed off every detail of her petite bosom.

"You watch Millie?" he asked quietly.

"For a while now," I replied. "Do you? You don't like the kind of guy who watches Trad Wife content."

"No," he laughed. "Well, I've watched some of her videos, but I'm not into the Trad Wife thing." He watched as she picked up an iron, talking about how she never irons her own clothes, but she makes sure Mr Heart, her husband, always has perfectly pressed shirts and suits for his job.

"She's sexy," Lewis added, eyeing me for a reaction. "Isn't she?"

"I mean, yeah, but that's not why I watch her. The dynamic she talks about, the traditional roles thing, I find it interesting, given that we do a version of it ourselves, just inverted."

Lewis looked at me. "Ah, yes. The modern husband thing? Morgan mentioned it to me."

"That's right. Daisy works, and she studies. I'm at home." I nodded toward the hallway, the distant tap of Daisy's laptop audible from the living room. "I work, too. I'm a freelance artist, but I also manage all the domestic stuff, cooking, and cleaning. It works for us—" I gestured at the laptop, at Millie Grace explaining the importance of a husband always looking his best. "I'm curious about the other side of it. What it looks like from her angle. Plus, she does have some good recipes."

Lewis chuckled and nodded, considered that for a moment, the way his father considered things — unhurriedly, without filling the silence just because it was there. "I know her husband, actually. Jamie. We worked together at my previous car dealership. I was head salesman there for a couple of years before I got the manager's position at my current place." He paused. "Got to know them both pretty well. Jamie's still there. He's a nice guy."

The way he said *both* carried something, I wasn't sure what.

"And Millie?" I asked. "Is she just like she is in her videos?"

A small pause. Just long enough.

"Millie's—" He looked at her on the screen, at her composed smile and her immaculate kitchen. "She's a sweetheart. Just like she is in the videos. We were fairly close." He said it evenly, without elaborating, and didn't look at me as he said it. "They're only on the other side of town from here. I keep meaning to go back and see how he's getting on." Another pause. "And Millie, of course."

He left it there, neatly, but I could tell there was more to this story. I hoped he'd stick around the Rise a while longer, so I could find out more.

"You should introduce me sometime," I said, "The next time you're around."

Lewis looked at me then, those green eyes settled and slightly amused, but he didn't say anything. He glanced at Millie again, clearly deep in thought about something.

"Anyway, can I get you anything?" I offered. "Beer? Coffee. It's cold out there."

"We can't stop," Tom replied, stepping forward now that Lewis and I had finished chatting. He looked at the image of Millie, then back to me. "We're doing our first sweep of the cul-de-sac. Morgan asked us to check the path that runs behind the gardens. Some kids have been coming in from the country park — apparently it's a problem that crops up from time to time — and someone graffitied Russell's garage wall the other night, which he wasn't too pleased about."

"We saw that this morning," I mentioned. "I assumed it was the teenagers again."

"Always is," Tom shrugged, unbothered. "We had it where we used to live. They're just kids. If we can catch them once, it'll hopefully stop."

Daisy appeared at the kitchen doorway. She must have heard voices. She'd pulled her hair up into a loose knot and was still in my hoodie, glasses on from the reading she'd been doing. She blinked at the three of them standing in the kitchen.

"Oh! Hello." She pushed the glasses onto the top of her head. "Is everything okay?"

"We're just doing a sweep," Tom said, "Our first time. Oh, and the reason we stopped by was to let people know about the Watch meeting tomorrow. Seven o'clock at Tyler and Morgan's. They asked us to tell everyone."

"Okay, cool," Daisy nodded. She looked at Claudia, and something passed between them, a moment, like they were sizing each other up. Claudia looked immaculate in her leather and denim combo, whereas Daisy looked like she'd just got out of bed. "Are you two finding your feet on the Rise?" Daisy asked. "Are you joining the Neighbourhood Watch... fully?"

"That's the plan," Tom nodded, with a wry grin towards his wife.

"And this is your first sweep?" I asked, keeping it neutral, not entirely sure how much Lewis knew, how much Tom and Claudia had been told, or whether any of this needed to be navigated carefully. "Have you seen anything... interesting out there?"

Tom shook his head but smiled knowingly. "Quiet so far. A couple of dog walkers, a car I didn't recognise parked up near the path entrance."

"Nothing interesting," Claudia said, also with the faintest smile at the corner of her mouth that suggested she knew exactly what sometimes happened while doing these patrols.

Daisy caught it, too. She glanced at me, then back at Claudia. "Morgan's explained the Watch to you properly? And the fun things it involves?"

"She has," Claudia said simply. "I'm still... figuring it out. Maybe you can help me with some of it, like you said. We could go for a coffee sometime?"

"Definitely. Text me, and we'll arrange something." Daisy's eyes moved to Lewis, who had been quiet through this exchange, leaning against the counter, watching the three of us with that unhurried, slightly amused expression.

"I know what the Watch is," he said slowly. "You don't have to tiptoe around it with me. I know what my parents do. I've known since I was nineteen." He straightened up slightly, checked his watch, made sure the torch was still fastened at his waist. "Dad wasn't as subtle as he thought he was when I was growing up. And when I was old enough to understand what I was looking at, it wasn't hard to piece together." He looked between us both, easy and direct about it. "I don't think any less of them, of any of you who indulge in the lifestyle. If it works for you guys like it works for them — like it works for this street, apparently — then it's cool with me. It's just awkward to be around sometimes, for the obvious reason."

"Fair enough," I replied, relieved that this particular conversation was out of the way.

"So yeah, you don't need to be careful about what you say in front of me," he continued. "You're not going to shock me. I'm not going to run back and report anything to anyone." The green eyes moved briefly to Daisy, then back to me. "I grew up on this street. I know how it works. I know what joining the Watch fully tends to mean." He glanced at Tom and Claudia. "Which is part of why I introduced them to it, because I thought they'd be a good fit."

Claudia looked at him and blushed, then at Tom, who just nodded, opened his mouth as if he was going to say something, then stopped. I remembered Lewis saying that he knew Tom from school. There was something between the three of them, more than just that, but I couldn't put my finger on what it was just yet.

"Right," Daisy said, sensing the awkwardness that had suddenly filled the kitchen. "Well, that's good, that we're all open about this stuff with each other. It took me a while to figure out what was really going on here on the

Rise, so I'm glad you're moving here with your eyes wider open than mine were."

"Secrets can damage relationships." I had no idea what Lewis meant by that as he smiled at her. "You were being very tactful, for what it's worth."

"I'm a legal assistant," Daisy replied with a light shrug. "It's a professional habit."

He laughed at that, then he glanced at the counter, at my laptop, at Millie Grace still frozen mid-sentence on the screen where I'd paused it. Something crossed his face, quick and private, gone before I could name it. He looked away.

"We should get going," he said, straightening up. "Sorry for taking up your evening." His eyes moved briefly over Daisy, the hoodie, her legs bare beneath her shorts, the loose knot of hair, the glasses on her head, with the easy, appreciative directness of a man who didn't try to hide when he enjoyed what he saw. Then back to me. "Good to meet you again, Jordan."

"You too," I said. "Tell Morgan we'll see her tomorrow."

Tom raised a hand in farewell, and Claudia gave a small wave as they turned away, their breath making brief white clouds in the cold air as they stepped back out onto Far Bridge Rise. I watched the three of them fall into an easy stride up the pavement, Lewis's torch clicking on as they passed the last pool of lamplight and moved toward the darker top end of the rise.

I closed the door and headed back to the kitchen. Daisy was already padding back toward the living room, glasses back on, pulling the hoodie sleeves down over her hands. She paused in the doorway but didn't go through it.

"I'm not sure about her," she said.

I looked up from the sink, running the hot tap to refill the bowl because the water had gone cold. "Who? Claudia?"

"There's something." She leaned against the doorframe, arms folded. "I can't put my finger on it."

"You said you liked her at the party."

"I did. I do. I just—" She frowned. "I don't know. Something felt off."

I turned back to the washing up, rinsing off one of the plates, thinking about it. Daisy usually had very good instincts about people. But she'd also had a long day, her first back at university, the awkward talk with Patterson over coffee, his rejection of her, which is what it was, a rejection of sorts.

She'd come home and barely had time to decompress before three people had appeared at the door.

"Is it possible," I said carefully, "that you're a little bit jealous? Because you really don't need to be."

The silence that followed had a specific texture to it.

"No," she said, raising an eyebrow in warning.

"Because she's new on the street, and she's—"

"I said no, Jordan."

"—very good-looking, and the whole Neighbourhood Watch is going to want—"

"I heard you the first time." Daisy relaxed her eyebrows and crossed her arms defensively instead. "I'm not jealous of her."

I said nothing. Finished the washing up, setting the last couple of plates on the drying rack.

"She's beautiful," Daisy said, from the doorway. "Fine. Obviously, she is. But that's not—" She stopped. I heard her exhale. "Maybe it's just Patterson, getting back into university, work tomorrow. Today was weird, and I haven't fully processed it yet, and then they showed up, and I had to be charming and normal when I'm actually—"

"Tired," I offered.

"Yes." A pause. "Tired."

I dried my hands and turned around. She was still leaning in the doorway, arms folded, glasses hanging on the tip of her nose, her expression somewhere between irritated and self-aware enough to know she was being slightly unreasonable and not entirely ready to admit it.

"Lewis is kind of hot, though." She found a certain face, the forced straight face, when she's trying to suppress a smile.

I laughed before I could stop myself. "Ah. There she is."

"Who?"

"The real Daisy."

She tried to hold the poker face for a moment longer, but couldn't quite manage it. "I'm just saying. Objectively, he is." She unfolded her arms. "And he's slept with Claudia. I'd put money on it."

"What makes you say that?"

"Because of the way he is around her. The way he looks at her." She said it as if it were obvious, which, to her, it clearly was. "Not like he wants her, like he's already had her, and he's being careful not to show it too much

in front of anyone. And Tom knows. That's why they're here, on this street, joining the Watch. Tom found out, and instead of being angry about it, something clicked for him. Now he wants to share her." She paused. "But Claudia's not sure that's what she wants. Apart from the fact that she wants Lewis. You could see it, surely?"

"I got none of that." I stared at her. "But you got all of that from twenty minutes in the kitchen?"

"I got all of that from watching her eyes," Daisy said simply. "It's all in the eyes, Jordan. Female intuition. It's very reliable."

She pushed off the doorframe and came back into the kitchen, and as she crossed to me, she reached down and pulled the hoodie up over her head in one easy movement, dropping it on the kitchen chair. Underneath it, she was bare, no bra, her light pink nipples erect, her pert tits bouncing slightly as she stepped closer.

"What are you doing?" It was my turn to raise an eyebrow as she approached.

"I see how you look at Claudia," she murmured, as if that explained everything, which it did. She put both hands on my chest and tipped her face up, and I kissed her because she didn't give me any other option. Her mouth was warm and tasted of red wine. "I don't mind you looking at other women, as long as you know you're mine, Jordan Hoyland. My modern husband."

"Yours," I confirmed as her hands undid my zipper and found the way inside, grabbing my cock and squeezing firmly. "All yours."

"Good," she said against my lips. "Now, fuck me."

She wriggled out of her shorts and panties, now naked in our kitchen.

"I haven't finished—"

"Fuck me, Jordan."

"The curtains are open, and you know they're on patrol." Daisy yanked my jeans down, stroking my cock, which was growing harder by the second. "You don't want them to see, do you?"

She pulled away from the kiss, her gorgeous brown eyes finding mine. "Do you? We could be the first members of the Watch to give them a show."

I stared at her until she giggled.

"I'm joking. Come on. Bedroom. Now."

She took my hand, and I let myself be pulled towards the stairs, reaching back to click off the kitchen light as we went. Behind us, on the counter, Millie Grace was still frozen on the laptop screen, mid-sentence, teacup in hand, and I had no idea right then how everything was about to change, all because of her.

ON KEEPING YOUR HUSBAND HAPPY

Home & Heart

A blog by @DemureMillieGrace

I don't often write about what happens in the bedroom. It isn't my style, and I think there's a particular grace in keeping some things private, a closed bedroom door, a drawn curtain, certain things that belong only to the two of you. Some intimacies are cheapened by being spoken aloud.

But I've been thinking about this lately, and I think it needs saying.

An unsatisfied husband is a distracted one. When a wife neglects that part of her marriage, and I understand life is busy, I understand tiredness, I understand the weight of a long day that leaves you wanting nothing more than sleep, she leaves a door open that she may not have intended to. Men are visual creatures. Men are physical. Their eyes move naturally toward where they feel desired, and if that place stops being home, they will find somewhere else to rest them. I don't say this to frighten you. I say it because I believe in being honest about how men are made.

It is a wife's duty — and I use that word deliberately, because I believe in duty — to love her husband with her whole self. Mind, heart, soul, and body. All four. Not three. To come to him not merely as a companion or a housemate or the mother of his children, but as a woman who still wants him. Who lets him know she wants him. Who doesn't make him feel that desire itself is an inconvenience.

There is something quietly powerful about a wife who takes her husband to bed with intention. Who undresses without apology. Who reminds him, with her body, that he is wanted and chosen and hers. That power is not nothing. It is, I'd argue, one of the most important tools a wife has, and one of the most neglected.

Keep him satisfied, and you keep him. It really is that simple.

But — and this is perhaps a newer thought for me, one I'm still turning over — he owes her the same. Every single bit of it. Her desire matters as

much as his. Her satisfaction is not a footnote. A wife who tends to her husband so carefully deserves a man who tends to her in return, who notices when she is restless, who doesn't mistake her patience for contentment.

A marriage is not a performance for one.

Yours, in love and pleasure,

Millie Grace

Chapter 4

So, Claudia

The next day passed without incident. Daisy left for work at half eight, her first day back at the solicitor's office since the New Year break, looking much more the part than the woman who'd been padding around the kitchen in my hoodie the previous evening. Grey trousers, a white blouse under her long black jacket, hair up, the small gold earrings and glasses she wore when she wanted to look professional. She kissed me at the door with the brisk efficiency of someone who had places to be and didn't want to be late on her first day back, and then she was gone, her heels clicking down the path to the car.

I did the shopping. I put a second load of washing on. I spent an hour in the studio working on some of my own characters, keeping myself busy while I didn't have any commission to work on. I had Sariya's offer, but I'd forgotten to talk to Daisy about it last night. The idea certainly appealed—of course it did, she was beautiful—and I could use the work, but I wasn't going to agree to it without running past my wife.

* * *

By six o'clock, the house was clean, and there was a chicken in the oven. I was upstairs pulling a clean shirt from the wardrobe when I heard Daisy's key in the door and her call out that she was home.

"I'm upstairs. Getting ready," I shouted back.

She appeared in the bedroom doorway, still in her work clothes, cheeks pink from the cold, satchel dropping from her shoulder onto the chair. She

looked at me buttoning my shirt, and then at the wardrobe behind me.

"What time do we need to leave?"

"Seven. We've got an hour."

"Fine." She reached back and pulled the pins from her hair, shaking it loose, running her fingers through it with the particular relief of someone who'd had it up since eight in the morning. "How was your day?"

"Quiet. I did the shopping. Tidied up. Prepped my studio for new work. Chicken's in the oven, it'll be ready when we get back." I paused. "How was yours?"

"Long." She undid the buttons on her blouse. "And it felt longer because I've had three weeks off and my brain had to remember how to be a legal assistant again." The blouse came off, and she dropped it over the chair. "But not too bad. Just a lot of catching up and three weeks of correspondence to wade through."

She was just in her bra now — cream, with a narrow band of lace at the top — and her grey work trousers, and she moved to the mirror to take her earrings out with the unselfconscious ease of a woman entirely comfortable in her own bedroom. I watched her in the reflection. She was slim and beautiful, and the faint light from the bedside lamp caught the curve of her waist, the soft line of the edge of her breast.

"Did you hear from Patterson at all today?" I asked. "After yesterday's coffee?"

"One email." She set the earrings on the dresser. "But all professional. Dissertation feedback, a reading list for the new module, a note about the spring conference schedule." She unzipped her trousers and stepped out of them, laying them over the chair. Now she was in just the cream bra and matching panties, her bare feet on the carpet, already pulling open her side of the wardrobe. "No mention of anything else. Which is exactly what I expected from him in writing." She pulled out a dark green wrap dress, held it against herself in the mirror, considered it, then put it back. Tried a burgundy blouse and black trousers. Put that back as well. "What are other people wearing tonight?"

"It's only a neighbourhood watch meeting, not a proper party. I'm just wearing a shirt and trousers, nothing fancy."

She made a small sound of acknowledgement and reached for a soft grey jumper dress that I hadn't seen in a while — fitted, just above the knee. She stepped into it, tightened the fitted belt to accentuate her waist, then

studied herself in the mirror with the quick, unsentimental assessment she always applied.

"That works," I said.

"Mmm." She found her ankle boots and sat on the edge of the bed to pull them on. Then she looked up at me. "You said you've got some new work. A new commission?"

"Kind of. I went to see Sarah—Sariya, yesterday." I tucked my shirt into my trousers, made sure I was presentable in the mirror. "I meant to talk to you about it last night, but forgot when Tom and Claudia came over. Anyway, one of her clients wants a portrait done. And so does she. One of herself."

Daisy pursed her lips, one knee still drawn up, boot half-buckled. "A portrait." She looked up. "What kind of portrait?"

"She wants it for her husband. We haven't gone too deeply into it, but she's thinking—" I chose the word carefully "—something tasteful. Artistic."

Daisy looked at me for a moment, then finished buckling her boot.

"She wants you to draw her naked," she surmised.

"Possibly. I mean, it's for husband so—"

"Jordan. She wants you to draw her naked." She said it without accusation, just with the flat precision of someone who had read the situation correctly and had no interest in explanations. She stood, smoothing the dress down over her thighs. "Do you want to do it?"

"It's a legitimate commission," I replied. "It's not like Kendall."

"That's not what I asked."

I looked at my wife in her grey dress and her ankle boots, her golden hair loose around her shoulders, her arms folded beneath her breasts.

"Yes," I said. "I want to. I need the work."

She held my gaze for a moment, then reached for her perfume on the dresser, touched it to her wrist and the side of her neck with two unhurried movements.

"Then take the commission," she smiled. "But if it goes further than a painting, I want to know everything." She picked up her bag and checked its contents, then looked up at me. "Everything, Jordan. No surprises."

"It's a painting," I assured her. "But... if anything did change regarding that, then sure. No surprises."

"Good." She looked at herself one last time in the mirror, tucked a strand of hair behind her ear, and turned for the door. "Now come on. Let's go. I'd rather be early than late."

* * *

Tyler and Morgan's living room could hold twelve people comfortably and fourteen at a push. Tonight there were over twenty, which meant the dining chairs had been brought through, the footstool pressed into service, and Simon — who always arrived early and always somehow ended up with the least comfortable seat — was perched on the arm of the sofa with a bottle of beer, looking entirely unbothered by this arrangement, as he was by most things.

I knew the room well enough by now to read it at a glance.

Tyler and Morgan were here, of course, and Tom and Claudia, the newcomers. Eleanor and Geoffrey were on the two-seater by the radiator, both in their sixties, both silver-haired, both with the quietly contented air of people who had long since resolved every question the lifestyle had ever posed them and now simply enjoyed the social side of it. Margaret and Robert were beside them, Robert already on his second beer, Margaret in a burgundy blouse that suited her. Emma and James on the dining chairs, Emma with her hand on James's knee, both of them in their early thirties, both of them watching Claudia with the interested assessment of people who've decided they like the look of the new arrival. Jake was on the sofa, Alex on the footstool beside him, both of them also watching Claudia, but with considerably less subtlety.

Frank and Linda were standing near the kitchen doorway. Frank with his arms folded, a beer in one hand, his broad frame filling the space the way it always did. Linda beside him, elegant as ever in a dark green wrap dress, her silver-blond hair up. Kendall was perched on the wide windowsill, her dark hair loose, in jeans and a rust-coloured top, one knee drawn up, a glass of wine balanced on it.

Russell, Charlotte and Kelly were on the sofa beside Jake. And beside Kelly, perched on the arm, close enough that their shoulders touched, was Kelvin.

I'd known he'd be here. Daisy had known too. We hadn't discussed it, which meant we'd both decided, independently, that there was nothing

useful to say about it beforehand. He was her mother's ex-lover, the man whom Daisy had once caught in their bedroom at home, a memory that had stuck with her for years. A compact, well-built man in his early fifties, dark-skinned, close-cropped grey at his temples, Kelvin had a face that must have been handsome when young and even now, probably got women turning their heads. He was talking to Jake about something, relaxed, a glass of red wine easy in his hand, and seemed at ease with the group, settling in quickly since his introduction before Christmas. The only couple that weren't here tonight were Paul and Corinne, away on some work commitment, a team-building exercise or some such thing.

Daisy was beside me on the dining chair I'd pulled close to hers, her own wine glass held in both hands, her posture perfectly neutral. She hadn't looked at Kelvin once since we'd arrived. I hadn't looked at her looking at him. The time would come when the two of them should probably talk, but not yet.

Tom and Claudia were on the sofa opposite, newly arrived, Tom in a dark shirt, composed, his eyes moving around the room, taking it all in. Claudia was beside him in a deep red dress that had absolutely silenced Jake and Alex the moment she'd walked through Morgan's front door, her dark hair down, that pale skin warm in the lamplight. She crossed her legs, accepted a glass of wine from Morgan, and settled into the room, looking more relaxed than I'd have expected. Perhaps she was just used to being looked at. Women as sexy as her sometimes were.

She looked across at me once, briefly. I looked back. She smiled and looked away.

Movement in the corner of my eye made me turn, and I saw Kendall looking at me, as if registering that brief exchange between Claudia and me. She said nothing, just took a sip of her wine, then turned to Morgan as she called the room to order.

"Right," her step-mother began, "Let's get the business done first, then we can relax." She smiled at Tom and Claudia. "Welcome, properly, to both of you. We'll come back to you in a minute." She looked around the room. "Patrol rotas first. Frank's drawn up a new schedule—"

Frank produced a printed sheet, which went around the room. The next twenty minutes were procedural, patrol times, the graffiti on Russell's wall, the country park path access issue, and a brief discussion about the couple who were moving out, not members of the Watch. Eleanor asked a practical

question about torch batteries. Margaret reported that the motion-sensitive light at the top of the rise needed a new bulb. Tyler had already ordered one. This was the watch as it actually functioned most of the time: a group of neighbours managing a shared street, nothing remarkable.

Then Morgan set her wine glass down and looked at Tom and Claudia.

"Now then," she said. "Let's discuss you two."

The room shifted. Not dramatically, just a slight reorientation of attention, all heads turning to the new couple.

"We want to welcome you properly," Morgan smiled. "But before we do that, there are some things we'd like to know about you. Not because we're suspicious, but because we've learned that it helps. Knowing who people are, what they want, why they're here. It keeps things clean." She glanced at Tom. "In our experience, the husbands usually do the talking at this point. But I suspect with you two it might be the other way around."

Tom smiled at that, a genuine, undefended smile. "It might be," he agreed, and looked at Claudia.

Claudia looked around the room, unhurried, taking her time. She looked like she'd rehearsed her lines.

"We're here because we want to be part of the local community," she started, "It helps to be on good terms with your neighbours, and we're keen to help out where needed." She paused. "And then, talking about the other side of the Watch... We had an experience last year that made us both realise we wanted to explore this properly."

"What kind of experience?" Morgan asked.

A brief silence. Tom looked at his wine glass. Claudia looked at the room.

"A threesome," she said simply. "With Tom's friend, Lewis. You all know him."

I looked around. Lewis wasn't here tonight. Perhaps he felt awkward with his parents present.

"It was good. Better than good," Claudia continued, her striking eyes gazing around the room. "It wasn't planned. It was just a drunken thing that happened after a night out. But after... we talked about it and decided we'd like to do it again. And other things, too." She glanced at her husband. "Tom especially."

"I was wary," Tom continued. "I didn't want to screw our marriage up. But then, when I came here, Lewis had told me a little about the goings-on,

and I learned more. I thought it would be good to try this with people who knew what they were doing. That could help us into the... the lifestyle properly. And give us good advice along the way."

Daisy nodded, as if happy to take on that role for Claudia, even though I knew she wasn't. Not entirely.

"I'd like to say something," Kelly said, from the sofa. Her voice was measured, and she was looking at Daisy rather than Claudia when she said it. "Since we're being transparent." She paused. "When Daisy and Jordan first came to the Rise, we weren't entirely sure of their intentions. We knew Daisy was doing a university dissertation on non-monogamous communities. And we weren't certain whether this was research or whether it was a genuine interest."

"It was a bit of both," Daisy admitted, and the room broke out into a gentle laugh. "But I think we proved ourselves eventually."

"You did," Kelly agreed. "I'm not saying it to make you feel bad. I'm saying it because Tom and Claudia should know that we're careful about who we trust. And that once we do trust you," she looked back at the new couple, "we expect similar trust in return. Whatever happens on the Rise, stays on the Rise, okay?"

A beat of silence.

"Understood," Tom said.

Daisy took a sip of her wine and said nothing. I put my hand briefly on her knee. She didn't acknowledge it, but she didn't move away either.

"Right," Morgan said, smoothly taking the room back. "And is there anything you'd like to ask, before I move on?"

Tom glanced at his wife, then back to the black woman in the middle of the room. "I'm told there's sometimes a sort of... initiation... kind of thing."

"Oh, yes," Morgan nodded, smiling sweetly. "We'd love to have you show your... commitment to us. That you're serious about joining our community properly."

"Does this convince you?" Claudia slipped her phone from her pocket, scrolling through something, then stood and looked around the room. "It feels... weird, showing this to a stranger, but—"

She continued to turn her head, her eyes settling on me. She passed me the phone, her cheeks turning pink the moment her fingers reluctantly let go of it.

I looked at the screen.

Claudia was in what appeared to be a hotel bathroom, the light warm and gold, her dark hair loose and damp around her shoulders. She was completely naked, one hand resting lightly on the edge of the sink, looking directly at the camera with an expression of such composed, uncomplicated confidence that it was almost disorienting. She was extraordinary, her breasts were full, not too large, but more than a handful and perfectly shaped. Her pussy was totally bald, her slit just visible between her toned, pressed-together thighs.

"Wow," was all I managed to say. It didn't feel right to stare at her naked body with everyone watching, so I passed the phone to Daisy.

She looked at the screen. Her expression was unreadable for a moment. Then she handed the phone to Tom with a small, genuine smile.

"She's beautiful," Daisy said simply. "You're a lucky man."

"I know," Tom blushed, and I could tell immediately that he was horny as hell from his wife showing her nudes to his neighbour. But rather than give the phone back to his wife, he passed it to Frank, who whistled upon seeing the picture, then passed it to Tyler without comment.

The phone moved around the room. Jake looked at the screen and said, "Jesus," under his breath, which made Alex crane his neck immediately. The room was quiet for a moment until, eventually, Kelvin was the last man to enjoy the sight of the stunning naked woman sitting close by. He handed it back to her with a wide smile.

"So, does that pass the test?" Claudia said to Morgan.

"I think you've certainly got everyone in the room interested," Morgan replied, "If they weren't already. And I don't think there's a man in this room who wasn't."

Another quiet laugh rippled around the room. Frank reached behind the sofa and produced a familiar slim printed booklet, which he set on the coffee table in front of Tom. I recognised it immediately, the same plain cover, the same discreet typed title. *The Husband's Guide to Wife Sharing*.

Tom looked down at it, then up at Frank.

"Read it," Frank said. "It'll answer a lot of your questions." He looked at Tom steadily. "And for the questions that it doesn't — and there will be some — you know where I am. Or Tyler. Or Paul, Russell, even Jordan."

Tom picked up the booklet and turned it over in his hands. I watched his face as he read the back cover, the slight shift in his expression as he

wondered what the hell he was holding. I remembered exactly how that felt.

The meeting broke into smaller conversations after that, the formal part of the evening dissolving into the social part, which was how it seemed to always go. Morgan refilled some glasses and handed them around. Tyler put some music on low. The dining chairs got pushed back, and people moved around, reconfiguring into the looser clusters of a casual get-together rather than a meeting.

I ended up standing near the fireplace with a fresh beer, watching the room rearrange itself. Jake and Alex had migrated immediately to Claudia's end of the sofa, Jake already leaning in with the focused attention of a man who has decided this is where his evening is going. Alex was doing the thing he always did: being slightly funnier and slightly more self-deprecating than his younger brother. Claudia was responding to both of them with the gracious, slightly amused attention of a woman used to this, neither encouraging nor discouraging it, just letting it happen, all while her husband watched with eager eyes.

Daisy was watching them from across the room with an expression of polite interest that didn't reach her eyes.

"I don't think your wife approves of Claudia coming along and stealing her thunder," said a voice beside me.

I turned. Kelly had materialised at my elbow, her own glass of wine in hand, her eyes also on the far end of the sofa. She was in a dark blue dress, enough buttons undone to show off her voluptuous cleavage, and close enough that I could smell her perfume, warm and smoky.

"She's just sizing things up," I shrugged. "Out of all the men here, Jake and Alex are probably the most predictable. Claudia's the new girl, of course she's going to get the men talking to her."

"Oh, absolutely." Kelly took a sip of her wine, not looking at me, twisting a lock of her long auburn hair between her fingers. "Jealousy is a tricky thing to navigate at the best of times, and being in the lifestyle, it's one of the emotions you need a good grip on the most."

"She's not jealous." I shook my head. "Daisy is good at handling things."

"That's good." Kelly leaned in close so she could talk quietly into my ear. "I didn't know about Kelvin and Diane—that's Daisy's mother's name, right?—until he told me afterwards. I hope his sudden appearance at the Christmas party didn't cause any issues."

I looked at her. Kelly was a striking woman, not in the 'hot girl' way of Claudia, not in the 'girl next door' way of Daisy, but in the way of someone whose attractiveness hit you when she was up close. She had a presence about her, a sexiness that was hard to deny when she was right in front of you.

"It was a bit of a shock at first," I replied, watching as Daisy finally tore her eyes away from Claudia and the posse of men vying for her attention, walking over to talk to Kendall and Charlotte. The two women were laughing at some joke or other while helping themselves to the sandwiches and nibbles that Morgan had just fetched from the kitchen. "Especially when we were having her parents over for Christmas dinner just a few days later, and Kelvin had told Diane everything."

"He mentioned that." The corner of her mouth moved, disapproval. "I told him off for breaking our confidentiality rules, but he told me about his... situation with Diane, so he expected her to understand. He only said something out of concern. He didn't know much about the Rise at that point. Now that he knows we're a good bunch of people and that we're not in the business of exploiting anyone, he's cool with it. He's even told Diane since then that he'll take care of her, make sure she's okay."

"That's my job," I replied slowly. "But I appreciate the thought."

She looked at me for a moment longer than was strictly neutral, then turned back to the room. I turned back to the room also. We stood in companionable, slightly charged silence for a moment.

"Has anyone invited you to the club next week?" she asked, conversationally.

I kept my expression easy. "The club? What club?"

"Euphoria?" Kelly's eyes scanned my face, then seeing no recognition, she put her hand on my shoulder and guided me to a quieter corner of the room. I took one last look at Daisy, she seemed fine now, deep in conversation with Charlotte and Kendall. "Frank was supposed to mention it to you, but I think it slipped his mind." We both looked at our burly neighbour. It was his turn to sit next to Claudia now.

"Euphoria is a sex club. The best for miles around. We try to go as a group two or three times a year. It's a private members' venue, very discreet, not too expensive." She glanced at me. "I'm going. Tyler, Morgan, Frank, Linda, Russell and Charlotte."

"Sounds good," I replied. A sex club? That was a big step, but a logical one. It certainly beat dogging again. "I'll have to talk to Daisy about it."

"I think Daisy will enjoy it," Kelly replied. She said it simply, but a tilted grin on her mouth that I could only describe as dirty. "There's plenty of hot couples there to play with. Some experienced, some not so much. You can do as much or as little as you want. There's no pressure."

"I'll mention it to her. See what she thinks."

"Please do. As I mentioned, I'll be there. It would be nice to have your... company."

She held my gaze for a half second more, then moved away into the room, drifting back toward Kelvin with the easy, unhurried movement of a woman entirely comfortable in her own orbit.

I watched her go, then looked across the room to find Daisy already looking at me. She raised an eyebrow, the smallest possible query.

I gave the smallest possible shrug in return and mouthed, *I'll tell you later*.

She held my gaze for a moment, then her attention moved to Kelvin — one quick, involuntary glance, there and gone. She looked back at her wine glass, noticed it needed refilling, and headed into the kitchen for a top-up.

I was alone for the first time all evening, standing by a bookcase in the corner of the room, but not for long. I was looking at nothing in particular, half-watching the room, when I realised Claudia was beside me.

I hadn't seen her extract herself from the throng of admirers that had been by her side all night. One moment she was at the far end of the sofa with all the men competing for her attention, and the next she was simply here, close enough to talk quietly, her wine glass held in both hands, looking at the bookshelf as if she'd come over to examine it.

"I don't think we've met properly. I've been trying to get away from them to talk to you," she said, nodding subtly toward Jake and Alex. "I hope you didn't think I was ignoring you or anything."

"Not at all," I reassured her. "It's fine. You're very popular."

She smiled at that, a small, private smile, and was quiet for a moment. I waited. There was something deliberate about the way she'd positioned herself here, and I was curious enough to let it unfold at her pace.

"Can I ask you something?" She stuck out a lip and blew, trying to push a lock of stray hair out of her eyes—a cute gesture.

"Go ahead."

She looked down at her wine glass, her pale cheeks turning a light pink. "When I passed you my phone earlier." She paused. "Did you notice that I passed it to you first? Before anyone else?"

I looked at her. Why was my heart beating a little faster? "I did. It was a beautiful photo. You got all the guys rather excited."

"What about you? Did you—" She stopped, and for the first time, the composure cracked slightly, and she had to clear her throat, the blush now obvious on her chest and neck as well as her face. It was startling on her, the embarrassment, she seemed so confident up to this point. "Did you enjoy what you saw?"

I looked at her directly. "You know I did."

She exhaled, then giggled, nodding, as if she were relieved at my answer. Did she not know how stunning she was? "Good," she said quietly. "I'm glad."

Another silence. Around us, the party continued, oblivious. No one seemed to be looking our way. Frank's laugh carried from the sofa. Someone had turned the music up marginally.

"Tom and I have been talking," Claudia said, her voice lower now, careful. "About who on the street we might—" She stopped, choosing her words again. "Who we'd like to get to know better." She glanced at me sideways. "Your name came up."

I kept my expression neutral. "Just mine?"

A fractional pause. "Mostly yours." She looked back at the bookshelf. "We're new to all of this, despite what I said earlier. The threesome was one thing. It just happened. Doing something deliberate, planning it. All of this—" She gestured vaguely at Morgan's living room, at the assembled Watch. "This is different. Tom would watch me with anyone, but I kind of want to do this with someone who isn't too far ahead of us. Someone who's still finding their feet in it, the same as we are. Does that make sense?"

"It makes sense," I replied, my pulse kicking in my temple so hard I was worried she'd notice it.

She finally looked at me properly, those gorgeous green eyes steady now, the embarrassment resolved into something more direct. "We just don't know how to start something like that. How to make it happen without it being—"

"Awkward?"

"Awkward," she agreed. "Or presumptuous."

"I'd have to talk to Daisy." I looked around for my wife but couldn't see her at the moment.

She looked at me for a moment, and then said, quietly but clearly: "Not yet."

I blinked. "Sorry?"

"Don't talk to Daisy yet." She said it gently, without urgency. "I'm not asking you to do anything tonight, or next week, or even soon. I'm just—" She turned her wine glass slowly in her hands. "I just wanted you to know that I'm interested. Think about it for a while, and then, when I'm ready, I'll come to you. And then you can talk to Daisy." A small pause. "Is that strange?"

"A little," I admitted.

She laughed, very quietly. "I know. I'm sorry. I just — I need to do things in a particular order, or I lose my nerve entirely." She looked at me with that directness again. "So just keep it in your head. For now. Can you do that?"

"I can do that," I nodded.

She held my gaze for a moment longer, her eyes looking into mine, her lips curled into a pleased smile, then looked past my shoulder, and her expression shifted — smoothly, naturally, expertly — into the pleasant, social smile of a woman simply making conversation at a party.

I turned. Daisy was crossing the room toward us, freshly topped-up wine in hand, her eyes moving between Claudia and me with that quick, accurate intelligence of hers that missed very little.

"Am I interrupting?" she said. Lightly, no edge in it.

"Not at all," Claudia replied, all friendliness. "I was just telling Jordan that Tom and I are really glad we came tonight. It's been lovely." She touched Daisy briefly on the arm. "I'll talk to you in a moment. My husband looks a little lost. I really would like to learn more from someone who's on my wavelength, like you."

"You'd better go save him before Morgan eats him alive," Daisy nodded.

Claudia smiled, and then she excused herself, drifting away from us towards Tom, who was sitting on his down by the window.

Daisy watched her go, then turned to me with a raised eyebrow. "Getting to know the new girl, huh?"

"She seems sweet," I shrugged. "I think they like us. You should definitely talk to her, take her under your wing."

"I don't think she needs any help from me." Daisy glanced back over at Claudia. She was with Tom now, but Jake and Alex had once again got her engaged in flirty conversation, and her husband was, once more, simply a bystander.

* * *

We left just after ten, one of the first couples to go, Daisy citing an early start at the solicitor's office, which was true and not an excuse. There were the usual handshakes and kisses at the door, Kelly's and Claudia's both lingering longer than they probably should have. Tom shook my hand with the Guide tucked under his arm. Claudia kissed Daisy on both cheeks and said something quietly that made Daisy smile, whether it was a real one or a forced one, I wasn't sure.

The cold hit us as we stepped out onto the rise, sharp and clean after the warmth of Morgan's house. Our breath clouded between us as we walked down the pavement toward home, the fairy lights still strung between the lampposts from the New Year, swaying slightly in the light wind.

We walked in silence for a moment. Daisy had her hands in her coat pockets, her chin tucked into her scarf, looking straight ahead.

"Kelly has invited us to a sex club," I said. "Euphoria, or something, it's called. There's a bunch of them going. Something they do a few times a year."

"Morgan mentioned it to me, too." Daisy grabbed my hand—her fingers were cold—and squeezed it. "I want to go."

"Good. Me too. She said there's no pressure to do anything, so we can just scout it out, if we don't want to... you know."

"I know." Another silence as we rounded the corner of the cul-de-sac towards home. "Kelly was flirting with you. I think she might have designs on my husband."

"Even though she's with Kelvin?" I frowned at her, as if I hadn't noticed any flirting at all.

"Mmmhmm." She glanced at me sideways, no accusations, just curiosity. "So, do you like her?"

"She's attractive," I said honestly. "I mean... they all are. Charlotte, Corinne, even the oldies, Margaret and Eleanor."

Daisy just stared at me.

“All right, all right.” I laughed. “Just because they’re attractive doesn’t mean I want to fuck her. The same goes for Sariya.”

Daisy considered that. “If you say so,” she laughed back. “Claudia told me she was glad I was on the street. That I made it easier for her, knowing there was another woman here who’s fairly new to it all. She wants to take me for a coffee when I have a free afternoon.”

“Kelly said something,” I mentioned as we approached the drive of our house. “She thought you might be jealous that Claudia is getting all the attention now.”

She was quiet for a moment, the keys to our front door in her hand. “I wouldn’t call it jealousy.” Another pause. “But Jake and Alex didn’t look at me once all evening. Or Frank. Or Tyler.”

“They’re idiots.”

“They’re not idiots. She’s gorgeous.” She said it without rancour. “You saw the nude photo. Her body is perfect. Her hair, her face. She’s got it all. Every man in that room wants her.”

“Not every man,” I corrected her.

She looked at me.

“I was watching you all night,” I said. “She’s a good-looking woman, but you’re my dream girl.”

“Urgh, stop.” Daisy giggled, the keys rattling in the door as she unlocked it and pushed it open. “When she came over to you, what did she say? Don’t lie to me again and tell me she was just making pleasantries. She was blushing and giggling. Women like Claudia don’t blush and giggle at nothing.”

“She told me she showed her nude photo to me first because they’re interested.” I paused, wondering how best to say this without causing Daisy’s jealousy to flare up. “She asked me not to tell you just yet. I think she’s working out how she feels about it all before they actually do anything.”

“I see.” She held my gaze for a moment, searching it, then stepped inside. The house was warm, we’d left the heating on so it didn’t get too cold while we were out. The smell of the chicken waiting for us in the kitchen made my mouth water.

“I think you’re becoming more popular than me on the Rise,” she said quietly, then grinned. “I’m going to have to raise my game.”

I hung my coat up and followed her through to the kitchen, where she was already lifting the lid on the slow chicken, the steam rising in a fragrant cloud. She replaced it, satisfied, and turned to lean against the counter with her arms folded and that particular expression on her face, the one I'd learned to recognise over the last few months as the one she wore when she was making plans.

"What does raising your game look like?" I asked carefully.

She looked at me for a moment, her brown eyes bright and slightly dangerous. "I want to walk into that sex club and make every man there forget that Claudia exists. I want—"

She stopped herself. The kitchen was very quiet for a moment, just the low hum of the cooker and the distant tick of the hallway clock.

"You want what?" I said softly.

She looked at me, and whatever she'd been about to say, she changed course. "I want everyone there to look at me the way they looked at that photograph tonight," she said instead. "That's all."

It wasn't all. I knew it wasn't all. But I also knew better than to push it, so I pulled two plates from the cupboard and started to dish up while Daisy poured two glasses of juice to go with it. Then we sat down to our late chicken supper like any ordinary married couple at the end of an ordinary evening.

Except that we weren't. And it hadn't been. And whatever was coming next, Euphoria, Sariya, the slow and hesitant proposition from Claudia, none of it was ordinary, and we both knew it.

She raised her glass across the table. "To raising our game," she said.

I touched my glass to hers. "To raising our game."

She smiled, and we ate.

PERSONAL NOTES FROM MY 'HOTWIFE DIARY'

So.

Claudia.

I'm going to write this down because if I say it out loud, Jordan will give me that look, the one that means *you're better than this, Daisy*, and I don't want to hear that right now.

Every man on that street looked at her tonight like she'd invented the concept of being female. Frank. Tyler. Jake and Alex, obviously, they're male sluts, so they don't count, but still. Even Robert, who is about seventy and should know better. And Jordan... Jordan tried, bless him, he really tried not to, but I saw him. He might as well have drooled, it was that obvious.

And I sat there and smiled, and I was charming, and I was *fine*, and inside I was absolutely furious.

Not at her. She hasn't done anything wrong. She's just... bad timing. I was just getting comfortable with this new version of myself. I was just finding my place in this world. And then she arrives, and now it's all about fucking Claudia.

But here's the thing. Here's what I need to remember.

I am not my mother. I need to write that in capital letters and underline it. I AM NOT MY MOTHER. This is not me losing myself. This is not me chasing men because I need them to fill something empty. Jordan and I know exactly what we're doing and why, and that doesn't change because some gorgeous woman moved in across the road.

What it does mean is that I'm not going to sit quietly and become the girl who used to be interesting before Claudia arrived.

I am going to walk into that sex club, and I am going to remind every man from the Watch that comes with us exactly who Daisy Hoyland is.

Watch me.

— *Racy Daisy*

Chapter 5

Nothing, If Not Professional

I'd texted Sariya the morning after the watch meeting, once Daisy had left for work and I had the house to myself and could think clearly. I told her I'd spoken to Daisy, that she was fine with the commission, and I was happy to take it on. I'd assumed Sariya would come to me — the studio was set up, the light was good, it was my usual way of working. Instead, she'd replied within minutes, asking if there was any chance I could come to her.

My husband knows everything, she'd texted. I found my courage and told him last night. About my friend's husband, about you, about what I want to try to liven things up. I expected him to be hurt and angry, but he's more open to it than I expected. He knew I'd cheated. He's not a fool. And, as for the painting, he thinks it might help us. Would you mind coming here for the first sitting? If it's not possible, then fair enough, but it would mean a lot to both of us.

I'd reread that message a couple of times and mulled it over for a while before replying. The detail about telling her husband everything — that had taken nerve. Eventually, I replied and told her I'd come over Thursday afternoon if they were free, gave her my standard rate for a commissioned portrait, and she replied with her address and a single kiss emoji, which I chose not to overinterpret.

What I had not expected, as I drove over on Thursday with the travel easel in the boot and the canvas board on the back seat, was to walk in and find him there.

* * *

Hanbury Street was quiet in the early afternoon, residents' cars parked along one side, a few planes overhead cutting white lines into an otherwise clear sky for January. I pulled up outside the house, checked the address against my phone, and sat there for a moment. I went through what she'd told me, that her husband had a lower libido, that they did it once a month at the most—him fulfilling his husbandly duties—and that their sex life had gradually petered out, leaving her frustrated. I wasn't sure what to say to him if he tried to strike up a conversation with me, but I decided I'd cross that bridge when I got to it.

I got out of the car, collected my things, and rang the bell.

Sariya answered, wearing a silk robe, loosely tied at the waist, with her dark hair down around her shoulders. It was longer than I'd realised at the restaurant, glossy and thick. She looked at me and smiled the slow smile of someone who had been waiting with some impatience.

"Bang on time," she said, cocking an eyebrow. "Very professional."

"I'm nothing if not professional."

She stepped back to let me in, and as I crossed the threshold with the easel under my arm and the portfolio case in my hand, I looked up and saw him.

He was seated in an armchair at the far end of the open-plan living room, composed and still, watching me come through the door with the attentiveness of someone who had been expecting me. I felt my pace slow involuntarily. He was late fifties, maybe sixty, older than I'd imagined. He had close-cropped silver hair, a kind, lean face, and the easy upright posture of someone who'd once been athletic and still carried the habit of it. He was dressed neatly in a dark shirt, dark trousers, the opposite of Sariya, and he rose from the armchair as his wife said his name.

"This is Niran, my husband. Niran, this is my artist friend and client, Jordan Hoyland."

He extended his hand, and I shook it. His grip was firm and brief.

"Jordan Hoyland. Thank you for coming." His English was precise, careful, each word placed with a slight accent I couldn't immediately locate. Thai, I thought, like his wife, though slightly broader. He gestured toward the sofa. "Please. Sit for a moment."

I set down my things and sat. Sariya perched on the arm of the sofa a few feet away, one bare leg crossed over the other, watching her husband

with an expression I found difficult to read from the side. Not quite tenderness and not quite anxiety. Something suspended between the two.

I'd been prepared to read this room carefully, to tread carefully around what Niran did or didn't know, reacting to what he'd been told and how much of it. But there was nothing to read around. He settled back into the armchair with the composure of a man who had spent time preparing himself for exactly this conversation and was entirely ready to have it.

"Sariya has told me about the lifestyle you are involved in," he said. His voice was soft, genuine. "About your street, about your wife, about how these arrangements work." He paused. "She has told me everything. Including the things that were difficult to tell." His brown eyes moved briefly to Sariya, deep wrinkles at the corners deepening as he smiled, before turning his gaze back to me. Something in that glance between them told me the conversation they'd had — the real one, the one where she'd confessed about her friend's husband — had been long and hard and had brought them somewhere new. "I appreciated her honesty. I already knew much of it, but she didn't know that. So, it was not easy for her."

"No," I agreed. "I imagine it wasn't."

He nodded. "I want to be equally honest with you. May I?"

"Of course." I wished I had a beer or something to distract myself with.

He leaned forward slightly, elbows on his knees, fingers loosely laced. "Do you find my wife attractive, Jordan?"

He asked it the way a doctor asks about pain, not crudely, not provocatively, but because the answer genuinely mattered and there was no point dancing around it.

I looked at Sariya. She held my gaze with those dark, steady eyes and didn't look away or offer me any help with the answer.

"Yes," I said. "I do. Most men would. Your wife is a beautiful woman, Niran."

Niran nodded once, without surprise. "Most men do, this is true. I have always known this about her." A pause, measured and deliberate. "I am fifty-eight years old. Over twenty years older than Sariya. I am not a young man, and I have not been a young man for some time." He was quiet for a moment. "I love my wife. That is not in question. But I have not been able to give her what she needs for some years now. My body—"

He paused, searching for the right word with the particular care of someone speaking in a second language about something already difficult in

any language. "It does not respond the way it once did. My drive is not what hers is. And I am not—" He stopped again, and this time the pause was longer, and when he continued, his voice was a shade quieter. "Nature was not generous to me in certain respects. I have long known that Sariya has settled for less than she should have. She has never said so. But a man knows."

The room was very still. Outside, faintly, a lawnmower somewhere down the street.

Sariya was looking down at her hands, fiddling with the hem of her robe. She didn't look embarrassed, exactly, but there was a resignation in her posture that hadn't been there a moment ago.

"I don't tell you this for your sympathy," Niran continued, and there was quiet dignity in it. "I tell you because I want you to understand why I have asked Sariya to find someone, and why I am glad she found you. I have seen your work. You are talented." He gestured briefly toward my portfolio case. "I want you to go ahead with her wishes and paint her. Naked, properly, beautifully. I want to see her through the eyes of a man who desires her and who can act on that desire in ways I can no longer fully manage." He sat back. "I want to watch my wife be fulfilled. Not only by the painting. I think that if she is happy — truly, physically happy — then perhaps it will be good for both of us. Perhaps it will also excite me to see her that way." His eyes stayed on mine, clear and direct. "Would you be willing?"

I looked at him for a long moment. There was no malice in Niran. No agenda I needed to watch for. Not even any sadness, not truly. He'd come to terms with where he and Sariya were right now and wanted to put it right. What he'd just said had cost him something to say, and he'd said it with his chin level and his voice steady, and I found I had a great deal of respect for him.

"I'm happy to paint her," I replied, hoping my voice was steadier than my heartbeat. "Anything beyond that, we take as it comes."

The smile that crossed his face was warm and relieved in a way that made him look, briefly, younger. "Good," he said. "That is all I ask." He stood, smoothing the front of his shirt. "I'll sit in the corner of the room while you work. You won't even know I'm there."

Sariya led me through to the back of the house, a large room that opened onto the garden through a pair of French doors. A cream linen sofa

along one wall, a floor lamp she'd already positioned to throw a warm, even circle of light across the centre of the room. She'd arranged all of it in advance. I noticed the chair in the corner, just far enough back to be unobtrusive, angled slightly.

"He helped set the room up yesterday," Sariya said quietly, seeing me look at the chair, then watching as I extended the legs of the easel and adjusted the height. "The lamp, the chair, all of it. He wanted it to be right for you." She paused. "He's been very calm about all of this. Calmer than me, honestly. I'm nervous as fuck."

The curse word coming from her mouth made me pause for a moment. She noticed and laughed. "I am. You know I'm not wearing anything under this, right?"

She fingered the hem of the silk robe again, and I tried hard not to get excited at the thought.

"Your husband loves you," I said. It wasn't meant to be profound. It was just the most obvious thing in the room. "He thinks this is the best thing for you, so... He might appear calm, but he's probably nervous, too."

She looked at me for a moment with an expression I couldn't entirely read. "Nervous? You don't know my husband. But, yes, he does love me. Which is part of what makes this complicated."

I took a moment to look at the room, the light, the way the afternoon sun came through the French doors and angled across the floor. "Come here," I told her, then as she came over, I guided her by the shoulder—she felt warm and soft through the silk—toward the window overlooking the garden, standing half-turned, left shoulder toward the light.

"No," I murmured. "You'd be better in repose. Help me move the sofa."

Together, we slid the sofa into the pool of light where she'd just been standing.

She reached up and untied the robe with a single pull, but held it closed at the front. "Is that better? Where do you want me?"

"Okay. Take as long as you want, then discard the robe and lie on the sofa, sitting up slightly. Use the cushions so that you're comfortable. You're going to be in this position for a while."

The lamp, warm from behind, the natural light cool from the front, the two sources creating exactly the kind of tonal contrast I wanted as she looked at me, suddenly uncertain.

“I can paint you in the robe, if you’re nervous. It’s not too late to change your mind.”

Sariya shook her head, those long dark tresses of hair falling over her shoulders. I was aware of Niran, joining us, walking into the room and making his way to the chair in the corner.

And then the robe hit the floor, and I took my first proper look at her.

I managed about three seconds of detached professional appraisal before quietly abandoning the effort. Sariya was extraordinary. Warm brown skin, smooth and even, catching the light beautifully across the curve of her shoulder and the swell of her hip. She was slender but not slight. There was a fullness to her figure that the dresses she wore at Kamol's had concealed. Her breasts were larger than I'd realised, hanging down slightly but still firm and round, capped with dark brown nipples the size of coins. Her belly was flat, her hips full, and between her thighs, pressed together nervously, was a tidy triangle of fine dark hair.

She stood in her nakedness with the ease of someone entirely comfortable in their own body, but as her chin tilted slightly, I could tell she was also aware that I was taking her nudity in, daring me to keep looking. She began to sit down, then paused.

"Is this the right—"

"Don't talk yet," I said. "Let me figure out where to put you."

She went still, knees bent, one hand supporting herself on the sofa's arm.

I moved closer, taking my time, letting my eyes move over her the way I needed to, not just admiring her body, though I was, but with the attention of an artist studying a subject, reading the planes and the shadows, noting where the light hit and where it fell away. The line of her clavicle. The way her ribcage expanded slightly with each breath. The soft inward curve at the base of her spine, the jut of her hips, the inner thighs smooth and still pressed together.

I touched her shoulder, then her arm, guiding her to a half-sitting position, her back resting against the arm. I put a cushion under the small of her back, then put a hand beneath one knee, easing her legs open slightly and tilting that knee up, bent. Then I nodded, satisfied, stepped back, picked up the charcoal and began.

Niran was settled into his chair in the corner. He made no sound, and after the first few minutes, I stopped being consciously aware of him in the

way I'd been when I first walked in. He was simply there, the way the lamp was there, the way the light was there. Part of the room. I felt comfortable but also slightly horny, not just from the sight of Sariya's body, but from the fact that her husband was there. Perhaps the Neighbourhood Watch's kinks were rubbing off on me.

I could see her pussy fully now, the soft pink of her slit, the hair around it trimmed more than the downy triangle that covered her mound. She looked wet, but I tried not to think about her possibly being as aroused as I was. I needed to focus.

I worked through the first hour in a focused silence that Sariya instinctively understood. She didn't talk, didn't fidget, only adjusted her position when I quietly asked her to, and returned to stillness immediately after. I moved the lamp once, a foot to the left, and the shadow it threw across the underside of her breast shifted exactly as I wanted it to. I made a note on the corner of the canvas board, a habit of mine, a shorthand of light angles and temperatures I'd return to before the next sitting.

She was an exceptional subject. Still without being rigid, her face settled into an expression I was going to struggle to do justice to, resolved, a growing level of relaxation, just the hint of restrained excitement. It was the kind of expression you couldn't direct a model into. You either caught it, or you didn't.

"Do you like what you see?" Niran asked, after an hour and a half of almost complete silence.

"She's an amazing model," I said, but the look on the older man's face told me I hadn't answered the question to his satisfaction. I nodded. "Her body is perfect. You're a lucky man, Niran."

He smiled and nodded, and I stepped back and looked at what I had. The figure was properly established, the light mapped across it, the lines confident and clean. Her body was there, really there on the canvas, the warmth of her skin already present in the underpainting I'd moved to in the last half hour. But the face needed more time than I had left in the afternoon. I wasn't going to rush it. A face like hers, with the particular quality of expression that I'd carved into my memory, deserved more time.

"It's good." Niran's voice from the corner, quiet and level. I looked back at him. His eyes were on the canvas, and he looked... impressed. And something else. The front of his trousers was slightly tented. I looked away.

"That's the hard part done. I'll need to come back next week," I said. "The sketch is done. I'm happy with it. The colour guides are in, and the underpainting is great. I'll focus more on the details next time. Your face especially needs more time."

Sariya had reached for the robe. She'd barely said a word the whole time. She shrugged it back over her shoulders without tying it and came to stand beside me to look at the canvas, close enough that I could feel the warmth of her.

She didn't speak for a long moment.

"It's wonderful. It looks like me," she said finally. "But a better version."

"No, it looks exactly like you," I replied. "I don't embellish portraits. I draw and paint what I see."

She turned her head and looked at me, happiness and gratitude in her eyes, but not only that. She licked her lips as our gazes held a moment longer than they should, until I looked away, all too aware that my cock was hard and aching in my shorts.

I began packing my brushes. I wiped down the palette, capped the medium, and wrapped the charcoals. I left the canvas on the easel — it needed to stay flat and undisturbed — and fastened my case and straightened up. It took several minutes, during which Sariya went into the kitchen to get us a cool drink, Niran going with her. I picked up my case.

"Jordan."

I turned. Sariya was back, holding a tray with two glasses of sparkling lemonade, which I'd asked her for. Her robe was still hanging open, the inner slopes of her breasts visible along with the dark shadow between her thighs. She'd looked beautiful during the sitting, but for some reason, she was even sexier now, slightly flushed from standing in the lamp's heat for ninety minutes, her hair a little disordered, her eyes very direct.

She glanced back at Niran, a few feet behind her.

"Tell him," her husband said softly.

He had a glass of something golden and sparkling in his hand, and was watching us both with that same calmness he'd brought to the whole afternoon. He met my eyes across the room. Then I looked back at Sariya.

"Remember how I asked you if sometimes, the subject gets aroused while being drawn?" she asked, her voice rough, trembling slightly. "You said yes, sometimes. Well, this is one of those times."

"I'm glad you enjoyed it," I found myself saying, unable to resist looking up and down at the naked column of her body, visible through the opening in the robe.

"I'm not ready to do anything more than this," she continued, placing the drinks down on the table nearby, "But I want to thank you for a fun afternoon."

She reached for my belt, pausing as she touched the buckle, waiting for me to stop her. But I didn't.

"Let me..." She didn't say anything else, she just knelt on the floor before me, her dark eyes looking up, seeking permission. "Please, don't say no."

"I want her to try this," Niran murmured, coming closer as well, sitting nearby in the chair to watch. "And I want to see. Purely out of curiosity."

This felt as weird as hell, but I was incredibly turned on. Fuck it.

I took a deep breath. "Go ahead."

Without hesitation, fingers quick and unhurried, Sariya undid my belt and zipper, her slender hand pushing inside. I was already hard before she'd even wrapped her fingers around me, and as she pulled me out, her eyes opened at the sight, licking her lips again in anticipation.

She didn't do anything for a long moment, her bottom lip caught between her teeth, the robe sliding off one shoulder. Then she wrapped her hand around my shaft and started to stroke me slowly, and I put one hand on the top of the easel beside me and tried to keep my breathing even as she jerked me off.

She had warm, soft hands, and she used them with an unhurried confidence that told me she'd been thinking about this moment for a while. Her grip was firm, her pace measured, her thumb working a slow circle across the head of my cock on each upstroke that made my jaw clench. She let the robe fall from the other shoulder, both tits exposed to me, then looked up and giggled as she saw me looking at them.

"I've been thinking about this for a while," she said, her voice thick with desire.

"I know," I replied, my throat tight at the feeling of my cock in her hand.

She looked up at me then, dark eyes steady and amused, and tightened her grip and increased her pace, and I stopped pretending I was in any kind of control of the situation. I was aware of Niran across the room, watching

his wife's hand pleasure another man in front of him. I wondered what he was thinking, how he felt, but those thoughts were washed away as Sariya put her lips around the head of my cock.

Within seconds, Sariya was working me with her hand and mouth with a growing urgency, reading every small shift in my breathing and adjusting accordingly. I felt the pressure build quickly, with no possibility of slowing it down. When it reached the point of no return, I said her name, *Sariya*, and she moved her head away, angling me towards her chest, and then stroked me through my orgasm with long, deliberate pulls. I came hard, spurt after spurt of hot cum landing on her throat, décolletage and those perfect tits. I steadied myself with one hand against the wall, my whole body tensing through the pleasure of it while she milked out every last pulse with patient, thorough hands.

When it was over, she straightened, still holding the base of my softening cock loosely in her hand, and looked up at me. Her cheeks were flushed, and her breathing had quickened in a way that hadn't been there at the start.

"Now watch me cum," she said. "Please."

She didn't wait for an answer. She let the robe drop from her shoulders entirely and lowered herself to the floor fully — right there between the easel and the French doors, in the warm circle of the sunlight where it moved across the room during the afternoon. She lay back, her dark hair spreading around her head, then opened her legs without any self-consciousness at all, one knee falling to the side, and her hand went straight to her pussy with the directness of someone who knew exactly what they needed and couldn't wait any longer.

She was already wet. I could see it from where I was standing, her fingers slipping easily against herself, two of them finding her clit and working it in fast, tight circles. Her hips lifted almost immediately, her body responsive and urgent, and she made no attempt to be quiet about any of it, a low, continuous moan that rose in pitch as her back began to arch off the floor, her free hand gripping the edge of the nearby rug, her thighs trembling.

It took barely a minute. Her whole body curled upward, spine bowing, heels pressing into the floor, and she came with a sharp, open cry that filled the room, her fingers pressing hard against herself as the orgasm moved through her in long, shuddering waves. She rode every pulse of it with her

hips rolling and her mouth open and her eyes shut, completely unguarded, completely herself.

Then she went still, lying spread on the floor in the sunlight, chest heaving, one arm thrown above her head, legs still open.

From his corner, Niran let out a long, slow breath. "I think we will make love tonight, my darling."

Sariya smiled weakly at him, then turned to me, picking up her robe and wrapping it around herself as she stood. "I'll see you at the same time next week, Jordan."

I fixed myself, fastening my jeans, then picked up my case and looked one last time at the unfinished canvas on the easel. Her naked body, almost fully realised in paint, the details needing completing, her face still to be perfected.

"Next week," I said.

Niran saw me to the door. He shook my hand at the threshold the same way he had when I arrived, firm, brief, without any awkwardness.

"Thank you, Jordan," he said. "I enjoyed that, and Sariya certainly did. Perhaps next week will be even more exciting."

It felt weird to say 'You're welcome', but I did, then walked back to my car in the quiet street, put the equipment in the boot, and sat for a moment before starting the engine. The afternoon had almost turned to dusk while I'd been inside, the sky a deep, fading blue above the rooftops.

I drove home thinking about next week. It was going to be difficult to finish the painting, knowing it was almost certainly going to go further than just a blow job afterwards.

ON UNEXPECTED READING MATERIAL

Home and Heart

A blog by @DemureMillieGrace

It's my return to our local book club next week, and I've been absent for rather too long, nearly three months. Partly from writing my blog posts, making videos and partly from sheer domestic busyness. So when my friend texted me the title of this month's read with a string of aubergine emojis I chose to ignore, I ordered it from the library without looking it up first.

Reader, I should have looked it up first.

I won't be printing the title here until I've finished it, and then I will write a review, but what I will say is that it is *not* the gentle literary fiction I had assumed the book club favoured. It is, in the words I believe the young people use, absolutely filthy. I sat in the bath on Monday evening, intending to read twenty pages and emerged an hour and a half later, pink-faced, wrinkle-toed, having finished nearly half of it and feeling — how to put this delicately — *rather stirred*.

Mr Heart found me in an unusually warm and expressive mood when he came to bed, which I think pleasantly surprised him. I am, as regular readers know, a devoted and willing wife in the bedroom—as I am in all areas of my marriage, I don't shy away from that—but Monday evening was... well, let's just say he asked me twice if I was quite alright. I told him I was simply feeling more loving than usual.

He seemed satisfied with that answer.

I shall attend the book club next week with my annotations prepared and my most composed expression firmly in place. Whether I will be able to discuss certain plot points without going the colour of our rose kitchen tiles remains to be seen.

Yours, rather out of breath, and surprised by myself,
Millie Grace x

Chapter 6

Honesty Is Always The Best Policy

Daisy was in the kitchen when I got home, still in her work clothes, a glass of wine in her hand, sitting at the table with her laptop open in front of her. She looked up when I came through the door and read my face immediately.

"You're back," she smiled. I'd texted her to tell her that I was doing the first sitting at Sariya's home. "How'd it go? Tell me everything."

I hung up my jacket, almost tripping over the shoes that she'd kicked off and left in the middle of the floor, and poured myself a glass from the bottle she'd opened.

"Everything?" I had to tell her. I'd promised we'd be transparent, so I sat down opposite her and took a sip of the wine. "It went well, but she had a bit of a surprise in store for me."

I told her about Sariya answering the door in the robe, about walking into the living room and finding Niran there, composed in his armchair, waiting for me.

"Her husband?" Daisy's eyes widened. "And he knows about her sleeping with her friend's husband?"

"She'd told him everything, and then when I got here, he had this whole talk with me about it."

"Wow." She pushed her laptop to one side, genuinely interested now. "What was he like?"

I thought about how to answer that. "Hard to describe," I said finally. "Blunt and honest but not in a way that made me feel uncomfortable. He managed to put me at ease, somehow. He just... laid it out. His age, his

libido, what he can't give her. He wasn't ashamed about it, he was just factual." I paused. "Then asked me — directly — if I found her attractive."

Daisy raised an eyebrow. "What did you say?"

"Well, she is attractive. I wasn't going to tell him that his wife didn't do anything for me."

"And you do find her attractive, anyway." She absorbed everything, her thumb moving slowly around the rim of her glass. "And so you did the painting?"

"We made a good start. I need to go back next week to complete it." I took a sip of wine. "She got naked, and her husband watched the whole sitting from a chair in the corner. He was so quiet that I almost forgot he was there."

She was quiet for a moment, and I could see her turning it over, examining it from different angles, the way she did with things that interested her academically as much as personally.

"What is her body like?" Daisy asked.

"You have nothing to be jealous about," I reassured her. "She's older than you, different, but good, for her age."

"Did you get horny?" she asked. Her voice was carefully even.

"Yes," I admitted. "She knew. So did he. We did the sitting and then... she thanked me before I left."

Daisy looked at me over the rim of her glass. She knew exactly what I was saying. "Did you fuck her?"

"No," I shook my head, then tightened my face, finding the next bit hard to say. I still wasn't used to our relationship being... the way it was now. "She wants to, but not yet. I think she's still figuring it out now that Niran knows. These things aren't easy."

"So how did she thank you?"

"She sucked me."

Daisy's deep brown eyes blinked twice. "In front of her husband?"

I nodded slowly. "He said he wanted to try watching. I finished on her boobs, then she was so excited that she made herself orgasm, right there in front of both of us."

She set her glass down and licked her lips, taking everything in as I finished telling her everything, how Niran had walked me to the door and even thanked me as I left, promising to see each other next week for the second sitting. Then Daisy let out a slow breath. "For some reason, I'm

really fucking turned on imagining this," she murmured, in a tone that told me she wasn't lying.

She uncurled herself from the chair and walked around the kitchen table toward me with her wine glass still in her hand, and I could tell from the look in her eyes that the conversation had shifted into different territory. She took a mouthful of wine, set the glass down on the table beside me, then reached down and unzipped my jeans with one hand.

"So you came for your commissions agent," she said, her voice low and amused, her fingers wrapping around my stiffening cock and pulling it out. "I hope you've saved some energy for your wife."

She sank to her knees in front of me without any further preamble, and I felt her mouth close around me, the warmth of her lips on my shaft making my head drop back against the chair.

She sucked me slowly, her hands on my thighs, her eyes occasionally flicking up to my face with that look she'd developed lately, wanting me to watch, enjoying the power of it. After a minute, she pulled back, my cock shining wet, and looked up at me.

"Is she better than me?"

"Daisy—"

"Some women have different techniques." Her hand took over from her mouth, stroking me with a loose, easy grip. "Did she suck it good for you? Was it exciting?"

"It was good," I replied carefully, "But not better than you."

"Are you sure?" She ran her tongue slowly up the underside of my cock, and I made a sound I hadn't planned on making. "She managed to get you off, Jordan. On her tits, too. Are they bigger than mine?"

"It wasn't like that—"

"Shh." She took me back into her mouth for a long moment, her lips going all the way to the base, making her gag slightly, then released me again. "Is her body better than mine? Be honest."

"No," I said, and meant it.

"But you'd fuck her."

"Yes."

She held my gaze. "Good," she said quietly. "I want you to." She stood then, reached under her skirt, pulled her panties down and stepped out of them. She lifted the skirt until I could see the hint of blonde hair on her

mound, then swung one leg over me, straddling me in the chair, and settled her weight onto my lap with her hands on my shoulders.

"Would you fuck me?" she asked with a smile that was half teasing, half turned on.

"God, yes."

She reached down and positioned me against her, but didn't sink down yet, just held me there at her entrance, teasing. "What's it like?" she breathed. "Being the other man fucking a woman in front of her husband? Rather than being the husband doing the watching." She rubbed the head of my cock against her clit, making both of us moan softly. "You liked fucking Elia, didn't you?"

"You know I did," I said honestly. "And you enjoyed fucking Spencer. It was fun. What it'll be like to enjoy another man's wife while he just sits there and watches... I really don't know."

"Russell still wants you to fuck Charlotte," she reminded me, then pushed down, taking me fully in one slow movement, her eyes closing for just a second before they found mine again. She started to move, a slow, rocking pace, her forehead almost touching mine.

"I know he does," I said, enjoying the heat of her around me. "But I enjoy seeing you with other men more. I don't want to become a bull. I want to watch you."

She kissed me hard, then pulled back. "I like you watching, too," she murmured against my mouth. "I'm going to fuck lots of hot men for you, Jordan. Does that turn you on? Do you enjoy your wife being a slut for you?"

"Yes. I want you to get fucked so much. I want you to get new dick all the time."

She moaned quietly at that and increased her pace, her hands gripping my shoulders, and we fucked like that until she was breathless and close and I needed more than the chair could offer. I stood, taking her with me, and she wrapped her legs around me and laughed softly in surprise as I walked her the two steps to the kitchen table and bent her forward over it, her palms flat on the wood, skirt up around her waist.

I fucked her properly then, both hands on her hips, and she pressed her cheek against the table and said my name and then said nothing coherent at all for a while. When I came, I finished deep inside her, holding myself

there until I'd emptied every single drop of cum inside, until my cock and balls had finished throbbing.

We stayed still for a moment, getting our breath back. Then she giggled — a soft, contented sound — and straightened up, smoothing her skirt down with her palms.

"You didn't ask me about my day," she said, picking up her wine glass from the counter and taking a composed sip as if we'd just finished washing the dishes together. "Work went fine, but at lunch, I had a conversation with Peter."

"Dr Patterson?" I tucked myself back in and looked at her. "What about?"

"He said he wanted to know everything. It was just a chat by text, but when I told him about the sex club and what I might do, he suggested we meet for a coffee near the office." She paused, and the faint flush on her cheeks wasn't from the sex we'd just had. "I invited him, but he said a sex club is too risky for him. Too contained, too well lit, too many people who might know him." A pause, a look my way. "He said dogging is different. Darker, more anonymous. Easier to disappear if you recognise someone."

"Even though he got caught at a dogging site with his cock in his hand, watching one of his star students swallow another man's cum."

"He didn't lead with that part of his reasoning," Daisy chuckled. "But I got turned on telling him, if I'm honest. Watching his face across the table as I told him I was going to get fucked again, while you watch me."

"And..." My heart was beating fast now. "Did something happen between you?"

"No, but he told me he wants to fuck me." She said it simply, factually, watching for my reaction. "I think that's the first time he'd actually said it out loud."

"And you want to fuck him?"

"Yes, but he won't. Not until my course is finished. He's holding onto that line he's drawn. He'll watch, he'll get himself off over me, he'll give me the grades I need, but actually fucking me is the line he won't cross until I'm no longer his student." She made a short, frustrated sound. "He drove me back to the office afterwards, and we sat in his car outside for a few minutes. He kissed me." She touched her bottom lip briefly, unconsciously.

"Properly. And he put his hand on my breasts, and I could feel how hard he was through his trousers, so I undid his zipper, and he stopped me. Took my wrist and moved my hand away. He wouldn't even let me give him a blow job." She said the last few words with a precision that made it clear they had not sat well with her.

"So what did you tell him?"

"I told him I was frustrated." She picked up her wine. "He suggested we meet up at a car park, once the course is finished, and I said I would, but only if he actually fucks me this time. No more watching through the window. I want him." Her jaw had that particular set to it I recognised when she'd set her mind on something and couldn't be talked out of it. "He's holding out on me, Jordan, and it's genuinely annoying. I don't like being made to wait for something I've already decided I want."

"And that's where you left it?" I asked.

"More or less." She turned her glass slowly, then drank the last dregs. "I was frustrated, so I told him I was fuck someone at the sex club next week and that I'd only tell him about it if he at least lets me suck his cock. Then I'm going to make sure he knows exactly what he's missing out on." She looked at me, and there was that competitive look in her eyes that had been building since Claudia's arrival on the Rise.

"You're going to make him jealous," I said.

"It's not even about jealousy," she corrected. "I'm going to make him absolutely furious with himself for turning me down today."

* * *

We went upstairs before nine, which was early for us, but we were both tired and still slightly horny from our eventful day. Daisy had showered and changed since our fuck in the kitchen, but within minutes of getting in bed, we were both naked again, her pyjamas on the floor next to my discarded underwear.

We fucked again, slower and more deliberate this time. Daisy rode me again, this time with her hands flat on my chest and her head back, unhurried and completely in control of the pace, taking exactly what she wanted from it until she came, with her thighs clamped around me, grinding down hard, and I followed her over the edge almost immediately after.

Afterwards, she lay with her head on my chest in the dark, breathing slowly, one hand flat on my stomach.

"Twice in one day," she murmured contentedly. "I love you."

"I love you, too," I replied softly.

She was quiet for a while after that, and her breathing eventually deepened and steadied as she fell asleep. I lay awake, my mind refusing to wind down as easily, and eventually I gave up, slipped out from under her arm without waking her, and went downstairs with my laptop.

I wasn't looking for anything in particular. I opened Demure Millie's Home and Heart blog out of habit, the way I checked it every few days, and scrolled through the latest posts. There were a couple of new ones, but I found myself scrolling back to the one she'd written on New Year's Day.

Sometimes I don't recognise the woman in the mirror.

I catch glimpses of her throughout the day, in bathroom mirrors as I braid Sweetpea's hair, in shop windows while shopping for the groceries, even in the reflection of the oven door as I pull out fresh bread for Mr Heart's dinner. I do a double-take. Who is that? Then I remember. It's me. The new me.

This past year has changed everything. Three months ago, I was the traditional wife I always wanted to be. Modest. Devoted to my marriage in every conventional way. Anything beyond that would have horrified me. Change is scary.

But this past year opened my eyes in ways I could never have imagined. Not everything needs to be shared here—some things remain sacred between husband, wife, and God—but I will say this: we've discovered deeper intimacy, stronger trust, and a kind of joyful surrender that has made our marriage unshakably strong. He leads. I follow. And in following him into these new waters, I've found the happiest place I've ever been.

It was good writing. Sharp and honest, and I could totally relate to it. We'd changed, too.

I had the Sinner Minnie tab open in another window because I'd been meaning to read Minnie's latest post, one that had shown up in my feed that morning, but when I clicked across and started reading, I was three paragraphs in before I stopped.

I went back to Demure Millie Grace.

I read the mirror post again.

Minnie's 'Sultry Whispers' blog was on an older post, one I'd never read until now, and it hit me right then just how similar they were. They paralleled each other almost perfectly.

I don't recognise the woman in the mirror anymore.

That sounds dramatic, I know. But it's true. I catch glimpses of her throughout the day—in bathroom mirrors, shop windows, the rearview mirror of my car—and I have to do a double-take. Who is that? Then I remember. It's me. The new me. The shared me.

Three months ago, I was a traditional wife. I know some of you reading this will roll your eyes at that phrase, but it's accurate. I was monogamous, faithful, devoted to my husband in every conventional sense. I'd never kissed another man since our wedding day. The idea of sleeping with someone else would have horrified me.

Now? Now I'm a hotwife. A shared wife. A woman who spreads her legs for other men while my husband watches, participates, and encourages.

I put them side by side on the screen and read them again. A traditional wife. Minnie used that exact term. I read more posts from both blogs and noticed even more similarities. A particular fondness for asking themselves questions mid-paragraph and then answering them with a kind of wry self-awareness. More matching sentiments shared at similar times. Even the names were close. Millie. Minnie.

Either one of them was copying the other, or they were the same person writing in two different registers for two very different audiences.

I sat back and looked at the ceiling for a moment.

Lewis had said he knew Millie Grace. Knew her personally, worked with her husband, Mr Stag or Mr Heart, whichever he saw himself as. Maybe he was both. Maybe he had a duality to him, just like his wife. Maybe he'd understand how I felt about it all.

I looked at Millie's videos and photos. She was gorgeous with her lustrous dark hair, her classic makeup, her petite frame, and her love of pretty dresses. The thought of her doing the slutty things that Sinner Minnie described made my cock twitch, despite having cum three times today.

I felt myself about to fall into a rabbit hole of curiosity, and couldn't afford that. I had enough on my plate already. I closed the laptop and went back upstairs to bed, sliding in carefully beside Daisy without disturbing her, before I was tempted into digging further.

But before I eventually fell asleep, I made the decision to find and ask Lewis about her tomorrow. And if he wasn't forthcoming, I'd write to her and at least point out the similarities, just in case Sinner Minnie was just someone impersonating her, making a parallel blog for some warped reason.

But I had the strongest feeling that wasn't what it was.

Demure Millie Grace had a secret life, and I'd uncovered it.

MANAGING JEALOUSY

An Excerpt from The Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing

Jealousy will occur. Plan for it.

It does not announce itself coming. It will not arrive during a conversation over dinner or in the warm aftermath of good sex. It will arrive at three in the morning, keeping you awake while your wife sleeps beside you, and your mind has nothing useful to do except replay the details you found most arousing at the time, and quietly reframe them as evidence of something being taken from you.

This doesn't mean you've made a mistake. It isn't the beginning of regret. It's simply a sign that you're human and that the cultural programming around marriage, ownership, and male adequacy runs considerably deeper than a few months of lifestyle exploration can entirely rewire.

The following should be understood clearly.

Jealousy at this stage is rarely about the other man. It is about your own sense of worth. It is the fear that desire is a finite resource, that what she gives to someone else is subtracted from what she gives to you. This isn't how desire works. But, of course, fear isn't interested in accuracy.

Don't try to suppress it. Don't pretend it's fine, that you're not feeling anything at all, because your wife won't believe you, and the effort of bottling it up will just convert that jealousy into resentment, which is considerably more destructive.

Instead, admit it. Tell her how you feel, calmly and without accusation, that you're jealous of her and her lovers. She won't be shocked. She's likely been waiting for it, wondering why you don't feel more possessive.

Also, expect reciprocity. She feels it too about you. About the women you have looked at, touched, or thought about. Don't let your new open

lifestyle become a competition for feelings. You and your wife are both experiencing these new feelings together. Talk, be honest, adjust your expectations. Jealousy, named and discussed, loses most of its power within a single honest conversation.

Communication is key, and in this particular instance, it opens a part of your relationship you never want to have to work to unlock again.

Chapter 7

Different In Person

I texted Tyler at eight, while Daisy was in the shower getting ready for university.

I should have been thinking about the upcoming visit to Euphoria, or getting in touch with Sariya to see how things had been with her husband since I'd left, or wondering if Dr Patterson would talk to Daisy today. But instead, I'd been lying awake since six with the laptop tabs open in my head — Sinner Minnie, Millie Grace — questions turning over in my head until I needed to do something about it.

Is Lewis still around, or has he gone home? I need to ask him something.

Tyler came back within minutes. He's staying with us until next week, but he's out until the afternoon. Some deal at a showroom over in Cheltenham. He said he'd be back by three. Why don't you come over then? There was something I wanted to mention to you, too.

I told him I'd be there, then once Daisy had headed out, I spent the morning in the studio working on some figure studies, a woman with proportions similar to Sariya, trying to stay focused on the canvas and mostly failing. At half two, I cleaned my brushes, changed my shirt, and walked to Tyler and Morgan's house, next door to ours.

Lewis answered the door in a dark polo shirt, car keys still in his hand, looking like a man who'd just walked in. He was broader than I remembered from the party.

"Jordan." He stepped back. "Dad and Morgan just went to the shops, but they said you were coming over. Come in."

The house was quiet without his parents. He led me through to the kitchen and put the kettle on. "Coffee or tea?"

"A coffee would be great," I smiled, realising I'd headed over without thinking how I was going to frame the question.

"So," he said, leaning against the counter with his arms folded. "What's up?"

I pulled out my phone, opened both tabs, Sinner Minnie in one and Trad Wife Millie in the other, and set it on the counter between us. "Tell me what you see."

He picked it up, looked at the Sultry Whispers post, then at the almost identical Home and Heart post. He read for longer than I expected. Then he passed the phone back to me.

"So you like reading blogs, huh?" he asked.

"I've followed Demure Millie Grace for a while. You saw my laptop the other day. Sinner Minnie came up in my feed more recently. I was browsing about the whole hotwife deal, you know, because of what goes on here." I paused. "Lewis, if I'm wrong about this, please don't say anything to her. I know you said you know her. I don't want to cause any offence, and I might be completely off base. But I'm pretty certain I'm not. Are these blogs the same person?"

Lewis looked at me for a long moment and took a deep breath, a look in his eyes that I didn't recognise.

"You're not off base," he admitted.

I waited.

"You need to swear to me this goes nowhere," he said firmly. "Millie is a good person. She has kids to think about. She'll be heartbroken if this ever got out publicly and her friends or family found out."

"I swear," I said.

He was quiet for another moment, as if deciding how much of the door to open. Then he said, "I've fucked her."

I kept my expression neutral with some effort. I didn't expect that to be his opening line of explanation. "You... what?"

"Millie Grace," he said. "I've fucked her." He pulled two mugs from the cupboard, put a tea bag in one and instant coffee in the other, then poured water into them, stirring slowly as he thought everything through. "I told you that we were close, but—"

We were interrupted by the front door opening as Tyler and Morgan returned from their shopping trip, several bags of groceries in their hands.

"I'll tell you the rest later, when we do the rounds," Lewis whispered, moving to help his parents with the shopping.

"What rounds?"

He opened his mouth to answer, then closed it as his dad spoke.

"Jordan." Tyler looked pleased to see me. "I'm glad you came over. It saves me texting you." He came in past me, Morgan following, and together with Lewis, they unloaded the groceries onto the kitchen table. "Has Lewis told you that we're doing a patrol tonight?"

I glanced at Lewis while taking a sip of the hot coffee that he passed to me. "He just mentioned it."

Tyler poured himself a glass of water and turned to lean against the sink. "We had a further conversation with Tom and Claudia after the meeting. Similar to the conversation I had with you last year."

Morgan took over explaining, a smile that lit up her dark eyes as she looked my way. "They're keen to show willingness and want to try something to ease them into things. I've suggested they leave the curtains open this evening while we walk the rear path tonight." She looked between Lewis and me. "I thought you two might want to be the ones to do it, seeing as Claudia seems to like you two the most."

My phone buzzed in my hand. I glanced down at it. A message from Daisy.

I went shopping at lunch and found the most incredible underwear in Selfridges. Red. Very see-through, and also a new dress. You're going to die when you see it.

I typed back, *Can't wait. Show me everything when you're home*, and then slipped the phone into my pocket.

"Tonight works for me," I smiled at the three of them in the kitchen, waiting for an answer. "A patrol sounds like fun."

* * *

Daisy was home by half four, dropping her own bags on the kitchen table with a smile of anticipation on her face. She pulled some pink tissue paper aside and held up the underwear first. It was made from sheer red lace, a

balconette bra, and high-waisted panties with an attached suspender belt, the kind of garments that showed more than they covered.

"Well?" she giggled. "What do you think?"

"These are to wear to the swingers club?"

"Oh, yes. I texted Kelly, and she approved. Said they'd be perfect." She grinned. "And I got this, too." The dress came out of the second bag. It was red, slinky, cut low at the front and lower at the back, a glossy, silky red fabric. She held it against herself, the hem falling mid-thigh. "Kelly says she has the same one, but in black, so we're not going to clash."

"I didn't know you were so close, Kelly helping you pick what to wear for a sex club outing."

"We've been talking a little," she filled me in. "She wanted to check that the air was clear between us after the Kelvin thing. She's nice once you get to know her." She folded the dress back carefully. "How was your day?"

"Interesting." I sat down at the table. "I went to see Lewis."

She looked up. "Why?"

"You know the trad wife blogger I follow?" Daisy nodded, putting the bags on the kitchen side so she could make herself a drink. "Lewis knows her. I wanted to ask him a few questions about her."

"Because of your modern husband thing?" Daisy tugged off her grey sweater, revealing a tight black t-shirt beneath that was hugging her breasts. "It's similar, right? Domestic goddess, domestic god."

"Something like that." I watched her make a coffee, wondering how much to tell her. What was more important right now was telling her the other part. "Also, while I was there, Tyler and Morgan asked me if I'd do a patrol later, with Lewis."

"Oh yeah?" That had piqued her interest. She took a sip of her hot drink, her brown eyes finding mine over the rim of the mug. "Just a regular patrol, is it?"

I couldn't get anything past Daisy. She knew me too well. "Tyler's arranged for Tom and Claudia to leave the curtains open. Their way of gently easing their way into the lifestyle."

Something shifted in Daisy's expression. Not quite a frown, but close.

"They're going to leave the curtains open," she repeated slowly. "So you're going to watch Claudia have sex?"

That little flare of something again. Jealousy? "And Tom. I don't know. They just said they were going to leave the curtains open, the lights on, not

what they were actually going to do."

"Maybe I should come with you." She looked in the cupboards. "What's for dinner?"

"I have a couple of steaks and some vegetables," I replied. I didn't want her to come with us. Not because I wanted to watch Claudia—though I did—but because I wanted to talk to Lewis about the Millie Grace situation. "I mean, you can come with us if you want, but—"

"Actually, I have a better idea," Daisy interrupted me. "I was going to try these on now, but I could wait until later."

"What?"

"Why should Claudia have all the fun? Tell Lewis you want to show him the rear path behind our house, too." She fished in the bag and picked up the red dress again. "We can time it so that I'll be getting changed into this. With the curtains open." She met my eyes steadily. "If he's going to watch Claudia with you, he can watch me too."

I looked at her for a moment. It was definitely jealousy that I detected in her voice.

"Okay," I said, liking the idea and not just because it gave me the opportunity to talk with Lewis.

She nodded once, satisfied, and took the bags upstairs.

* * *

Lewis and I set out at nine. The night was cold, the sky above us clear, our breath visible under the streetlights as we walked the main loop first. We walked unhurried, Lewis picking up the thread he'd left in Tyler's kitchen.

"So, yeah, it happened just a couple of months ago. She came into the showroom," he said, his voice low. "The one I was working at before I moved to Birmingham. Expensive cars. A top-of-the-range dealership." He had his hands in his jacket pockets, keeping it quiet but easy, like he was describing a routine sale rather than revealing someone's darkest secrets. "Her husband, Jamie, worked there, too. There was a party put on by our boss, Matthew. I didn't know at the time, but he and Jamie had been working together, trying to get Millie into the whole wife-sharing thing."

"Really? Wow. So what happened?"

"We'd just got a new car in stock, a Ferrari. Are you into cars?" I shook my head; to me, cars were just a means of getting from A to B. "Anyway, it

was an absolute beast of a car. Long story short, I was allowed to test drive it, and Millie came with me."

We turned onto the rear path, the darkness thickening around us as the streetlights fell away.

"And you fucked her in the car?" I asked.

"No. We kissed, I felt her tits, rubbed her pussy through her panties. She was soaking wet. But she wouldn't do it in the car. She wanted to talk to her husband first."

I was picturing it in my head as we walked. Millie was extremely attractive. But from how he acted on her videos, so innocent, so virtuous, it was hard to believe what he was saying was true.

"When we got back to the showroom, the party was in full swing." Lewis was quiet for a moment. "There were drinks, champagne, photos being taken. Matthew had fixed it for her to be the star of the show, she was having her pictures taken with the car, it was crazy." He paused, gazing into the darkened windows of number 20, before moving on. "The next thing I know, we're in Matthew's office, him, Jamie, me, Millie. I fucked her on his desk while they watched."

"No way."

"Yes way. Here's the thing. She hadn't done anything like that before. She really was the full Trad Wife thing, genuinely, not pretending. She still is. She keeps the house clean, cooks everything from scratch, the whole picture."

We walked past a couple more houses, nothing to see, reaching the odd-numbered houses.

"Apparently, Jamie had always wanted to see her with another man." A short pause. "Somehow Matthew found out—he's been in the lifestyle for years, so he and Jamie talked, then encouraged Millie to try something. Turns out she'd only ever really been with Jamie and was curious about other guys. I was her first." I glanced at Lewis, and saw a slightly smug grin on his face as we walked. "She's slept with a few men since, including Matthew. And now she writes about it on her new blog, so we can all keep up with her adventures."

"Have you thought about telling her about the Rise?"

"Sometimes." He considered it. "Not at the time. I'd only just found out about her, and then I left, so it never entered my mind at the time. Besides, she's got a whole life, two kids, a nice husband, has to fit her social media

influencer life in between school runs, gardening, making dinners, book clubs, and whatever it is she does. Maybe it's better left as it is." He glanced at me. "And I don't get too involved in what goes on here. Too close to home, you know?"

"Yeah," I nodded. "I completely get it."

We had reached the stretch of path behind the houses on the south side of the Rise. Lewis touched my arm, and we slowed.

Number seventeen, Tom and Claudia's house, was lit up.

They'd done as promised and left the curtains open downstairs. We approached the small wall that bounded their back garden, the darkness of the woods behind us. They must have seen us coming, or just perfectly timed things, because they were already at it.

Through the uncurtained window, I could see Claudia and Tom. She was lying on the sheepskin rug in front of the fireplace, completely naked, her dark hair spread out beneath her, one knee raised. Tom was between her thighs with his face buried in her completely shaved pussy, his hands hooked under her hips, and she had her fingers loosely in his hair with the relaxed authority of a woman who knew exactly how she liked it done.

"Christ," Lewis said quietly, beside me.

I'd seen Claudia naked before, the photo she'd shown us all at the meeting, but it hit me harder now, seeing her in the flesh. She was genuinely stunning. Long legs, alabaster-pale skin, full breasts that fell softly to either side as she lay back, dark nipples stiff in the warm air of the room. Her stomach was flat and smooth, her pussy completely bare, and Tom's tongue was working against her with a focus that had her hips making small, involuntary tilts upward.

"Dad's told me about this," Lewis murmured. "The window thing. But it's different in person."

"First time, huh?"

When he nodded, I smiled to myself, wondering what he'd think of Daisy.

"But you've seen her before. You slept with Claudia, right?" I remembered how he'd introduced them, the three friends having a drunken threesome. "You and Tom?"

"You know about that?" Lewis's eyebrows climbed his forehead as I nodded.

"Claudia told everyone at the Neighbourhood Watch meeting."

“A heads up might have been nice,” he chuckled. “But, yeah, whatever. We went out, the three of us. Got drunk. Ended up back at my place, put some music on. Tom doesn’t like dancing, but Claudia does, so we danced. There’s always been a bit of an attraction between us, but she’s always been Tom’s girl, you know? Anyway, this one night, I don’t even know how, we started kissing. Kissing led to more. Tom just sat and watched. Then at some point, he joined in, and we fucked her together.”

“Sounds like a hell of a night.”

“It was.”

Tom shifted, he was naked, too. He lifted his head, her wetness smeared around his mouth, then repositioned himself, lying on his back on the rug while Claudia moved over him, upside down to his position. She took his decent-sized erection, curving slightly upward, in her hand, stroking him while lowering her pussy onto her husband’s mouth. Then she began to suck him, working the head while her hand pumped at the base of his shaft, and Tom went back to work licking her pussy.

"You only have to look at her body to know how good the sex was," Lewis said. "She knew how to suck cock. Her tits were so firm, and her pussy was so tight. It's just a shame that we've never done it since. She wants to try new things now, with new guys. I'm too close, apparently. It'd be weird."

“What’s Millie’s body like?” I asked, finding my mind drifting back to the trad wife influencer for some reason.

“Oh, she’s tiny,” Lewis responded, unable to take his eyes from the couple sixty-nining in front of us. “Petite, small but perfect tits. Landing strip on her pussy, which was really fucking tight, by the way. Different to Claudia, but really fucking hot, too.”

As if hearing her name, Claudia turned her head toward the window, her eyes finding us immediately — and then she held my gaze with an expression that I read as arousal and nervousness mixed together. I knew how that felt. Her lips were parted, her chest rising and falling, and she kept her eyes on me as a violent shudder ran through her. We heard her cry out, orgasming on her husband’s mouth, his dick still in her hand.

But she still didn't look away.

Only when her climax had subsided did she move, standing up and walking over to the window. For a moment, she stood there in all her naked glory, giving us an outstanding view of her full tits, that smooth pussy, and

then she pulled the curtains closed, slowly but deliberately, a small smile growing on her lips as she disappeared from view.

Lewis hadn't spoken for a while, but managed to find his voice.

"Well, fuck. That was something."

"It sure was." I pulled out my phone and texted Daisy. *Get ready. We'll be five minutes.*

"I guess that's it for the night," Lewis rued. "We're supposed to report back to Dad and Morgan what we saw."

"Sure, but I just want to walk around the backs of our houses," I told him. "Then we'll call in and give our report."

"Cool."

Lewis and I moved on, continuing along the rear path toward our end of the Rise, passing Kelly's house, which was lit up but with no one in view. As we came level with the back of our house, I slowed.

The living room was lit warm and bright, the curtains open, and Daisy was there, as expected.

She was standing in the centre of the room with her back toward us, already undressed to nothing, her blonde hair loose around her shoulders. She was unhurried, unself-conscious, moving the way she did when she thought she was alone. She'd asked me not to tell Lewis, but to keep it a surprise. He'd know that we'd set this up between us. He knew what we were into, being a part of the Neighbourhood Watch.

The dress and underwear were draped across the back of the chair in front of her, and she reached for the suspender belt first, stepping into it, drawing it up over her hips, and adjusting it at the waist. Then the stockings, sitting on the arm of the sofa, so she could roll each one up her leg elegantly. We had the perfect view of her lightly-haired pussy as she parted her thighs slowly, pulling up the panties sexily, the sheer red lace settling over her pale skin. Her tits looked perfect, not huge, but round and firm, her nipples stiff with arousal. Then she put on the bra, fastening it at the back with one hand. She stood, looked down at herself briefly, and pushed her hair back from her face.

Beside me, Lewis had gone very still.

She picked up the red dress from the sofa and dropped it over her head, letting it fall down her body, the fabric settling over the curves of the underwear beneath. She smoothed it with both hands, turned once to look at

the mirror above the fireplace, and then walked to the window and, just as Claudia had, she closed the curtains in one clean pull.

Neither Lewis nor I said anything for a moment.

"I see why you wanted us to finish the patrol," Lewis said finally.

"I hope you liked what you saw," I replied. "Daisy didn't want Claudia getting all the attention."

"She's incredible. They both are. Can I ask something?" Lewis responded as we started walking back towards the path that led to his parents' house. When I nodded, he continued. "Do you get turned on by guys seeing your wife naked like that? I'm not judging."

"Yeah. I think my Daisy is beautiful. It's kind of hot when other guys think the same."

"Well, I definitely do." We walked a few more steps, then he slowed to a stop, just a few yards from home. "I know I told you I don't get involved in the... goings-on... here on the Rise."

"But?" I sensed what was coming.

"But I would very much like to fuck your wife."

We stood there under the dim streetlights of Far Bridge Rise and waited for the slightly awkward silence to turn into the complicated tangle of emotions that it always did. Pride, possessiveness, arousal, all combining together into something new.

I smiled. Lewis relaxed.

"I'll talk to Daisy," I told him, and then we headed inside to report to Tyler and Morgan everything that had just happened.

MY PRIVATE NOTES (SHOULD I CALL THIS MY HOTWIFE DIARY?)

I saw Lewis's face before I closed the curtains. Standing in the dark of the rear path with Jordan beside him. I wonder if he knew we'd set this up, or if he thought I didn't know they were there? I knew exactly when they arrived. I'd been watching the window in the mirror above the fireplace the whole time.

I wish I'd taken longer with the stockings and the bra. My hands were shaking a little. I was so turned on but also slightly nervous. I wasn't sure how Lewis would react.

This is something I wasn't expecting about this life we've fallen into, the power of it. Not in any complicated psychological sense, just the simple, intoxicating fact of knowing that a man wants you. Knowing it with certainty, seeing it written across his face through a pane of glass after you roll a stocking up your thigh and pretend they don't know you're watching.

Jordan thinks I agreed to the curtains-open thing because I was jealous of Claudia. He's not entirely wrong. She's beautiful, and she's been the centre of attention on this street since she arrived, and I am not above admitting that I found that irritating. But it was more than that. I wanted Lewis to see my body. I might not be as perfect as Claudia, but I know that men like my body. It turns me on to show them and see that look in their eyes.

What I'm also beginning to understand, and this is genuinely useful for the dissertation, not just self-justification, is that the power dynamic in these situations is almost never where the men think it is. They believe they're the ones in control, the watching, the wanting, the pursuing. But they're not. They're the fish. We're the ones holding the rods with the baited hooks, ready to reel them in when they bite. I'm filing that observation away carefully alongside everything else.

Jordan will tell me what Lewis said on the walk home, but I think I already know. I saw the look on his face.

Jordan will ask me if I want to fuck him. I'll think about it for exactly as long as it takes to be polite.

I already know my answer.

Chapter 8

Putting It All Together

Lewis replied to Daisy's text within thirty seconds of her sending it. I'd barely finished telling her what he'd said on the path — she'd been sitting cross-legged on the bed in her white dressing gown, still flushed from her performance at the window, looking at me with that expression of entirely unconvincing innocence — when her phone lit up.

"He's keen," she observed, reading it.

"What does he say?"

She turned the screen toward me.

I've been thinking about you since the New Year's Eve party, and I know I'm not going to be able to get you off my mind after seeing you tonight. Tell me what you want.

She typed back one-handed, the other hand resting on her bare ankle.

I want to know what I'm working with first.

She hit send and looked up at me. "Sit down. This might take a minute."

It took about forty seconds. Her phone buzzed, and she looked at the screen, and the way her eyebrows rose told me everything I needed to know before she turned the phone around.

Lewis had sent her a photo. He was lying on a bed, in what I guessed was the guest room at Morgan and Tyler's, completely naked. His body was solid, not muscular, but also not an inch of fat on his broad frame. His cock was hard, standing at ninety degrees from his body in one hand, not huge but not small either. It was thick, a prominent vein running down one side of the shaft.

"Well, well, well," Daisy said. "Lewis has a nice cock to go with his nice body."

"He sure does," I agreed. I couldn't help but think about how that cock had been inside Claudia and Millie. And now Daisy, if she decided she wanted him.

She studied it for a moment longer than was strictly necessary for assessment purposes, then handed the phone to me and loosened her dressing gown, letting it fall open to display her tits. "We should send him a nice picture in return," she smiled. "Take a good photo of my boobs."

"Daisy—"

"Do you have a better idea?" She dropped the robe altogether, tossed it to the floor, so she was entirely naked, then got on all fours on the bed, her ass and pussy pointing towards me and the camera. "Maybe something more like this?"

"He's just seen you naked through the window," I pointed out. "You really want to show him more?"

"I want him to forget Claudia even exists."

I stared at my wife for a moment, but her expression — or her pose — didn't change. I stepped back to capture her full body, on all fours on the bed, the swell of her tits hanging below her, the curve of her ass catching in the light from the bedside lamp, and the glistening wet pussy crack, then took the shot and sent it.

A reply came immediately.

"What does he say to that?" Daisy asked, returning to a sitting position, tucking her legs beneath her.

I read it aloud: *Why don't you put on a show for me one night? Like Tom and Claudia did for us earlier. I'd love to watch you suck Jordan and then get fucked.*

"Pass me the phone," she replied, taking it from me and replying, turning the screen so I could see.

Why don't you just come over one night and fuck me yourself?

"Don't you think we should slow down?" I asked, but Daisy shook her head, waiting for his response. Again, it didn't take long, buzzing in her hand.

I will, but not until next week. I have some work to do on the road, but I'll be around until the end of next week, so don't worry.

"Urgh," Daisy complained. "There's always some excuse." Then she read her next message out loud as she typed and sent it.

“Well, in that case,” her thumbs moved swiftly over the keys on the screen, “I’m just going to show you what you’re missing. Make sure you don’t chicken out.”

“What are you doing?”

"Shush. Come here," she said, patting the bed beside her. "Get naked. I'm going to show Lewis how good I suck cock."

I undressed and sat on the edge of the bed, and Daisy knelt between my thighs with her phone in her hand, angling it to get both of us in frame. She looked into the lens for a moment, then at me, then back at the lens.

"Hi Lewis," she said conversationally, and wrapped her hand around the base of my cock.

She took her time about it. Daisy knew exactly what she was doing, and the next several minutes were genuinely difficult to endure with any composure. She started with her hand, long, slow strokes while she looked into the camera and talked in that low, sexy voice about what she was going to do, what she wanted him to imagine, whether he was already hard at watching this. Then she dipped her head and ran her tongue up the underside from base to tip, making me groan with pure lust.

She sucked me slowly and thoroughly, her dark brown eyes flicking up to the camera with a regularity that made it clear she was performing as much as she was enjoying it. She told me to hold the phone, her free hand moving to cup and squeeze my balls, her head bobbing in a steady rhythm that she occasionally broke to pull back and look directly into the lens.

"I love sucking cock," she murmured, her lips brushing the head with each word. "I'm going to do this to you so slowly, Lewis. I'm going to take my time and make you beg for it."

She went back down, deeper this time, and I stopped trying to hold the phone at a considered angle, and just pointed it roughly in her direction and hoped for the best.

When I told her I was close, she looked up at me — not at the camera, at me — and nodded slightly. Then she took me deeper, and I came with my free hand tangled in her hair. Daisy just held herself there, her lips tight around my shaft, letting me empty my balls in her mouth.

When it was over, she sat up slowly and looked directly into the camera with her lips closed and her eyes bright. Then she opened her mouth.

I could see my cum on her tongue. She stayed like that for a long, deliberate moment, looking into the lens, then closed her mouth and

swallowed.

Then she took the phone from my hand and turned it on herself, moving it slowly down her body, lingering on her naked tits, her nipples hard, then down between her legs, capturing every detail of her wet pussy.

"I swallow," she said to the camera, her voice low and conversational. "But I'd rather you cum on my tits. Or here." She used two fingers to open herself up, showing the pink wetness inside. "Just so you know."

She stopped the recording. Looked at it once in preview, nodded, satisfied, and began typing. I looked over her shoulder to see what she was putting.

Jealous? I thought you might like to see what you're missing. Come and find me next week before you go home, and I'll do all of that for you. You'll never look at Claudia twice after I'm done with you.

She attached the video and hit send.

"Daisy—"

"He's already seen me naked through the window," she said, setting the phone on the nightstand and lying back against the pillows. "I've already told him I want sex. The time for coyness is long gone."

He replied a few minutes later, long enough to have watched the video.

Tuesday. I'll come to your place. Jordan can watch if that's what he's into.

She turned the screen toward me with her eyebrows raised. A question.

"Tell him yes," I said.

She smiled and typed.

He wants to. Tuesday then. I'll text you the time. She paused, fingers over the screen, then added more. *Goodnight Lewis. Dream about me.*

She put the phone face down on the nightstand and looked at me. "Right," she said. "Now make me cum."

"I thought you'd never ask," I smiled, reaching across and turning off the bedside lamp. She pulled me towards her in the dark, and I kissed her, my hand sliding down her stomach and between her thighs. She made a small sound against my mouth as I found her clit, her hips shifting, her thighs spreading wider. She was already wet, slippery and swollen, close to her climax.

I took my time. She'd taken her time with me, and it seemed only fair. I worked her clit in slow, patient circles, reading every shift in her breathing,

every small involuntary movement of her hips, until she was gripping my wrist with both hands, not to stop me, but to guide me.

"Fingers inside," she breathed. "I'm close."

When I slipped two fingers into her heat and curled them, she gasped, short and sharp, and I felt her tighten around them almost immediately. I kept my thumb on her clit and worked her steadily until she came with her head thrown back and her spine arching off the bed, one long shuddering peak that moved through her in waves while she gripped my wrist and moaned so loudly I was worried the whole cul-de-sac would hear.

Afterwards, she lay still for a long moment, breathing.

"I fucking needed that," she sighed.

I laughed. She turned her head and smiled, and reached up to touch my lips once with her fingertips, and then closed her eyes.

* * *

The day of the trip to Euphoria came around far too quickly.

I got up early, doing the washing up from last night's dinner, and was at the kitchen table with my first coffee of the day and my laptop. Daisy was still asleep upstairs, so I let her get some extra rest. She'd worked hard all week; she deserved a lie-in. After scanning through the news, mostly boring, depressing stuff as usual, I checked my two favourite blogs out of habit. Sinner Minnie had posted overnight, and when I checked Millie's blog, there it was, something similar. But the tone of them was different. It was in her usual voice, but she was writing about feeling stuck, feeling static.

Do you ever find yourself standing at a crossroads, waiting for a sign? I've been there lately. That strange, restless feeling of knowing you want to move forward, but not quite knowing which road to take. Waiting for a spark. Waiting for something—or someone—to point you in the right direction.

That was Millie, but her alter ego, Minnie, went further.

Mr Stag and I have come a long way in a short time. Further than I ever imagined, if I'm honest. And now that we're here, truly here, I find myself frozen, not with doubt, not with fear exactly, but with choice. There is so much. So many possibilities. So many paths into this beautiful, filthy world.

And I want to explore all of them, immediately, which of course means I need to slow down and actually think.

I kept reading.

So here I am, community. I'm going to take the leap. I'm going to stop hovering in the doorway and actually walk into the room. But I'd love your wisdom first, especially those of you who've been on this journey longer than I have. How did you choose? How did you decide what to try first? How do you know when you've found the right person?

Drop me a message. Slide into my DMs. Tell me everything.

Fuck it. I clicked through to the contact form on the Sinner Minnie blog and typed.

Hi Minnie. I've been reading your blog for a while, and your latest post made me want to reach out. I'm part of an open relationship community. We're really friendly, close by, and I think we can help you. I'd love to help you explore this new side of yourself. No pressure either way, but it'd be great to hear from you. Jordan.

I used my real name. Why not? There were thousands of Jordans. Then, on a whim, I sent her another message, wanting to get something off my mind.

Hi, Jordan again. I thought I should also tell you that I suspect you have another blog, too. Are you also Demure Millie Grace? If you are, don't worry, it's cool. I just thought I should tell you that some of your posts are so parallel to each other that it's kind of obvious. If you don't want people to know, perhaps you should change them up a little. I expect you probably thought that no one would read both blogs; they're for different audiences, but I did, so maybe there are others like me, too.

Oh, and I know someone who knows you. He says you're an awesome person, so I hope you don't take my messages the wrong way. I hope to hear back from you sometime. X.

I closed the laptop as I heard the shower start upstairs. Time to make Daisy's breakfast and start our preparations for our own big leap tonight.

** * **

By seven that evening, Daisy was at the mirror in the bedroom, checking herself in the red underwear, doing her makeup, trying to get it perfect. I sat on the edge of the bed and watched her, admiring the red lace against her

lightly tanned skin, the stockings, the suspender straps taut against her thighs, and thought about how far we were from the couple who'd moved onto this street last year, with their ordinary life and unspoken desires.

"Stop staring," she said, not looking away from the mirror.

"I'm not staring. I'm appreciating."

"You're making me self-conscious."

"You're getting ready to go to a sex club," I replied. "Self-consciousness seems like the last thing you need to be feeling right now."

She smiled at me in the reflection. "Fair point." She stood, reached for the red dress, dropped it over her head, and smoothed it down. Then she turned once, looking at herself over her shoulder. The dress fitted perfectly, the low front reaching down between her breasts. She looked fantastic.

"Well?" she purred, a smirk on her mouth when she saw my face. "How do I look?"

"You look like trouble," I murmured, moving close and wrapping her hands around her waist. "Like a woman who's going to be dangerously popular where we're going."

I bent my head to kiss her, but she laughed and put a hand against my chest, pushing me back. "You'll ruin my makeup," she giggled. "Go and get dressed or we'll be late."

We'd arranged to pick up Tyler and Morgan, so they could have a drink, then meet Frank, Linda, Russell, Charlotte, and Kelly at the venue at eight. It was ten past seven now. Daisy was right. I needed to get ready.

I quickly changed into a crisp white shirt and black trousers, picking out my best shoes and styling my hair the best I could in the mirror that Daisy had vacated. When I was done, I looked myself up and down, clean shaven, smart and presentable. I looked good. Not as good as Daisy, but that was kind of the point.

Five minutes later, we left, locking the door behind us.

"I'll get the car started," I muttered, nerves starting to kick in. "You go tell Tyler and Morgan we're ready."

"Okay," she nodded, and I could tell she was nervous, too. "But are we?"

"Are we what?"

"Ready?" she asked softly.

"I don't think you're ever really ready for these things," I shrugged, trying to remember something Millie — or Minnie, I couldn't remember

which — had quoted in one of the blogs. “Sometimes you just have to take the leap.”

Daisy seemed to think about that for a moment, then turned her eyes on me. “You’re right. And what Kelly said, that we can do as much or as little as we want, so there’s no pressure.”

“No pressure,” I agreed.

And with that, my wife went to fetch our next-door neighbours, ahead of what might be one of the biggest nights of our lives.

YOUR FIRST CLUB NIGHT

An Excerpt from The Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing

A sex club is not an orgy. Understand this before you walk through the door.

It is a managed social environment with rules, and the rules exist for good reason. Learn them before you attend. Every reputable establishment operates a consent policy that is absolute and non-negotiable. No means no, always, for everyone, including your wife. Especially your wife. Her right to decline any approach without explanation or apology is not up for discussion, and that includes you. Your job is not to manage her interactions. It is to be entirely supportive of whatever she chooses.

Practical etiquette is straightforward. Do not watch other couples without their tacit or explicit permission. Do not touch anyone without invitation. Do not discuss what you see inside with anyone outside. Discretion is the currency of these spaces, and it spends in both directions.

Now. What nobody adequately prepares you for.

The moment another man approaches your wife in that environment, and she decides she's interested, the moment you see her smile at him in that particular way, and you understand that something is going to happen, is unlike anything else this lifestyle will give you. The jealousy and the arousal arrive simultaneously, indistinguishable from each other, a single current running through you that is almost unbearable in its intensity.

Let it happen. Watch her be wanted. Watch her choose. Watch her discover what she's capable of in a room full of people who understand exactly what she is, and some who are just figuring it out for themselves.

You brought her here. She is desirable, and men want her.

This is what you wanted.

Chapter 9

Euphoria

Frank and Linda were waiting outside on the pavement when I pulled up, Frank in a dark suit that actually fitted his large frame, Linda in a black wrap dress with her fading blonde hair up. They looked like a couple heading to a corporate dinner rather than a sex club, which I supposed was the point.

"We were starting to think you'd bottled it," Frank said, grinning, as we climbed out. Tyler and Morgan got out of the back, Morgan immediately pulling her coat tighter against the cold.

"The others are already inside," Linda said, kissing Daisy on the cheek. "Kelly and Charlotte were freezing. Probably because neither of them was wearing much." She looked Daisy up and down. "You look incredible, sweetheart."

"So do you," Daisy replied. She was right. Linda looked fabulous.

The venue from the outside was deliberately anonymous, a converted warehouse on a quiet street in the city's industrial fringe, a single brushed steel sign reading *Euphoria* beside an unmarked door with a small camera above it. There were no windows. No noise escaped the building. There was just a shiny buzzer with a red light and a member's code, which Frank punched in without ceremony. The light turned green.

"First time's always the worst bit," Morgan said quietly beside me, squeezing my arm. "Once you're inside, it's just people."

"People having sex," Tyler added.

"People having sex," Morgan agreed cheerfully. The door swung open, and she beckoned us inside with one hand. "After you."

* * *

The woman at the reception desk was cute, with big blue eyes and a beehive hairstyle. She was entirely matter-of-fact as she took our membership confirmation—Tyler had arranged guest passes for us—which I was grateful for, as the biggest thing I was dreading was making small talk with strangers. She checked out IDs, then ran through the house rules with the monotone voice of someone who'd done it several hundred times.

No means no. Always. For everyone, without exception. No photography under any circumstances. Condoms are available for free throughout the premises. The dress code for the social areas was smart casual. Beyond the inner door — the play areas, the rooms — street clothes weren't permitted. Underwear, or less. Robes were available from the changing rooms if preferred.

Daisy absorbed all of this as though she was in solicitor mode, nodding several times, probably out of nerves. Then we were given wristbands and waved through.

* * *

I hadn't known what to expect, but any expectations I did have turned out to be wrong in almost every way.

The main social lounge had low-lit, soft-coloured ambient lighting that made everyone look their best. Black leather Chesterfield sofas were arranged in clusters, and a long bar ran along one wall, staffed by two bartenders who were casually chatting to everyone they served. 80s era music emanated from speakers set into the ceiling, at a level you could comfortably talk over. The place was fairly busy, not packed, but enough people to make it feel popular, all chatting or drinking, looking more relaxed than I felt. Most of them were dressed, at least in here. It looked, at first glance, like a very attractive private members' bar.

But then you noticed the details. A corridor beyond the lounge, glimpsed through a beaded curtain, with its low red lighting and rooms coming away from it. A couple on the far sofa, the woman sideways across the man's lap, his hand beneath her skirt and by the look on her face, she was enjoying whatever he was doing. A viewing window set into one wall,

currently showing an empty room beyond, dimly lit with a leather-upholstered platform in the centre.

We got a couple of drinks from the bar, but had only been sitting on one of the leather settees for a couple of minutes before Morgan appeared. "Right," she said briskly. "Clothes first, or you can't enjoy the rest of the club. Come on. Bring your drinks with you."

She shepherded us through a door at the side of the main bar and into the changing room. It was better appointed than I'd expected. Clean magnolia walls, individual lockers, a long bench down the centre, a rack of folded robes in various colours and graduated sizes near the door.

"Lockers for your clothes and valuables," Morgan said, already reaching for a robe. "Wear these while you're in the public spaces. The playrooms have their own rules." She held up the robe and assessed Tyler against it. "You'll need the large."

Daisy looked at me. "Okay. We're really doing this."

"We are," I nodded.

It was easier to undress in front of people than I expected, mainly because Tyler, Morgan, Frank and Linda had all seen us and each other naked by now. But it still felt strange, simply because of the fact that we were in a sex club.

Daisy reached back for her zip, and I crossed to help her, easing it down from the nape of her neck to the small of her back, my knuckles trailing the line of her spine. She stepped out of the red dress, folded it, and placed it in the locker, then stood in the red lace underwear and both stockings. She looked incredible. I became aware of Frank and Tyler both gazing appreciatively at her before she took a black robe and slid it around her shoulders.

Once I'd done the same, wearing just a pair of tight black shorts beneath, Morgan announced, "Time for your tour," and led us back out through the bar.

Heads turned as we passed, the robe being the lingua franca here, the currency of entry, and then she paused at the beaded curtain at the far end of the lounge and gestured us through like she was the venue's own, well-organised guide.

The corridor beyond was narrow and low-lit, the walls painted matte black, the lighting a deep arterial red that turned everything slightly unreal. Rooms came away from it on either side, numbered, each with a small

panel beside the door, glowing red, green, or amber. Tyler explained that the ones glowing green were free, the red ones were occupied, and the amber-lit rooms were also occupied, but people were still invited to enter. There were several amber lights already.

Daisy had found my hand, squeezing it firmly as Morgan stopped at a corner and turned to address us quietly, as if we were in an art gallery.

"So those are the private rooms, lockable, the panel is inside, choose red, amber or green. Down here are the open rooms. Anyone can watch; there are no doors, and some of them have one-way glass viewing windows." She pointed left. "The large communal sex space is that way. And the dungeon at the end, down the stairs."

She led us left, past the entrance to the communal play space, a large, open area, cooler in temperature and atmosphere, a vast graffiti mural covering the end wall in explicit, stylised nude figures. Four padded platforms were in the centre, in a loose arrangement, and three fully naked couples already in various sexual configurations across them, the sounds of sex reaching us before we reached the doorway. Daisy stopped at the entrance and looked in for a long moment, her fingers tightening slightly in mine. Her palm felt sweaty.

At the far end of the corridor, the door to the dungeon staircase stood ajar. A rhythmic noise came from below, a sound that could have been a crop on skin, followed by a male-sounding yelp. Linda peered toward it with an expression of complicated curiosity. Frank peered with her.

"Frank and Linda like it down there," Morgan informed us, and then we made our way back to the main bar. The bead curtain swung closed behind us, and the more comforting noise of the lounge returned, the music and gentle conversation. We were back in something that almost resembled an ordinary evening out, if you didn't look too closely.

Daisy leaned close to my ear. "The communal room," she said quietly. "I want to get fucked in there later."

Then she let go of my hand and went to join Russell and Charlotte, who were standing at the bar. I walked with her, but let her talk to them alone for a moment, taking in the room and trying to absorb everything I'd seen.

I bought Daisy another glass of wine and a top of Diet Coke for myself, then watched as our group began to disperse. Tyler had his hand on the small of Morgan's back, guiding her through the beaded curtain and down the corridor with a middle-aged white couple, the woman turning to look at

Morgan with an expression of open appreciation as she let her robe slip from one shoulder, exposing her breast. Morgan smiled back with a composure that told me she'd done this before.

Then I heard my name.

Kelly joined us at the bar, leaning in to kiss me on the cheek. She was wearing almost nothing, a silver slip dress, shoestring straps, the fabric barely reaching mid-thigh. But that wasn't what almost made me drop my drink. The man beside her was not who I'd been expecting.

Kelvin. Daisy's mother's former lover.

I saw Daisy go very still as he approached.

Kelly's expression changed, sensing our discomfort. "I should have told you Kelvin was coming," she started. "I never thought—"

"It's fine," Daisy cut in, saving the awkward moment. Her voice was level, and she smiled, but I couldn't immediately tell if it was genuine. She looked at Kelvin directly. "Hello, Kelvin."

He looked back at her, his eyes drifting over the black robe, then back to her eyes. He was in his early fifties, dark-skinned, still lean, good-looking in a weathered way, grey in his back hair and short beard. This was the man who had set Daisy so hard against infidelity, the moment she walked in on her mother cheating on her father with him.

"Daisy." His voice was deep, gravelly. "I know this is a bit of a strange place to meet again, but I'm glad we're getting the chance to talk."

"It's more than a bit strange," she agreed. "But, yes, we should probably talk about it."

"It was a long time ago, when you saw what you saw. You were—"

"Far too young to understand what was happening," Daisy replied. "I didn't know that mum and dad were into the whole cuckolding thing. I just saw it as cheating, then blamed it all on her when their relationship ended."

There was a beat of silence.

"Diane and Mark were adults," Kelvin said. "Adults making choices. Those choices didn't work out for their marriage, but they still spend time together, you know? I still see her. With her new boyfriend, we all sometimes—"

"I know," Daisy interrupted him, putting a hand on his arm. He looked down at it, then back to her face.

"I guess you don't want to know about your mother's bedroom habits." Kelvin apologised. "Sorry. And I'm sorry that I told your mother about

seeing you at the party." He paused. "I was concerned about what you were getting into. Whether you'd thought it through."

"She told me everything," Daisy replied. "Mum and I had a heart-to-heart at Christmas and cleared the air." She looked at him for another moment, then something in her posture shifted. "But if you really feel bad, get me a drink," she said, "and we'll call it even."

Kelvin laughed and ordered her another glass of wine as she downed the one I'd just bought her. The tension between them now dissolved, Kelly let out a breath and immediately began talking to Daisy about the venue, pointing things out even though Morgan had given us the full tour.

Russell made his way over as they chatted. "Is Daisy alright?" he asked quietly. "I heard about her... history with Kelvin."

"She will be," I replied. "Life's never short of complications, is it?"

"Not when you do what we do," he grinned.

Charlotte leaned in from Russell's other side and touched my arm. She was in a dark green robe, hanging slightly open at the front, enough to show the inner slopes of her generous breasts.

"Hi Jordan," she said simply.

"Hi, Charlotte."

Russell looked between us and smiled. "You two just need to fuck and get it out of the way," he shrugged. "Tonight's as good a night as any."

"We'll see how the night shakes out," I replied, not wanting to promise anything I couldn't deliver.

* * *

The club filled steadily over the next hour. Groups arrived, couples separated, reformed, disappeared down the corridor and came back. The social lounge hummed with conversation and low music. I didn't see anyone I knew apart from our group, although Frank and Linda had gone—to the dungeon with some freaky-looking couple, Kelly informed me—and Tyler and Morgan were in one of the private rooms having a good time with some friends.

Daisy had loosened with another drink, the strangeness of the situation with Kelvin processed and filed away. She was talking to Charlotte now with the animation she got when she actually liked someone, and Charlotte was leaning in, laughing at something, her hand briefly on Daisy's arm.

When I went to join Daisy, a couple approached us, attractive, mid-thirties, the woman not even wearing a robe, in a sheer teddy that did nothing to hide her voluptuous figure, the man with his hand at her waist. They were direct without being aggressive, interested without being presumptuous, and I watched Daisy respond to them with a confidence that I hadn't expected.

"Not yet," she said to me quietly, when they'd moved on at her gentle deflection. "Maybe after another drink, when I'm drunk enough not to feel terrified."

"I know how you feel. I wish I could have a few beers to take the edge off, but I'm driving," I reminded her.

She patted my shoulder sympathetically.

Another couple circled in, younger, maybe even younger than us, the man outrageously good-looking, and Daisy accepted the invitation to dance in the small cleared space near the bar without hesitation. I watched her move against him, his hands going slowly from her waist to her ass, her face turned up to his, and my jaw tightened with the mixture of anticipation and jealousy. She kissed him once, briefly, her fingers on his groin, feeling through his robe, teasing him, but then another couple descended on them from the side, friends apparently, and the momentum dissolved in a flurry of hellos and laughter and the man was absorbed away with cheerful apologies thrown over his shoulder.

Daisy came back to me slightly flushed and mildly frustrated.

"This is not as straightforward as I thought it would be," she said through gritted teeth. "I thought that it would... just happen, you know?"

She was right. I felt the same. I didn't think the night would comprise just drinking and watching everyone pair off, but here we were. Russell and Charlotte were talking to a couple near the viewing window, through which I could see an older, grey-haired couple fucking on the leather seat inside. Kelly and Kelvin were nowhere to be seen.

Then, with the latest drink working its magic on Daisy's nerves, she turned to me and said, very simply, "To hell with this. I want you."

"Like, as in sex? Here?"

"Of course as in sex. Let's find a room," she shrugged. "The more I think about it, I don't want to be cheap and just fuck a complete stranger. Not yet anyway. But I do want sex. I didn't buy this underwear for nothing, so come on, let's go find somewhere."

I let her take me by the hand and lead me through the beaded curtains. We found one of the private rooms, one with a viewing window that had a panel you could slide closed, the light on the panel glowing green, and the door unlocked.

Once inside, I turned to look at the control panel beside the door.

"Red or amber?" I asked, not sure what to press.

"What's the point in coming here if we're just going to fuck in private?" She had a point. We may as well be at home, in a comfortable bed, rather than the rather hard-looking vinyl bed in front of us.

"Amber it is. If someone wants to join us, we'll see how we feel." I confirmed the decision by pressing the yellow button, then moved toward the viewing window to slide it shut.

"Leave it."

I turned. Daisy was standing in the middle of the room in the red lace lingerie, the robe already off her shoulders and dropped to the floor, one hip cocked, her arms loose at her sides. I nodded toward the window.

"Someone'll watch."

"I know," she said.

I left it open.

The room was small and warm, lit amber, the bed a wide vinyl-upholstered platform that was exactly as practical and unromantic as it looked, easy to wipe down, built for purpose rather than comfort. I dropped the robe, pushed my shorts down, and stood in front of her and let her look at me the way I was looking at her.

She was already breathing heavily, her breasts heaving in the red bra. My cock hardened quickly, the riskiness of what we were doing making my heart beat hard in my chest.

I kissed her passionately, then turned her and walked her backwards to the edge of the bed and pushed her gently down onto it.

I didn't undress her. I reached down and pulled the red lace panties to one side, noticing for the first time that she'd shaved her pussy bald. She moaned softly as I pushed a finger inside her wetness, already slick and ready for me, her hips tilting up immediately. Then I knelt on the cool vinyl surface and pushed into her slowly, watching her face the whole time. Her eyes closed, one hand going to her breasts, pulling them free of the red lace cups.

"Oh, fuck," she breathed. "Finally. I hope someone watches us."

“We left the door on amber,” I reminded her. “Someone might even join us.”

“Good,” she moaned softly as I thrust into her again.

I began to fuck her properly, and the sounds she made in that small amber room were not the sounds she made at home. She was louder, performing but still enjoying it, her body rolling up to meet mine with a greediness she didn't bother to moderate. The vinyl was cool and faintly tacky beneath my knees; it must have felt the same against her back, but she didn't care at all, her legs wrapping around me, her fingers raking my back.

I was aware, after a few minutes, of a shadow beyond the viewing window, someone I didn't recognise, a man in a robe, pausing in the corridor, stopped by what he could see through the glass. He stood for a moment and then stepped closer, and something about being watched by a total stranger, with my wife spread out beneath me, her tits bouncing freely, her pussy on show, went through me like a high voltage current.

Her breasts were flushed, her nipples hard, her blonde hair loose across the vinyl. I fucked her harder as the stranger was joined by another shape at the window and then another, and I looked down at Daisy. She was looking up at me with those lust-darkened brown eyes and her mouth open, moaning loudly, then she turned her head toward the window, and her eyes went wide.

I looked sideways.

Kelvin was there. And behind him, Kelly, her auburn hair loose, her white robe catching the red corridor light, her hand on Kelvin's arm as they watched us through the glass. They smiled when our eyes met.

Daisy looked at them for a long moment. Then she raised one hand and crooked her finger, beckoning them inside.

“What are you—”

“Shush,” she silenced me. I looked at Kelvin. His mouth curved into a smile as he disappeared from the window, then the door opened, and he came in.

“Would you mind if I joined you?” he asked politely from the doorway.

Daisy didn't answer. She just reached out her hand toward him.

He crossed the room, dropping the robe as he entered fully, the door closing behind him. He was already hard, and when he stood at the edge of the bed, I did a double-take at the size of his cock. He was perhaps eight inches long or so, the shaft and head a very dark brown, a fuzz of dark hair

around the base. Without saying a word, Daisy took him in her hand, looked up at him and then at me, a question in her eyes that had its own answer already folded inside it.

I nodded. This wasn't what I had expected to happen tonight, but I was so fucking horny that I couldn't have stopped it if I'd wanted to.

She took him into her mouth. I began to fuck her again.

The sound she made around him, muffled, a slight gag as he pushed deeper into her mouth, went through me like another electric shock.

"Fuck me harder," she told me, so I did, making her tits bounce violently, making her groan around Kelvin's cock. She fucked me back, her hips moving to meet my thrusts, her mouth sucking him greedily, her hand working the four or five inches of his cock that she couldn't fit in her mouth. Kelvin stood there with his head back, his eyes closed and said nothing at all.

I felt myself getting close, just as Tyler appeared alongside us. I looked to the side, and Kelly was there, watching her boyfriend fuck my wife. Tyler looked at Daisy, and she looked back at him, at the hard black cock jutting out from in front of him. flushed, undone, sitting cross-legged on the bed — and then at me with a raised eyebrow.

"I want Tyler to fuck me now," Daisy said, a hand on my chest, slowing me, stopping me. "Kelvin can stay. I want to try two black cocks at the same time."

Tyler's face broke into a slow grin as I stepped back. He climbed onto the vinyl surface, and I watched as my wife arranged herself between them, rolling onto all fours. Tyler got behind her, Kelvin in front, and Daisy took both their cocks in this new position, making sounds I had never heard from her before. Her moans were lower, raw and even louder than before.

A hand closed around my wrist, and I turned, expecting to see Kelly, but it wasn't her.

"Come with me," Charlotte said, her blonde hair catching in the yellow light above her.

"I can't leave —"

"Jordan." Her eyes were steady, direct, telling me this was the right thing to do. "Come with me. Please."

I looked back at the bed. Daisy was still on her knees, Tyler pumping into her rhythmically, deep thrusts that made Daisy's back arch. Kelvin was at the head of the bed, Daisy's mouth around his shaft, and the sounds she

was making were nothing I could listen to for another thirty seconds without losing every last shred of composure.

My cock was so hard it was almost painful. I felt like I'd cum if I dared touch myself.

I went with Charlotte.

She led me to the communal lounge, the graffiti wall blazing its explicit panorama across the far end, the neon lights cool and blue-white after the amber room light and the red bulbs along the corridor. A small handful of people were occupying the beds, fucking or watching or both. Russell was waiting for us, leaning on the wall with a beer in his hand.

"Finally," he grinned when he saw me.

We took two steps towards the nearest bed, then Charlotte turned to face me, untied the robe and let it fall.

I'd seen her naked before, but up close like this, she was — there was no other word for it — spectacular. Blonde hair loose to her shoulders, her body full and pale and unashamed, heavy breasts that moved with their own weight as she moved, her stomach soft, her pussy completely shaved. She dropped to her knees on the mat in front of me without ceremony and took me into her mouth, my hand going automatically to her hair.

God, she was good. The urgency to cum had gone on the way here, my cock softening some, but she built me slowly towards being painfully hard again. Her full lips felt good sliding along my shaft, her tongue worked the head, and her hands cupped my balls, daring to touch beneath, stroking over my asshole.

Her eyes came up to meet mine, the corners of her mouth twitching into a smile around my cock. I felt myself getting close again and pulled back before it could take hold.

"Oh, no," she shook her head, "You're not getting out of here until I've had you."

She got up and lay back on the nearest platform, pulling me with her, drawing her knees up, her thighs open so I could see the wetness of her pink slit. I couldn't deny her, or myself. I needed sex, even if it made me lose the battle not to cum.

I positioned my erection against her folds, then pushed into her before I could overthink it. She was soaking wet, loose and hot. Russell said, "There you go," from somewhere behind me, and I just gave in to my desire and fucked her.

I gave it to her hard, not gently, she said she didn't want gentle, encouraging me to relax and enjoy her pussy. She was meeting every thrust with a matching tilt of her hips and pulling me into her, her hands in the small of my back. Her large, heavy breasts swung obscenely on her chest as I lengthened my strokes, pulling all the way, then slamming home.

"Yes, go on," Russell egged me on. "Fuck her good."

I became aware of other people watching us, not just him, and wondered briefly if this was what it would be like when I inevitably fucked Sariya next week. If having Niran watching would be the same as Russell. Would he talk through it, too? Would he instruct me to pound the shit out of his wife, like Russell was doing now? Probably not. But the thought didn't slow me down.

Charlotte came with both hands gripping my forearms, her back lifting clean off the vinyl, a cry bouncing off the ceiling and walls. She shuddered through it, her thighs clamped around me, her nails leaving crescents in my arms.

I stopped, just as my balls were tightening, pulling out, taking deep breaths, trying to keep control.

"I just came so fucking hard," Charlotte said breathlessly.

"Good." I was out of breath too.

"The guy can fuck," Russell chuckled, clapping a hand on my shoulder, his erection swinging dangerously close to mine as I turned to face him. I took a step back.

Charlotte sat up and looked at me for a moment. "You're saving that for Daisy?" She pointed at my throbbing cock. "Go find her, before Kelvin and Tyler wreck her pussy permanently."

"Yeah," I nodded. "I need to check on her."

Charlotte turned to her husband. "Your turn," she said, lying back down and opening her legs again.

Russell set down his drink.

I picked up a robe — I wasn't sure whose it was — and pulled it on, then walked back through the corridor in a state that could only be described as controlled dissociation. My cock was erect, my pulse was loud in my ears, and the red light of the corridor was doing nothing to help reorient me. Then I found the room.

The door was closed but unlocked, the panel glowing amber. The viewing window was clear; no one was watching.

I looked through.

There were four people inside, as there were when I left, but things had changed. Daisy was on her back, her long legs spread, bare toes pointing towards the ceiling, her red underwear gone entirely now. The two black men were still using my wife's pussy and mouth, but Kelly was naked beside them now, her auburn hair loose, her full curves gilded in the dim, warm light. She was rubbing Daisy's clit with the fingers of one hand, the other hand moving between her own thighs in slow, deliberate circles.

Fuck. This was crazy. Then I realised something. Tyler was the one at Daisy's head, working his cock in and out of her mouth, which meant...

Kelvin was between her thighs, his large black hands holding her legs apart, the full, considerable length of his thrusting into her with a slow, but hard motion.

Shit. I shouldn't have left them alone. Had Charlotte known this would happen?

I turned the handle and stepped inside. Just as I closed it behind me, Tyler pulled out of her mouth, and a streak of white cum erupted from the tip of his cock, spraying across her chin. He grunted, a hoarse sound, his hand wanking his cock slowly, another pulse of white landing across Daisy's throat and the swell of her breasts. Daisy made a sound — not protest, nowhere near protest — and her tongue moved across her lower lip, her mouth opening, letting him shoot a third jet onto her tongue.

Tyler jerked every drop of his seed onto my wife's face and tits, then stepped back, spent and satisfied, and picked up his robe.

That's when Kelly looked up and saw me. She didn't smile. Her face was straight and serious, as serious as I'd ever seen her, and she reached over and slid two fingers into Daisy's open mouth.

"Taste that," she said softly. "Suck them clean."

They were the fingers she'd had inside herself a minute ago. Daisy did as she was told, licking Kelly's pussy juices without objecting. Then she turned to Kelvin, without looking away from Daisy's face: "Fuck her fast and hard. Make her cum like only a big black cock can."

Kelvin hitched her legs higher, lifting her ass from the vinyl and started giving it to her hard, his balls slapping against her ass noisily. Daisy's hands shot out to either side of her and scrabbled at the vinyl, uncontrollable whimpers escaping her lips around Kelly's fingers.

Kelly moved her hand away and looked at me.

"Oh god, oh god, oh god," Daisy wailed in a voice that barely sounded like hers, but Kelly ignored her, her focus on me.

"Come closer," she instructed me.

I moved to the edge of the platform. Kelly's hand found my cock through the robe, then pushed it aside, her fingers wrapping around it with a cool, unhurried confidence. She dragged me by my erection onto the vinyl.

"Daisy," Kelly said. "Look at your husband. He's watching you get pounded."

Daisy's head turned. Her eyes found mine, wide, her expression completely undone, her body still moving on Kelvin's cock, and something passed between us that I knew I'd spend a long time thinking about from this day onwards.

Then Kelvin drove into her one last time, his full length, and held there, and Daisy came apart. Her whole body seized, her spine arching off the bed, a long, broken cry tearing out of her, and then, to my complete surprise, she squirted. A gush of clear fluid soaked Kelvin's cock as he pulled out, gushing down her thighs. Her legs shook violently, but he held himself inside her, letting her ride it out, his hands firm on her thighs, his expression one of pure dark satisfaction.

Then he started fucking her again, even though she was still shuddering, still gasping, her thighs trembling. Kelly felt my cock throbbing and said clearly, "Daisy. Open your mouth."

Daisy obeyed. Her eyes on mine, her lips parting, wanting my load.

Kelly angled me toward her and wanked me off, firm and fast, working me towards my climax, just as Kelvin groaned low in his chest and pulled out. Seeing his huge cock spray a massive line of sticky cum across her pussy to her stomach, then more in long, hot pulses, tipped me over the edge.

Kelly pulled me forward, then wrapped a hand around Daisy's head, pulling us together, and I came into Daisy's open mouth. I braced myself with a hand on the wall above the bed, my whole body shaking with the force of it. Daisy closed her lips around me, taking all of it with her eyes open and her gaze on mine.

"Now swallow it," Kelly said.

Daisy swallowed.

The room was very quiet for a moment. Kelly sat back on her heels with an expression of complete satisfaction. Kelvin was breathing hard, still

pulling slowly on his softening dick, milking out the last few drops of cum. I was barely able to stay upright.

Daisy lay between us all, her breasts heaving, covered in cum, utterly beautiful, and smiling.

"That was fucking crazy," she sighed, then giggled. "I can't believe what we just did."

"Me neither," Kelvin replied, scooping his discarded robe from the floor. "But it was pretty damn amazing."

He reached into the pocket of his robe and pulled something out, passing it to me in his fist. I took it and looked down to see a blue pill. "What is—"

"You know what it is," he leaned in and spoke into my ear quietly. "You'll want it to reclaim Daisy when you get home. Make sure you do, it's important, okay?"

I nodded once as Kelly handed me a robe that I quickly wrapped around my shoulders, dropping the pill into my pocket.

Kelvin pulled the robe on, and Kelly gathered hers from the floor. As they left, Kelvin paused only to squeeze my shoulder briefly, Kelly gave me a light kiss on the cheek, and then they were gone.

Daisy pushed herself upright slowly and gathered her underwear. I handed her the last robe from the floor, and she belted it loosely and ran her fingers through her hair. She looked, somehow, radiant.

"Right," she clapped her hands together, looking out of the window, "Buy me a drink and then let's head home."

* * *

The main bar was still busy, the night not yet done for most of its inhabitants. We found Tyler at the bar, dressed, nursing a beer, his phone face down on the counter. He looked up when he saw us and grinned.

"There they are." He looked us over. "Did you have a good time back there?"

"You should have stayed to see the climax," Daisy commented as I ordered one last drink for us both. "I... um..." She lowered her voice. "I think I squirted."

"You definitely squirted," I interrupted, taking a much-needed drink of the cold Diet Coke the handsome young barman slid across the bar.

"There's no thinking about it."

"Impressive." Tyler tilted his head toward the back of the club. "Morgan's still occupied with a group of lads, maybe four, maybe five by now. She's absolutely in her element." He said it with complete equanimity, even pride. "Linda and Frank are still in the dungeon."

"Still?" I asked. "I didn't know they were into BDSM?"

Tyler shrugged. "Poor old Frank won't be able to sit down tomorrow." He picked up his beer. "But whatever you're into, it's all good with me."

Daisy laughed. I did too. I'd imagined it would be Linda getting spanked, or cropped, or whatever it was they were doing down there, not big Frank.

"You two finish your drinks and head home," Tyler said, and his voice shifted slightly. "Go and reconnect. Don't wait around for us. We'll get a cab when we're done." He looked at Daisy. "You're quite incredible. I hope you know that. You could have had any man in the club tonight"

Daisy leaned forward and kissed him on the cheek.

"Thank you," she said quietly. "For everything."

Tyler nodded once, smiling at us, and for once, there was no agenda in it, no sexual innuendo, no leering at her body. He was just being genuine. "I'll catch you at the next meeting."

He turned back to drinking his beer and waiting for Morgan, and we went to get changed, ready for home.

* * *

The drive back was quiet, as things often are after something big has happened. Daisy had her heels on her lap and was looking out at the passing lights.

"I slept with Charlotte," I confessed, needing to get it off my chest now that things had calmed down. "While you were with Tyler and Kelvin. She took me to the communal room. Russell watched us."

Daisy was quiet for a moment, turning to look at me. "I know."

"How?"

"I smelled her perfume on you. I just knew. A woman's intuition." She went back to looking out of the window. "Your cock also smelled like pussy."

We both laughed.

"Was she good?" Daisy asked softly.

"I'm not going to lie to you." I glanced sideways at her, but she was gazing into the distance still. "Yes. Is that okay? Are we okay?"

"We're better than good." She moved, looking at me, sliding a hand over my thigh. "I'm glad it was all one-sided. It feels... unfair that I should get all the fun. I'm happy you got some, too."

I drove for another half mile, not knowing what to say to that.

"What about Kelvin?" I asked. "I didn't see that coming."

Daisy smiled at me, her hand creeping closer to my groin.

"I know. Neither did I," she replied. "That's what's going around in my head now. Out of everyone, I slept with Kelvin. It seems almost —"

"Absurd?" I offered the word when she paused.

"Yes." She was quiet for a long moment. When she spoke, it was carefully, like someone who had been arranging the words for some time.

"Somehow, it just felt right. That's the thing. I can't explain it any other way." She turned to look at me again, not moving her hand from my upper thigh. "He's the one who changed everything. That afternoon, walking in on him and mum, that's the moment my whole understanding of sex and marriage was... changed. I've been carrying that image since then, blaming their break-up on mum and him." She exhaled, as if this was something she needed to get off her chest. "Sleeping with him tonight felt like going back to that moment and taking it back. Instead of it being something that happened to me, it's something I chose. Call it exorcising a demon. Call it me owning that moment, I don't know how else to explain it. It's like I somehow *ate the monster*, I don't know how else to explain it."

Her jaw set as I glanced at her. "I've beaten it. The fear that I might end up becoming my mother. Whatever fear it left in me, it's gone because I've come out of tonight knowing something with more certainty than ever before."

I reached down and took her hand in mine.

"What is it?" I asked softly.

"That I love you," she said. "I love you more than I did this morning. More than I did a year ago. I might have given my body to other men, but I fucking love you, Jordan Hoyland."

My heart swelled. "I love you, too. More than I ever have," I replied simply, unable to best what she'd just said. "We've done something most

couples never even think about. You looked at your insecurities, jealousy, possessiveness, fear, and you walked straight through them."

She squeezed my hand. "The sky's the limit now, Jordan. I mean that. There are maybe one or two things I'd still like to try."

"Such as?"

She smiled. "Lewis, of course. I don't know yet. But after that." She took a deep breath again. "I want to take things to the next level. With us. The real next level."

That sounded exciting. I pulled onto Far Bridge Road and towards our end of the cul-de-sac. The house was waiting for us, windows dark. I parked and cut the engine, and the silence of the street settled around us.

"What does that mean?" I asked. "The next level."

She turned to face me fully, took my face in both hands, and kissed me, slowly and lovingly, the kind of kiss that has nothing to prove and everything to say.

When she pulled back, her brown eyes were bright.

"A baby," she said.

The word crashed through me. I looked at her, feeling tears spring into my eyes. "A baby?"

"A baby," she repeated quietly, and smiled.

The word sat between us in the quiet car for a long moment. My heart was thumping in my chest, and for once, it had nothing to do with sharing my wife or the Neighbourhood Watch or sleeping with someone.

"Okay," I said.

"Okay?"

"Yeah." I brought her hand to my mouth. "Let's do that. Let's become a family."

She exhaled, and laughed, and pressed her forehead to mine.

* * *

Inside, Daisy went upstairs. I stood in the hallway and did what I always did on autopilot, keys on the hook, shoes off, a quick pass through the emails on my phone before I followed her up.

There was the usual junk mail. A newsletter from my art supplies company. Two things from the accountant that could wait until Monday.

Then one from Demure Millie Grace.

The subject line was blank. I opened it.

Hi, Jordan. Thanks for getting in touch. I always like hearing from my followers, though your message caught me off guard.

First of all, you're right. It's me. I'm Sinner Minnie. Please, please don't say anything to anyone. I'm trusting you completely with this.

But yes. God, yes. The idea of a community of people who actually understand this life, who live it properly, I'd love to know more. Lately, I've felt a little bit alone with all of it. My partner, Mr Heart—Jamie is his real name—is as inexperienced as I am. So, perhaps, you can help him, too. Help us both to find our feet in this new world.

Maybe you could give me your number? We could talk properly sometime?

Millie

I stood in the hallway for a moment.

Lewis and Sariya first. See that through properly, the way it deserves. Then Millie. Then —

From upstairs, Daisy called my name.

I pocketed the phone and checked that the blue pill was still in my jacket pocket. It was. I headed into the kitchen, swallowing it down with a glass of water.

I smiled to myself at the audacity of life, the way it kept changing in waves, one after another, each one bigger than the last. And then I went upstairs to reclaim my wife.

Afterword

So, there you have it. A baby. Starting a family is a big deal, but there's the unfinished business of Sariya, Lewis, and Dr Patterson to name just a few. We'll be getting around to that, don't worry.

Will Daisy's unexpected coupling with Kelvin affect her relationship with her parents? And, of course, Claudia and Tom. What is going to happen with them? Has Daisy reclaimed her crown as the Darling of Far Bridge Rise with the goings on at Euphoria? Or is Claudia going to continue to steal her limelight?

In 'The Hotwife Diaries #3: Good Girl/Bad Girl', we'll find out the answers to some of these questions, as we return to where we left off with Jamie and Millie, and the much-anticipated coming together of the two series and their characters. The book is coming out on June 1st, and pre-orders will be available soon.

Thank you so much for buying and reading this one. I hope you had fun and that you'll join me as we see what happens when the worlds of Daisy and Millie collide.

Paul

About the Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.)

He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began *'The Cuckold Collection,'* a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories*, *The Sexy Season Stories* and *The Cerulean Archives*. 2022 began two series, *Holiday Hotwives* and *A Size Queen Story* and 2023 introduced a new series, *Improper Investigations* and the return to the *Cerulean Archives* with *I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex*. 2024 saw the *My Wife* series and the *I Know Who You Did Last Summer* series reach huge success. 2025 introduced us to his best selling *Trad Wife* series, the follow up *Modern Husband*, and his sci-fi erotica series, *Cheat Codes*.

2026 brings the return of the Detective Hotwife, a new superhero hotwife erotica and the climax of the *Holiday Hotwives* books, along with his highly anticipated and biggest series to date, *The Hotwife Diaries*.

My Website: <http://www.paulgarland.net>

All my links in one place: <https://allmylinks.com/eroticapaul>

My Medium Page (exclusive stories): <https://medium.com/@belgarionten>

Patreon: <https://www.patreon.com/paulgarland>

Twitter: <https://twitter.com/eroticapaul>

Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/paulgarlanderotica>

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/paulgarlanderotica/>

Join my mailing list: [My Mailing List](#)



Also by Paul Garland

The Modern Husband's Guide Series

[The Modern Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing, Part One](#)

[The Modern Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing, Part Two](#)

[The Modern Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing, Part Three](#)

[The Modern Husband's Guide To Wife Sharing, Part Four](#)

The How To Turn Your Trad Wife Into A Hotwife Series

[How To Turn Your Trad Wife Into A Hotwife In 10 Days, Book One](#)

[How To Turn Your Trad Wife Into A Hotwife In 10 Days, Book Two](#)

[How To Turn Your Trad Wife Into A Hotwife In 10 Days, Book Three](#)

[How To Turn Your Trad Wife Into A Hotwife In 10 Days, Book Four](#)

A Hotwife Story Series

[Her Husband's Homework](#)

[His Wife's Arrangement](#)

Cheat Codes

[Book I: Cheat Codes](#)

[Book II: Hard Core](#)

[Book III: Safe Word](#)

[The Formula](#)

[Skin Deep](#)

I Know Who You Did Last Summer

[I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 1](#)

[I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 2](#)

[I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 3](#)

[I Know Who You Did Last Summer, Book 4](#)

The 'My Wife...' Series

[I Visited My Wife's Hometown... And Found Her Hidden Life, Book 1](#) [I Visited My Wife's Hometown... And Found Her Hidden Life, Book 2](#)

[I Visited My Wife's Hometown... And Found Her Hidden Life, Book 3](#)
[I Visited My Wife's Hometown... And Found Her Hidden Life, Book 4](#)
[I Explored My Wife's Fantasies... And Found A New Kind Of Love, \(Book 5\)](#)

[I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex, Book 1](#)
[I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex, Book 2](#)
[I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex, Book 3](#)
[I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex, Book 4](#)

[I Caught My Wife In Bed... With My Boss](#)
[I Caught My Wife In Bed... With My Boss, Book 2](#)

Best Hotwife Erotica Anthology

[1: Friends & Lovers](#)
[2: Fun & Games](#)
[3: Empty Nesters](#)

The 1st ACHE Collaboration

[The Hotwife Key Party: Tina](#)

The 2nd ACHE Collaboration

[The Hotwife Games: Inescapable](#)
[The Hotwife Games: Insatiable](#)

The 3rd ACHE Collaboration

[The Hotwife Cruise: Maria](#)

The Wishing Faery Chronicles

[A Second Bite At The Cherry](#)

The Holiday Hotwives Series:

[Tina: Taking One For The Team](#)
[Tina Takes Another One For The Team](#)
[Kelly: Takes Two To Tango](#)
[Stacy: Three's A Crowd](#)
[A Hotwife's Christmas Roast](#)

[Gemma: Four Letter Words](#)

[Gemma: More Than Words](#)

Sarah: Give Me Five (coming soon)

The Improper Investigations Series:

[A Hotwife's Love Letter](#)

[The Detective Hotwife](#)

The Thirst Trap (coming soon)

A Size Queen Story Series:

[Part 1: Great Lengths](#)

[Part 2: Hard Feelings](#)

Stretched Out (coming soon)

Filled Up (coming Soon)

The Cuckold Collection Series:

[Size Matters](#)

[Ex Appeal](#)

[Dark Curiosity](#)

[Locked Up](#)

[Access Denied](#)

[Access All Areas](#)

[Cleaning Up](#)

The No Angels Novels Series:

[The School Reunion](#)

[Dawn's Dark Desires](#)

[The Photo Shoot](#)

[The Bad Crowd](#)

[Katie's Casting Call](#)

[Sara's Shocking Secret](#)

[No Angels: The First Collection](#)

[No Angels: The Second Collection](#)

The No Angels Stories Series:

Tales of the Black Cats Club:

[#1: The Cat That Got The Cream](#)

[#2: Cat Got Your Tongue?](#)

[#3 Cat And Mouse](#)

The Photographer's Secret Portfolio:

[#1: The Camera Doesn't Lie](#)

[#2: Camera Shy](#)

[#3: Lights, Camera, Action](#)

The Sexy Season Stories Series:

[Tracy's Trick or Treat](#)

[A Cuckold's Christmas Carol](#)

[A Hallowe'en Hotwife House Party](#)

The Cerulean Archives Series:

[Hannah's Helping Hands](#)

[The One That Got Away... Until He Didn't](#)

[Perfectly Cucked!](#)

[Over Cucked!](#)

The Cerulean Erotica Presents Series:

[The Dream Holiday Nightmare](#)

[What Would You Do?](#)

[A Seduction in Sorrento](#)

[A Friend in Need](#)

[Beth and her Boss](#)

[Costa Del Cuck](#)

[The Complete 6-Book Bundle](#)